

ADULT – SEXES ALIKE; ♀ LARGER NO. I

Southern Cassowary

Casuarius casuarius johnsonii

CASUARIIDAE · CASSOWARIES

130–170 cm; females to ~60 kg – Australia's heaviest bird



NO. I

BREEDING J F M A M **J J A S O** N D **Jun–Oct**

DESCRIPTION

- **Casque** – tall grey-brown blade-like keratin helmet
- **Neck** – bare vivid blue skin, red on the nape
- **Wattles** – two pendulous red wattles on the foreneck
- **Plumage** – coarse, glossy black hair-like feathers
- **Feet** – three toes; inner claw a 12 cm dagger

Male glossy black, hair-like plumage; bare blue neck, red nape and twin wattles; tall horny casque. Female larger (to 1.8 m, 60+ kg), taller casque, brighter bare skin. Juvenile brown with dull head, rudimentary casque; chicks striped black and cream.

BEHAVIOUR

Strides the rainforest floor alone, gleaning fallen fruit; the key rainforest seed-disperser. Solitary, sedentary in a fixed home range; deep booms and rumbles often heard before seen. Wary; sparse.



Wet Tropics + Cape York ranges

Rainforest | Wetlands | Mangroves

DISTRIBUTION

Confined to tropical NE Queensland: Wet Tropics rainforests from Cooktown to the Paluma Range (strongholds at the Daintree and Mission Beach), plus disjunct Cape York populations in the Iron and McIlwraith Ranges. Mostly below 1,100 m.

BREEDING

Jun–Oct. Clutch 3–5, usually 4, olive-green. Ground scrape lined with leaf litter; male alone incubates ~50 days and rears chicks.

ssp. johnsonii in Australia; EPBC Endangered.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE; ♀ SMALLER NO. II

Brolga

Antigone rubicunda

GRUIDAE · CRANES

100–130 cm tall; wingspan to 2.4 m



NO. II

BREEDING J **F** **M** **A** **M** J J A **S** **O** **N** **D** Feb–May, Sep–Dec

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – bare coral-red band behind grey-green crown
- **Dewlap** – black bristled pouch under the chin
- **Plumage** – uniform silvery-grey body
- **Wingtips** – black primaries show in flight
- **Legs** – long, dark grey-black

Male tall silver-grey crane; bare red head-band, grey-green crown, black dewlap; dark legs. Female identical but noticeably smaller. Immature fully feathered grey head, lacking red skin; bare adult head develops over the first year.

BEHAVIOUR

Digs sedge and bulkuru tubers from shallow wetlands with the heavy bill; also insects, molluscs and crops. Famed bowing, leaping dance displays. Territorial pairs when breeding; dry-season flocks of 100+. Common in the north, scarcer south.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Wetlands · Grassland · Farmland

DISTRIBUTION

Widespread across Queensland, which holds Australia's largest populations – Gulf of Carpentaria floodplains and Cape York south through central and western QLD to the SEQ coast. Dry-season flocks on Gulf wetlands can exceed 1,000 birds.

BREEDING

Mainly Feb–May in N QLD (wet season); Sep–Dec in the south. Clutch usually 2. Large vegetation mound islanded in shallow swamp.

Monotypic; formerly in Grus, now Antigone.



ADULT ♂ NO. III

Victoria's Riflebird

Ptiloris victoriae

PARADISAEIDAE · BIRDS-OF-PARADISE

23–25 cm — the smallest riflebird

NO. III

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D — **Mainly Aug–Jan**

DESCRIPTION

- **Crown** — iridescent metallic blue-green cap
- **Gorget** — triangular metallic throat shield
- **Body** — velvet black with oily purple sheen
- **Bill** — long, slender, gently decurved
- **Breast band** — bronze-olive wash below the gorget

Male velvet-black with purple sheen; iridescent blue-green crown, throat-shield and central tail; olive-washed belly. Female grey-brown above with whitish eyebrow; cinnamon-buff below, marked with dark chevrons. Immature female-like; young male gains full plumage over several years.

BEHAVIOUR

Hops up trunks, probing and tearing bark and dead wood for arthropods; also canopy fruit. Polygynous — the male displays from a traditional perch with fanned wings and a rasping "yaa-ss". Solitary; common within the Wet Tropics.



Wet Tropics

Rainforest · Wet forest · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Endemic to the Wet Tropics — Cooktown south to the Seaview Range and Mt Elliot, south of Townsville, including the Atherton Tablelands. Sea level to ~1,200 m; most numerous in upland rainforest.

BREEDING

Aug–Feb; eggs late Aug–early Jan. Clutch 1–3, usually 2. Leafy cup in vine tangle or tree-fern crown; female alone builds and tends.

Monotypic; endemic to the Wet Tropics (Cooktown–Mt Elliot). The smallest riflebird.



ADULT ♂ NO. IV

Golden Bowerbird

Prionodura newtoniana

PTILONORHYNCHIDAE · BOWERBIRDS

23–25 cm – the smallest bowerbird

NO. IV

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D **Mainly Nov–Jan**

DESCRIPTION

- **Crown & nape** – glistening golden patch, silky sheen
- **Underparts** – golden-yellow, throat to undertail
- **Upperparts** – contrasting olive-brown
- **Tail** – largely golden – striking in flight
- **Build** – small, compact; ~24 cm

Male olive-brown above with glistening golden-yellow crown-patch and nape; golden-yellow underparts and tail. Female plain olive-brown above, ash-grey below, no yellow. Immature female-like with brown (not pale) eye; male takes 5–6 years to full plumage.

BEHAVIOUR

Quietly plucks fruit in the canopy; some insects and spiders taken in sallies. Male tends a twin-towered maypole bower of sticks decorated with lichen and pale flowers, rattling and calling nearby. Solitary, sedentary; sparse, upland rainforest only.



Wet Tropics

Rainforest

DISTRIBUTION

Endemic to upland Wet Tropics rainforest – patchily from Mt Windsor and Thornton Peak through the Atherton Tablelands to the Seaview Range near Paluma. Almost entirely above ~900 m.

BREEDING

Sep–Jan; eggs mainly Nov–Jan. Clutch 1–2. Bulky deep cup wedged in a sheltered trunk crevice, usually below 3 m; female alone.

Monotypic; sole member of Prionodura. Endemic to Wet Tropics uplands.



ADULT ♂ NO. V

Lovely Fairywren

Malurus amabilis

MALURIDAE · AUSTRALASIAN WRENS

12–14 cm; ~10 g

NO. V

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D — Mainly Jul–Apr; any month

DESCRIPTION

- **Crown** – azure-blue with flared pale-blue ear tufts
- **Throat** – black throat and nape band
- **Shoulders** – chestnut patches on blue upper back
- **Tail** – short, broad, blue – boldest white tips of any fairywren
- **Belly** – clean white against blackish wings

Male azure-blue crown, ear-tufts and mantle; black throat and breast; chestnut shoulders; white belly; white-tipped blue tail. Female smoky-blue above with turquoise ear-tufts, white lores and eye-ring, creamy-white below – the brightest female fairywren. Immature female-like, duller.

BEHAVIOUR

Gleans insects, especially caterpillars, along rainforest edge and vine scrub; forages higher than most fairywrens, tail fanned and cocked. Pairs and small cooperative groups with helpers; sedentary. Locally common, Cape York to the Townsville region.



Cape York & NE coast

Rainforest · Vine scrub · Mangroves · Rivers & creeks

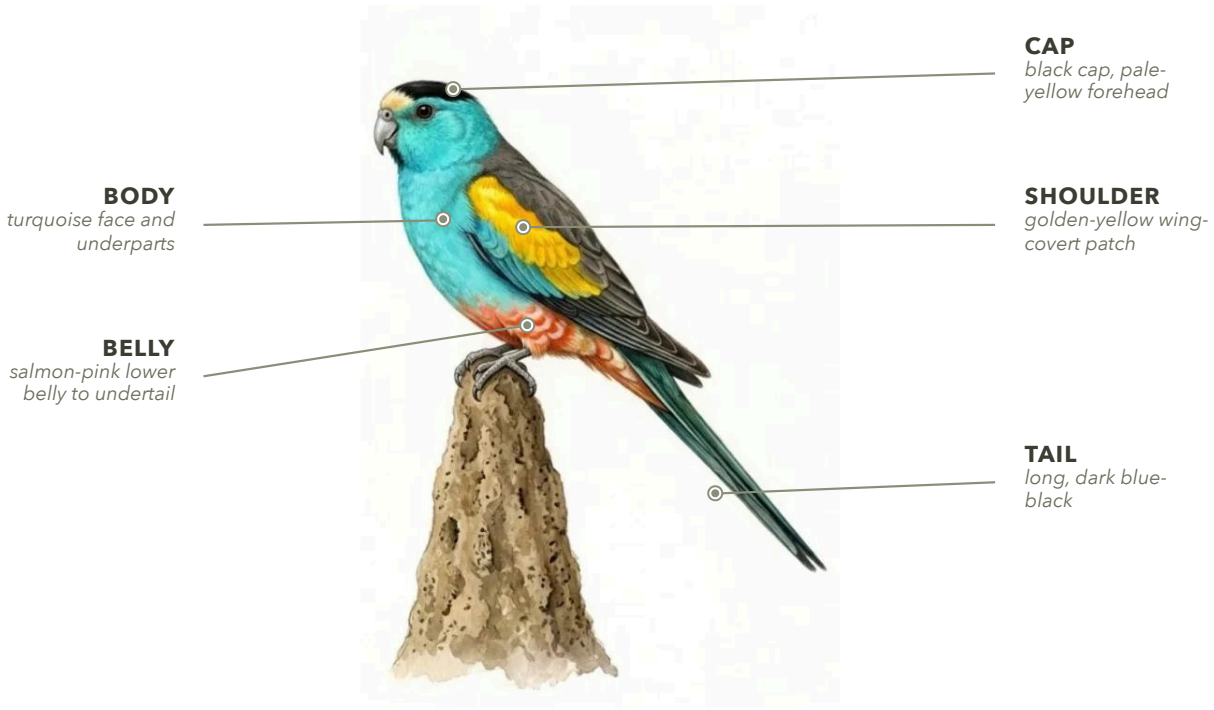
DISTRIBUTION

Endemic to far north Queensland – Cape York Peninsula on both coasts, extending down the east coast through the Wet Tropics lowlands to about Cardwell–Townsville. The only fairywren in rainforest-edge habitat across most of this range.

BREEDING

Most months, mainly Jul–Apr; multiple broods. Clutch 2–3, usually 3. Domed side-entrance nest slung low in dense foliage.

Monotypic; chestnut-shouldered group, sister to the Purple-backed Fairywren (M. assimilis).



ADULT ♂ NO. VI

Golden-shouldered Parrot

Psephotellus chrysopterygius

PSITTACULIDAE · OLD WORLD PARROTS

25–27 cm; ~55 g; long dark tail

NO. VI

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D — **Mainly Apr–Jul**

DESCRIPTION

- **Cap** – black crown behind a pale-yellow brow band
- **Body** – turquoise-blue face, breast and underparts
- **Shoulder** – golden-yellow patch across wing coverts
- **Belly** – salmon-pink lower belly to undertail
- **Mantle** – grey-brown back and wings

Male turquoise-blue with black cap, pale-yellow frontal band, golden shoulder patch, salmon-pink belly to undertail; grey-brown back. Female dull greenish-yellow with broad cream underwing-bar; older birds grey-capped. Immature like female; young male shows a brighter blue cheek.

BEHAVIOUR

Forages quietly on the ground for grass seed, chiefly fire-grass before the wet season; perches on mounds and low shrubs. Flight swift, slightly undulating. Pairs or small parties; ~700–1,100 wild birds remain, southern Cape York only.



S-central Cape York

Woodland Grassland

DISTRIBUTION

Endemic to south-central Cape York Peninsula – now just two small strongholds, around the Morehead River (Artemis Station, near Musgrave) and the middle Staaten River. Lowland savanna only.

BREEDING

Mainly Apr–Jul, soon after the wet (records Mar–Aug). Clutch 3–6, usually 4–6. Unlined chamber at the end of a tunnel dug into a termite mound.

Monotypic. Formerly Psephotus; sister to the Hooded Parrot and the extinct Paradise Parrot.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE; ♀ SMALLER BILL NO. VII

Palm Cockatoo

Probosciger aterrimus macgillivrayi

CACATUIDAE · COCKATOOS

55–60 cm; to 1.2 kg – Australia's largest parrot



NO. VII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D **Mainly Aug–Jan**

DESCRIPTION

- **Crest** – tall, spiky, backswept erectile crest
- **Cheek** – bare crimson patch – flushes scarlet when excited
- **Bill** – massive grey-black hook, largest of any cockatoo
- **Plumage** – uniform smoky grey-black
- **Tail** – broad, all black – no coloured panels

Male huge, sooty grey-black; massive erectile crest, bare crimson cheek-patch flushing scarlet when excited, enormous grey-black bill. Female similar with a smaller bill. Immature shows pale-yellow scalloping below, whitish bill-tip and pale eye-ring.

BEHAVIOUR

Feeds on nuts, hard seeds (pandanus, Parinari), fruit and larvae in canopy and on the ground; the male drums a hollow rim with a fashioned stick or seed pod. Flight slow and buoyant on deep, floppy wingbeats. Singles, pairs, trios; calls at dawn from dead emergents. Sparse; Cape York only.



Northern Cape York

Rainforest Woodland

DISTRIBUTION

In Australia, only northern Cape York Peninsula – north of Princess Charlotte Bay in the east and the Archer–Watson Rivers in the west, including the Iron and McIlwraith Ranges. Also New Guinea.

BREEDING

Mainly Aug–Jan (recorded to Mar). Clutch 1. Egg on a platform of splintered twigs inside a deep vertical hollow; pairs may fledge one young only every few years.

Australian race macgillivrayi (shared with Trans-Fly New Guinea); sole member of Probosciger.



ADULT ♂ (♀ CRIMSON & BLUE) NO. VIII

Eclectus Parrot

Eclectus polychloros macgillivrayi

PSITTACULIDAE · OLD WORLD PARROTS

42–45 cm – the largest eclectus taxon

NO. VIII

BREEDING J F M A M J **J A S O N D** Jul–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Body** – brilliant emerald green (male)
- **Flanks** – scarlet flanks and underwing, flashing in flight
- **Bill** – candy-orange upper mandible, yellow tip
- **Wing edge** – blue outer flight feathers
- **Tail** – short, dark green, pale yellow tip

Male emerald-green; scarlet flanks and underwing-coverts, blue primaries; upper mandible coral-orange tipped yellow, lower black; orange eye. Female vivid crimson with violet-blue belly-band and collar; all-black bill, pale yellow eye. Immature resembles its sex but duller, bill brownish at first.

BEHAVIOUR

Noisy, conspicuous canopy frugivore – fruits, nuts, seeds and blossom; pairs and small groups disperse from communal roosts at dawn. Flight direct with shallow wingbeats and raucous screeches. Complex cooperative breeder, several males provisioning one female. Locally common, eastern Cape York rainforest only.



Northern Cape York

Rainforest

DISTRIBUTION

In Australia, only the lowland rainforests of eastern Cape York between the Pascoe and Massy Creek–Rocky River catchments – essentially Iron Range (Kutini-Payamu) and the McIlwraith foothills. Widespread in New Guinea.

BREEDING

Jul–Jan; the female may attend the hollow much of the year. Clutch 2. Deep hollow high in an emergent rainforest tree, eggs on decayed wood dust.

Australian race macgillivrayi, the largest form; now within Papuan Eclectus E. polychloros after the split of the E. roratus complex.



ADULT – SEXES SIMILAR NO. IX

Buff-breasted Paradise-Kingfisher

Tanysiptera sylvia

ALCEDINIDAE · KINGFISHERS

~35 cm incl. 13 cm tail streamers



NO. IX

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Nov–Mar

DESCRIPTION

- **Bill** – bright orange-red, large for the bird
- **Crown** – violet-blue cap over a black mask
- **Rump** – silky white patch, glowing in dim forest
- **Streamers** – two greatly elongated white central tail feathers
- **Underparts** – warm rufous-buff

Male orange-buff below with blue cap and wings, blackish back with silky white rump-stripe; scarlet bill; white tail-streamers to 13 cm beyond the tail. Female similar with shorter streamers, often abraded when nesting. Immature duller with brownish bill, buffy scalloping, no streamers.

BEHAVIOUR

Still-hunts from a low perch in dim understorey, pouncing on earthworms, beetles, phasmids, skinks and small frogs; located by an incessant chattering trill. Flight swift and darting, the white rump flashing. Solitary or pairs; a wet-season breeding migrant from New Guinea, locally common on the NE QLD coast.



Wet Tropics

Rainforest

DISTRIBUTION

Wet-season breeding migrant from New Guinea; core population in the Wet Tropics lowlands between Cooktown and Townsville, mostly below 500 m, with scattered records north through eastern Cape York and south to Byfield.

BREEDING

Arrives early Nov, departs Mar–early Apr; breeds Nov–Mar. Clutch 3–4. Short tunnel and chamber dug into an active terrestrial termite mound.

Nominate sylvia breeds NE QLD and winters in New Guinea; race salvadoriana resident SE New Guinea.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. X

Wompoo Fruit-Dove

Ptilinopus magnificus

COLUMBIDAE · PIGEONS & DOVES

35–45 cm – Australia's largest fruit-dove

NO. X

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Aug–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – pale ash-grey head and neck
- **Breast** – rich glossy plum-purple bib
- **Belly** – bright yellow below the bib
- **Wing bar** – bold yellow spotting across green coverts
- **Upperparts** – iridescent golden-green, long tail

Sexes alike: rich purple throat to upper belly, yellow lower belly, green upperparts, pale grey head, bold yellow wing-bar; orange-red bill tipped yellow. Immature duller and greener, purple reduced or absent. Northern birds markedly smaller.

BEHAVIOUR

Sluggish canopy frugivore, swallowing large fruits (figs, laurels) whole; clambers and hangs acrobatically among vines. Easily overlooked – betrayed by falling fruit and the deep "wollack-a-woo". Flight strong, direct. Singly or in pairs; flocks at fruiting trees. Sedentary; locally common north, scarcer south.



Eastern seaboard

Rainforest

DISTRIBUTION

East-coast rainforests from eastern Cape York (Iron–McIlwraith Ranges) south through the Wet Tropics and central coast to SEQ and into NSW; lowland to upland rainforest.

BREEDING

Mainly Aug–Jan, variable with fruit crops in the north. Clutch 1. Flimsy twig platform in a fork of small tree, vine or sapling, often low; both sexes build and incubate.

Australian races: small keri (Wet Tropics) and assimilis (Cape York) v. the large southern nominate; variation partly clinal.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. XI

Noisy Pitta

Pitta versicolor

PITTIDAE · PITTAS

19–21 cm; plump, near-tailless

NO. XI

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D **Mainly Oct–Jan**

DESCRIPTION

- **Crown** – chestnut with a narrow black centre stripe
- **Hood** – jet-black face through eye to nape
- **Breast** – buff-yellow; black belly patch, scarlet vent
- **Wings** – bright green, turquoise shoulder flash
- **Build** – plump ground bird on long pinkish legs

Male stocky, short-tailed; chestnut crown with black median stripe, black face; green back, blue shoulder; buff-yellow below with black belly-patch and scarlet vent. Female near-identical, fractionally duller. Immature duller, washed-out, with grey-black orange-based bill and reduced red vent.

BEHAVIOUR

Hops on the rainforest floor flicking leaf-litter; hammers snails open on stone or log anvils. Flight low, whirring, direct; mostly terrestrial. Solitary or pairs; common but shy in coastal QLD rainforests, with some altitudinal movement in winter. The far-carrying "walk-to-work" betrays it.



Eastern seaboard

Rainforest · Wet forest · Vine scrub · Mangroves

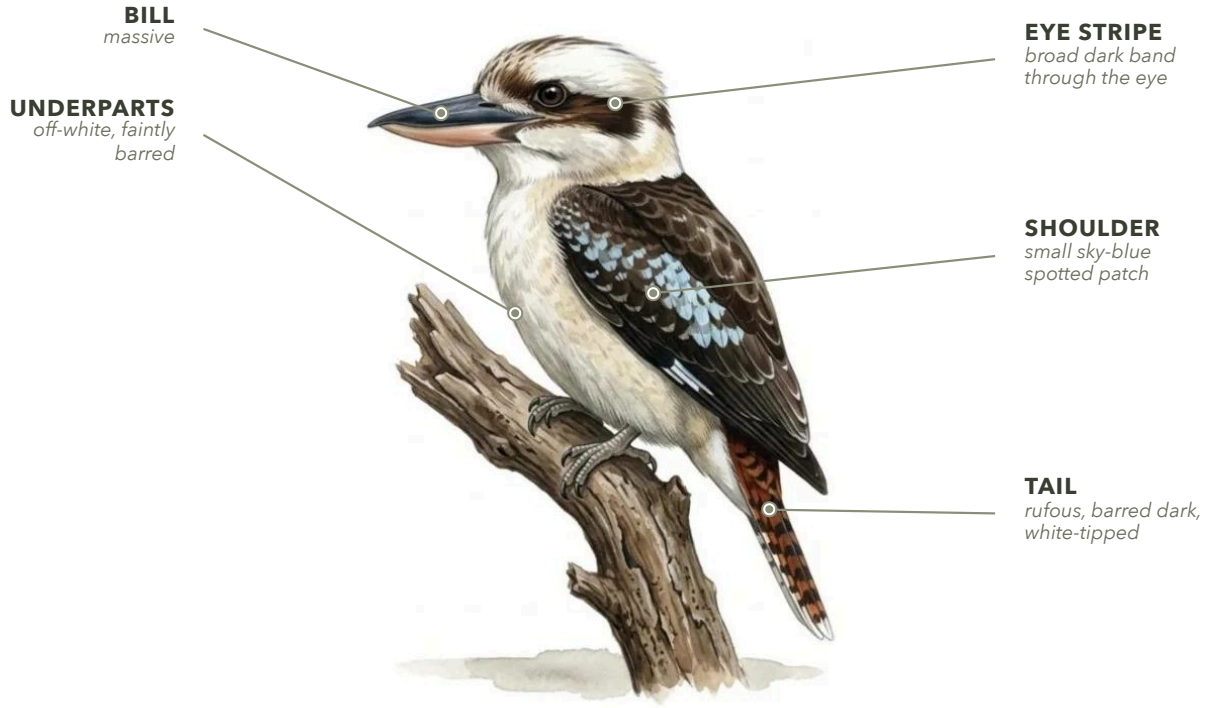
DISTRIBUTION

Coastal and subcoastal eastern QLD from Torres Strait and Cape York through the Wet Tropics to SEQ. In the Wet Tropics an altitudinal migrant – breeding upland in summer, wintering in the lowlands.

BREEDING

Mainly Oct–Jan in QLD (Nov–Feb on Cape York). Clutch 3–4. Bulky domed stick-and-leaf nest with side entrance, on the ground at a tree base, buttress or log.

Two: versicolor (Cairns district to NSW) and simillima (Torres Strait and Cape York; partial migrant to New Guinea) – intermedia no longer recognised, the variation clinal.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE; ♀ LARGER NO. XII

Laughing Kookaburra

Dacelo novaeguineae

ALCEDINIDAE · KINGFISHERS

41–47 cm – the world's heaviest kingfisher

NO. XII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A **S O N D** Mainly Sep–Dec

DESCRIPTION

- **Eye stripe** – broad dark brown band through a whitish head
- **Bill** – massive; black above, horn below
- **Shoulder** – small sky-blue spotted patch
- **Underparts** – off-white, faintly barred
- **Tail** – rufous, barred dark, white-tipped

Male whitish head and underparts with dark brown eye-stripe; brown back; blue-flecked wing coverts, blue wash on rump; rufous tail barred black. Female alike, slightly larger, with little or no blue on the rump. Immature duller and mottled, with dark scalloping and shorter bill.

BEHAVIOUR

Perch-and-pounce hunter – drops onto insects, reptiles and small vertebrates, bashing large prey on a branch. Flight direct and heavy on shallow wingbeats. Sedentary, in territorial family groups with helpers from previous broods; famous dawn and dusk chorus. Common and conspicuous throughout eastern QLD.



Eastern Queensland

Open forest · Woodland · Farmland · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Throughout eastern Queensland from Cape York to the NSW border, well inland along wooded watercourses; absent from the treeless arid west. Smaller subspecies minor on Cape York. Common in Brisbane.

BREEDING

Aug–Jan, peak Sep–Dec. Clutch usually 3 (2–4). Unlined chamber in a tree hollow or excavated arboreal termitarium; the group shares incubation and feeding.

Two: nominate over most of the range; minor of Cape York smaller. Despite the epithet, absent from New Guinea.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. XIII

Rainbow Lorikeet

Trichoglossus moluccanus

PSITTACULIDAE · LORIKEETS

25–30 cm; ~130 g



NO. XIII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D — **Mainly Jun–Jan; any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – violet-blue with fine pale shaft streaks
- **Collar** – greenish-yellow nape band
- **Breast** – orange-red, unbarred
- **Belly** – deep blue-violet
- **Bill** – bright orange-red (dark in juveniles)

Sexes alike: violet-blue head and belly, orange-red breast, yellow-green nuchal collar, green upperparts; scarlet bill, red eye. Immature duller with brown-black bill, brown eye and shorter tail.

BEHAVIOUR

Swift, direct, screeching flight on whirring wings. Clambers acrobatically through blossom; the brush tongue takes nectar and pollen, plus fruit, seeds and insects. Noisy pairs and flocks; large communal dusk roosts. Abundant, tracking flowering; thrives in QLD towns and gardens.



Eastern seaboard

Open forest | Woodland | Heath | Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Eastern seaboard from Cape York to the NSW border, on and near the coast and adjacent ranges; abundant in coastal SEQ cities. Australia's most commonly recorded bird.

BREEDING

Mainly Jun–Jan in QLD; can breed most months in the north. Clutch usually 2 (1–3). Eggs on decayed wood-dust in a high eucalypt hollow; female alone incubates.

Split from the Coconut Lorikeet (T. haematodus) complex; nominate moluccanus in E Australia, smaller septentrionalis on Cape York.



ADULT ♂, GREY MORPH NO. XIV

Tawny Frogmouth

Podargus strigoides

PODARGIDAE · FROGMOUTHS

34–53 cm

NO. XIV

BREEDING J F M A M J J **A S O N D** Aug-Dec

DESCRIPTION

- **Camouflage** – silvery-grey, mottled and streaked black
- **Bill** – wide, hooked 'frog mouth' with bristle tufts
- **Eye** – large, yellow, side-facing – no facial disc
- **Posture** – bolt-upright broken-branch pose by day
- **Underparts** – pale grey, finely dark-streaked

Male silver-grey, finely streaked and mottled black and rufous; massive flattened olive-grey bill, yellow eye. Female often browner or rufous-washed with finer markings; a chestnut-red morph is mostly female. Immature paler and fluffier with diffuse markings.

BEHAVIOUR

Nocturnal; pounces from a low perch onto insects, worms and small vertebrates, some prey hawked in flight. Flight silent, mothlike. By day freezes upright in the cryptic broken-stick pose; pairs sedentary, roosting together. Common but overlooked throughout QLD; soft resonant "oom-oom" at night.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Open forest · Woodland · Heath · Parks & gardens

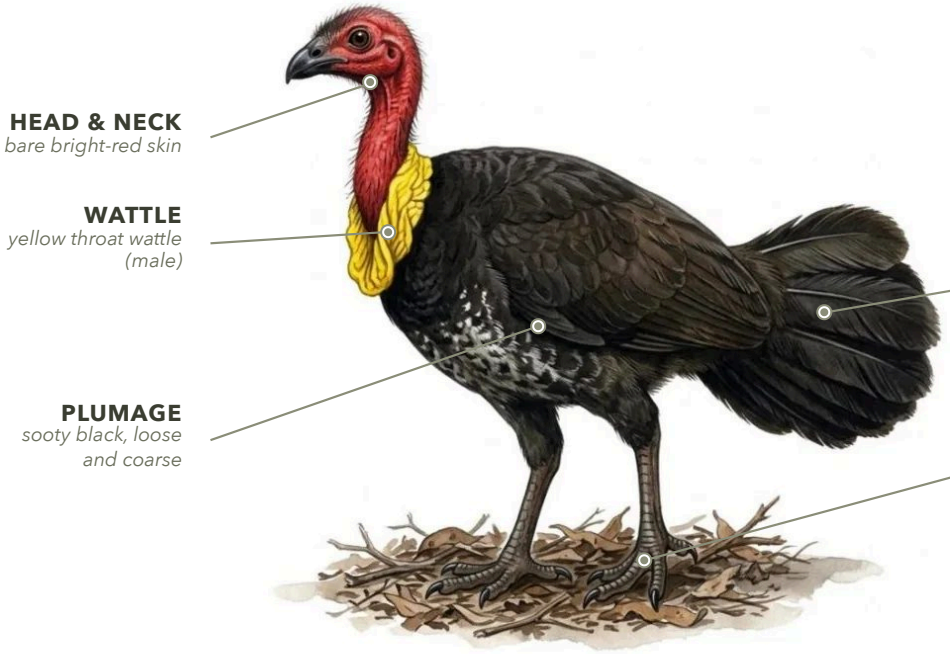
DISTRIBUTION

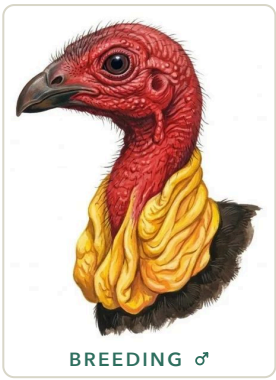
Virtually statewide wherever there are trees – coast, ranges and inland woodland; the smaller, paler subspecies phalaenoides across the Gulf and north. Absent only from treeless desert; avoids dense rainforest interior.

BREEDING

Aug–Dec, opportunistic after rain inland. Clutch 2–3, often 2. Flimsy stick platform on a horizontal fork; male incubates by day, pair shares at night.

Three Australian races: nominate (E Australia incl. S QLD), smaller paler phalaenoides (tropical north), brachypterus (west).





ADULT ♂ NO. XV

Australian Brush-turkey

Alectura lathami

MEGAPODIIDAE · MOUND-BUILDERS

60–75 cm; ~2.3 kg



NO. XV

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D — Mainly Sep–Dec

DESCRIPTION

- **Head & neck** – bare bright-red skin, sparse bristles
- **Wattle** – pendulous yellow throat wattle (male)
- **Plumage** – sooty black, loose and coarse
- **Tail** – large fan, flattened vertically – unique
- **Feet** – powerful; rakes litter backwards

Male large, black-plumaged; bare red head, pendulous yellow wattle enlarging and brightening when breeding; laterally flattened fan tail; white-flecked underparts. Female smaller with a paler, reduced collar. Immature brown and mottled with feathered head and neck; no wattle.

BEHAVIOUR

Rakes leaf-litter powerfully for invertebrates, seeds and fallen fruit; a bold raider of gardens and compost. Flight clumsy and brief; flutters up to roost in trees. Usually solitary or in loose groups; mound-owning males territorial. Common in SE and NE QLD rainforest, scrub and suburbs.



Eastern seaboard

Rainforest · Wet forest · Vine scrub · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Eastern QLD from the tip of Cape York through the Wet Tropics and coastal ranges to SEQ. Purple-wattled subspecies purpureicollis on northern Cape York; yellow-wattled nominate elsewhere. Abundant in suburban Brisbane.

BREEDING

Eggs Aug–Mar, peak Sep–Dec. Each female lays ~18–24 eggs singly, several females per mound (up to 50 eggs); male-tended mound of raked litter and soil held at 33–35 °C. Chicks independent at hatching.

Two: nominate lathami (yellow wattle); purpureicollis of N Cape York smaller, with purple-white wattle.



ADULT ♂ (♀ PALE BELOW) NO. XVI

Australasian Darter

Anhinga novaehollandiae

ANHINGIDAE · DARTERS

85–97 cm; wingspan ~120 cm

NO. XVI

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D — **Mainly Aug–Oct, Jan–Apr; any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Neck** – long, snake-like, with S-kink and white cheek stripe
- **Bill** – straight, finely pointed dagger – never hooked
- **Body** – glossy brown-black, chestnut breast wash (male)
- **Wing** – bold silvery-white streaking on coverts
- **Tail** – long, broad, stiff fan – far longer than a cormorant's

Male glossy black with chestnut foreneck, white cheek-stripe and silver-white wing streaking. Female grey-brown above, white to pale grey below, with the white neck-stripe. Immature like a dull female, stripe indistinct. Facial skin brightens when breeding.

BEHAVIOUR

Swims body-submerged, only the snaking neck visible; dives and spears fish, surfacing to flick and swallow them head-first. Soars high on thermals in a cross-shaped silhouette; perches with wings spread to dry. Usually solitary or pairs; common on still inland and coastal waters.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Wetlands · Rivers & creeks · Coast & mudflats

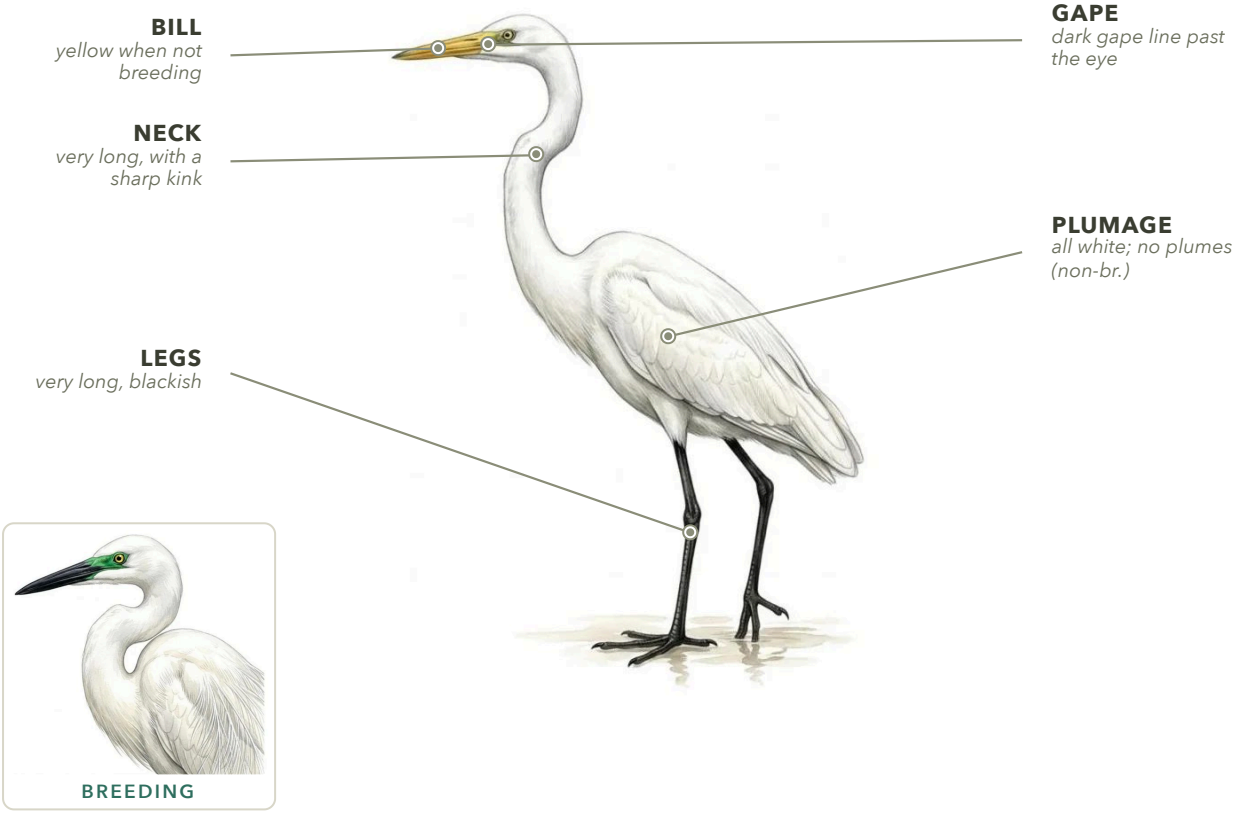
DISTRIBUTION

Throughout Queensland wherever there is smooth open water at least ~0.5 m deep – rivers, lakes, dams, lagoons and sheltered estuaries, coast to far inland; absent only from waterless arid country.

BREEDING

Any month, tied to water levels – chiefly Aug–Oct in SE QLD, Jan–Apr in the north. Clutch 3–5, usually 4. Large stick platform in a fork over water, often among cormorant colonies.

Formerly a race of the Oriental Darter; now a full species, Australian birds A. n. novaehollandiae.



ADULT NON-BREEDING – SEXES ALIKE NO. XVII

Great Egret

Ardea alba modesta

ARDEIDAE · HERONS & EGRETS

83–103 cm; wingspan to 1.7 m



NO. XVII

BREEDING J F **M A M** J J A S **O N D** Mar–May, Oct–Dec

DESCRIPTION

- **Gape** – dark gape line extends clearly behind the eye
- **Neck** – extremely long (~1.5× body), carried with a sharp kink
- **Breeding** – bill black, facial skin emerald-green, back aigrettes
- **Non-breeding** – bill and facial skin yellow, no plumes
- **Legs** – very long, blackish; upper legs flush reddish when breeding

Sexes alike: all white, the largest egret, with a neck longer than the body. Breeding birds grow filamentous plumes over the back only – no head plumes. Juvenile as non-breeding.

BEHAVIOUR

Stalks slowly or stands motionless in shallows, neck kinked, spearing fish with a rapid lunge. Flight ponderous, neck folded, legs trailing. Usually feeds alone but roosts and nests colonially; common and widespread on wetlands statewide.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Wetlands · Rivers & creeks · Farmland · Coast & mudflats

DISTRIBUTION

Across virtually all of Queensland, from coastal estuaries and mudflats to inland floodplains; the flooded Channel Country supports some of Australia's largest breeding colonies.

BREEDING

Mainly Oct–Dec in the south, Mar–May in the north; dependent on water levels. Clutch 2–6, usually 3–4. Flat stick platform in a tree over water; colonial with ibis, cormorants and other egrets.

Eastern Great Egret A. a. modesta (Asia–Australasia); treated by some authorities as the full species Ardea modesta.



ADULT NON-BREEDING – SEXES ALIKE NO. XVIII

Little Egret

Egretta garzetta nigripes

ARDEIDAE · HERONS & EGRETS

55–65 cm; 350–550 g



NO. XVIII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Oct–Apr

DESCRIPTION

- **Build** – small, slim, dainty all-white egret
- **Bill** – slender and black in all seasons
- **Lores** – yellow to grey-yellow facial skin
- **Legs & feet** – black; toes mostly blackish in Australian birds
- **Breeding** – two long ribbon nape plumes, lacy back plumes

Sexes alike: small, slender, all white; bill fine and black; facial skin yellow; legs and feet black with yellowish soles. Breeding: two long ribbon nape plumes and lacy back and breast plumes; facial skin flushes pink-red at courtship peak. Juvenile lacks plumes.

BEHAVIOUR

The most active egret – dashes, jinks and sprints in the shallows, foot-stirring and raking to flush prey, sometimes shading the water with raised wings. Flight buoyant and quick. Singly or in loose groups; moderately common on coastal and inland wetlands.



Eastern Queensland

Coast & mudflats · Mangroves · Wetlands

DISTRIBUTION

Widespread in coastal and subcoastal Queensland – Gulf of Carpentaria, Cape York and the entire east coast – extending inland along major rivers and floodplain wetlands; scarce in the arid southwest.

BREEDING

Oct–Feb in southern QLD, Mar–Apr in the north; linked to water levels. Clutch 3–5, usually 4. Scanty stick platform in tree or mangrove over water; colonial.

Australasian race nigripes: yellow facial skin and black toes, unlike the yellow-toed Eurasian nominate.





BREEDING

ADULT NON-BREEDING – SEXES ALIKE

NO. XIX

Royal Spoonbill

Platalea regia

THRESKIORNITHIDAE · IBISES & SPOONBILLS

74–81 cm; wingspan ~120 cm



NO. XIX

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D — **Mainly Nov-Feb**

DESCRIPTION

- **Bill** – long, black, spatulate – broad spoon tip
- **Face** – bare black skin; yellow patch above each eye, red forehead spot
- **Plumage** – entirely white body
- **Breeding** – shaggy white nuchal crest to ~20 cm, buff breast wash
- **Flight** – neck fully extended – not tucked like a heron

Sexes alike: white, with black spatulate bill, black facial skin and black legs. Breeding: nuchal crest of long white plumes (to 20 cm, longer in the male), yellow patch above the eye, red forehead spot, creamy breast wash. Female slightly smaller, shorter-billed. Juvenile duller, crestless, dark-tipped flight feathers.

BEHAVIOUR

Wades steadily in the shallows sweeping the submerged bill side to side in wide arcs, detecting prey by touch; feeds day or night. Flight direct, neck extended, with steady wingbeats and glides. Singly to small parties; common on fresh and sheltered marine wetlands.



Eastern Queensland

Wetlands · Coast & mudflats · Mangroves

DISTRIBUTION

Widespread across eastern, northern and central Queensland in coastal and inland wetlands, pushing into Channel Country wetlands after flooding; scarcest in the driest southwest.

BREEDING

Oct–Mar in QLD, eggs mainly Nov–Feb; timing and success tied to water levels. Clutch 2–4, usually 3. Solid stick bowl lined with leaves, in a tree crown over water or tall reeds; mixed colonies.

Monotypic. One of two Australian spoonbills – Yellow-billed has a pale bill and legs and no crest.



ADULT – ♀ LARGER NO. XX

Comb-crested Jacana

Irediparra gallinacea

JACANIDAE · JACANAS

20–27 cm; female much larger than male

NO. XX

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D — **Mainly Nov–Apr**

DESCRIPTION

- **Comb** – fleshy red-pink wattle on the forehead
- **Head & neck** – white face, golden-yellow foreneck, black crown and hindneck
- **Breast band** – broad black band above a clean white belly
- **Upperparts** – plain grey-brown; black flight feathers
- **Feet** – extraordinarily long spider-like toes and claws

Sexes alike in plumage: fleshy red-pink comb; black crown, hindneck and breast-band; golden-yellow wash on the face-sides; white throat and belly; brown back; enormous toes. Female distinctly larger and brighter. Juvenile chestnut-crowned with white breast (no band) and rudimentary comb.

BEHAVIOUR

Trots over lily pads on huge spidery toes, gleaning insects and seeds; constantly flicks the tail and bobs the head. Flight low and fluttering, legs and toes trailing. Singly, pairs or loose groups on tropical lagoons; swims and dives if alarmed.



Northern & eastern coastal wetlands

Wetlands

DISTRIBUTION

Coastal and subcoastal freshwater wetlands from Cape York and the Gulf Country down the entire east coast to the NSW border; greatest numbers in the tropical north, absent from the dry interior.

BREEDING

Sep–May in QLD, mainly the wet season in the north; re-nests as water levels shift. Clutch usually 4, glossy and heavily scrawled. Flimsy damp pad on floating leaves; polyandrous – the male alone incubates, carrying chicks to safety under his wings.

Australian birds I. g. novaehollandiae; the only jacana in Australia.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE; ♂ LARGER NO. XXI

Magpie Goose

Anseranas semipalmata

ANSERANATIDAE · MAGPIE GOOSE

71–92 cm; male larger

NO. XXI

BREEDING J **F** **M** **A** **M** **J** J A S O N D **Feb–Jun**

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – domed knob on the black crown
- **Bill** – hooked, orange-pink; bare pinkish face
- **Neck** – long, slender and all black
- **Body** – white underparts and saddle; black wings
- **Legs** – orange; toes only half-webbed

Sexes alike in pattern: black head, neck, wings and tail; white body and saddle; orange legs; bare pinkish face. Male larger, with a taller crown knob that grows with age. Juvenile has white areas mottled grey-brown and only a small or no knob.

BEHAVIOUR

Grazes grasses and digs for spike-rush bulbs and wild rice in shallow swamps; dry-season flocks of thousands on remaining wetlands. Often in trios of one male and two females. Common in the north; recovering in the south.



Northern & eastern coastal wetlands

Wetlands · Grassland · Farmland · Parks & gardens

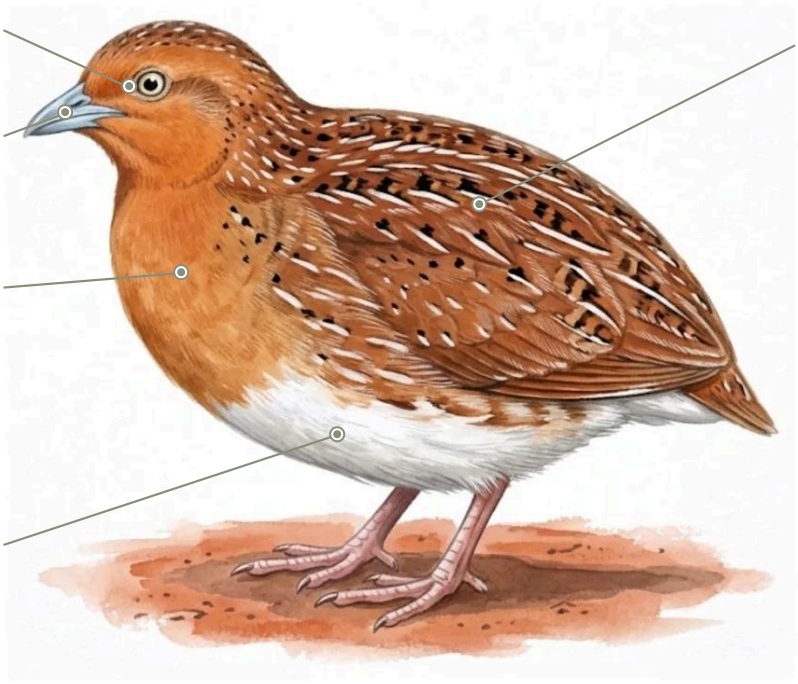
DISTRIBUTION

Coastal floodplains of northern and eastern Queensland – Gulf and Cape York wetlands, the Burdekin delta and Townsville Town Common south to SEQ, where it has recolonised; flocks wander inland after rain.

BREEDING

Wet season, mainly Feb–Jun. Clutch usually ~8 (up to 16 when two females share). Floating platform of trampled sedge in deep swamp; male builds; all adults incubate.

Monotypic; the only species in Anseranas and family Anseranatidae.



ADULT ♀ (♂ SMALLER, DULLER) NO. XXII

Little Button-quail

Turnix velox

TURNICIDAE · BUTTONQUAILS

12–16 cm; ♀ larger

NO. XXII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D — **Mainly Sep–Mar; any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Breast** – ♀ plain rufous-orange; face, throat, breast
- **Eye** – pale whitish-cream iris
- **Bill** – stout, pale blue-grey bill
- **Upperparts** – rufous, streaked white; flecked black
- **Belly** – white belly and flanks, unbarred

Reversed dimorphism. Female larger: unmarked rufous-orange face, throat and breast, rufous upperparts streaked white. Male smaller, paler and duller, breast buff with darker scalloping. Juvenile like male but spotted and scalloped below.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats grass seeds, green shoots and insects, scratching on the ground mainly at night and dusk. Solitary, in pairs or small groups; nomadic and abundant after good seasons. Runs through grass and is seldom seen unless flushed.



Western & central-west inland

Grassland · Spinifex · Arid scrub · Farmland

DISTRIBUTION

Mainly western and central QLD south of about 19°S: Mitchell-grass downs, Channel Country and the Winton–Longreach district; nomadic, occasionally reaching the Darling Downs and eastern plains in dry years.

BREEDING

After rain in any month; mainly Sep–Mar in the south-east. Grass-lined scrape under a tussock, sometimes hooded. Clutch 3–4; male incubates.

Monotypic; endemic to mainland Australia.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE

NO. XXIII

Crested Pigeon

Ocyphaps lophotes

COLUMBIDAE · PIGEONS & DOVES

30–35 cm

NO. XXIII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D — **Mainly Sep–Mar; any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Crest** – tall, thin black crest held erect
- **Eye** – orange eye; pinkish-red ring of bare skin
- **Wing** – buff-grey, boldly barred black; green-purple patch
- **Underparts** – soft grey; neck and breast washed pink
- **Legs** – short, bright pinkish-red legs

Sexes alike; the female is marginally smaller with a slightly duller wing patch. Juvenile duller and browner, with a shorter crest, buff-fringed wing feathers, fainter barring and a dull eye-ring.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats mostly fallen seeds of native grasses, herbs, crops and weeds, with some leaves and insects, foraging on the ground in pairs to flocks of dozens. Drinks daily, often waiting in trees before descending. Abundant and increasing.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Grassland · Woodland · Farmland · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Throughout most of Queensland, from the western deserts to the coast and into Brisbane and other cities; scarce on northern Cape York and absent from closed rainforest. Spread coastward through the 20th century with clearing.

BREEDING

Any month, mainly Sep–Mar. Flimsy twig platform in a shrub or tree fork. Clutch 2 white eggs; incubation and nestling periods ~21 days each.

Nominate lophotes in QLD; the more rufous-toned whitlocki replaces it in Western Australia.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. XXIV

Spinifex Pigeon

Geophaps plumifera leucogaster

COLUMBIDAE · PIGEONS & DOVES

20–24 cm

NO. XXIV

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D **Any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Crest** – tall, pointed rufous crest; held erect
- **Face** – bare red skin around eye; black-and-white stripes
- **Breast band** – white band, bordered black below
- **Upperparts** – cinnamon-rufous, boldly barred black
- **Belly** – white belly (QLD ssp. leucogaster)

Sexes alike. Adult rich cinnamon-rufous, barred black above, with tall rufous crest, bare red facial skin, black-and-white face pattern and white breast band; QLD birds white-bellied. Juvenile duller and plainer-faced with shorter crest.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats seeds of spinifex, grasses and herbs, foraging on the ground in pairs or small flocks. Shelters from midday heat in shade, prefers to run rather than fly, and must drink daily. Locally common within its patchy QLD range.



Western & central-west inland

Spinifex

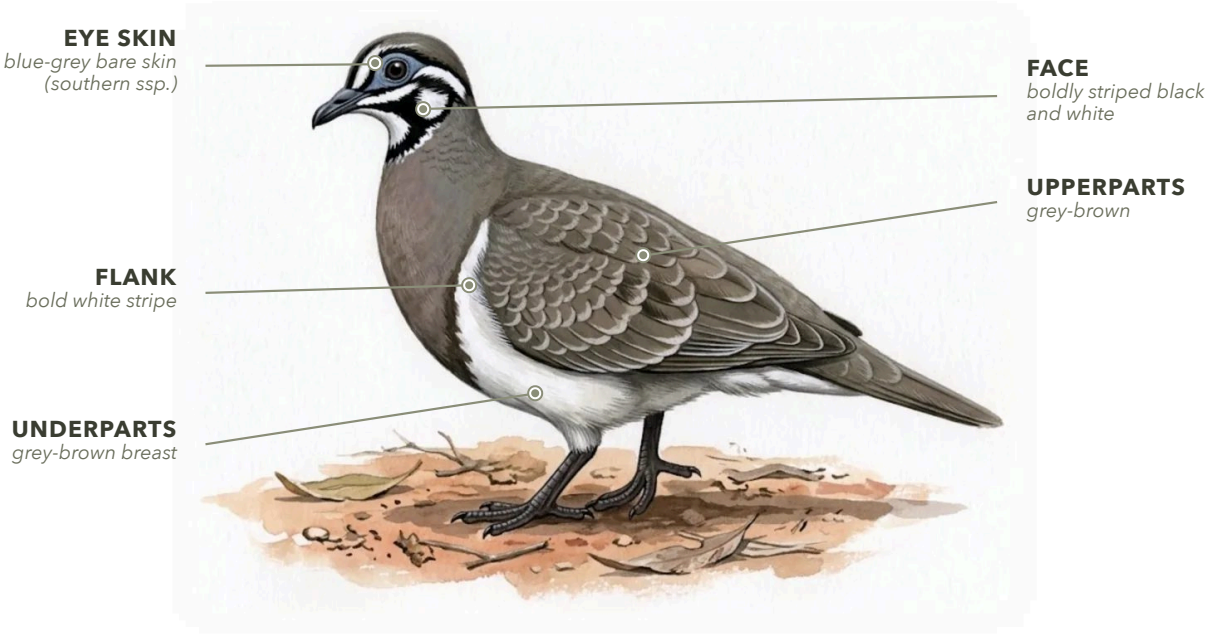
DISTRIBUTION

Patchy in stony spinifex ranges of western QLD: the Mount Isa–Selwyn Ranges and Boodjamulla in the north-west, south-east to the Winton–Opalton jump-ups, Diamantina NP and the Grey Range near Windorah.

BREEDING

Breeds at any time after rain. Nest a shallow, sparsely lined scrape under spinifex or a shrub. Clutch 2 creamy-white eggs; both parents incubate.

QLD birds are white-bellied leucogaster (AFD); some lists treat NW QLD birds as nominate plumifera.



ADULT SOUTHERN SSP. – SEXES ALIKE NO. XXV

Squatter Pigeon

Geophaps scripta

COLUMBIDAE · PIGEONS & DOVES

28–32 cm



NO. XXV

BREEDING J F M **A M J J A S O** N D **Mainly Apr–Oct; any month**

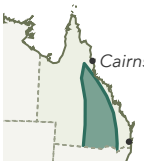
DESCRIPTION

- **Face** – boldly striped black and white
- **Eye skin** – blue-grey bare skin (southern ssp.)
- **Flank** – bold white stripe; side of breast to belly
- **Upperparts** – grey-brown; wing coverts pale-scalloped
- **Underparts** – grey-brown breast; white lower belly

Sexes alike. Adult grey-brown with black-and-white striped face, white flank stripe and white lower belly; eye skin blue-grey in southern scripta, yellow-orange to red in northern peninsulae. Juvenile duller, face pattern weaker, facial skin pale buff-yellow.

BEHAVIOUR

Ground forager on fallen seeds of grasses, herbs and acacias; drinks daily. In pairs or small coveys, larger groups at water. Common in the north; the southern subspecies is patchy and declining, persisting best in the Brigalow Belt.



Inland eastern Queensland

Woodland Grassland

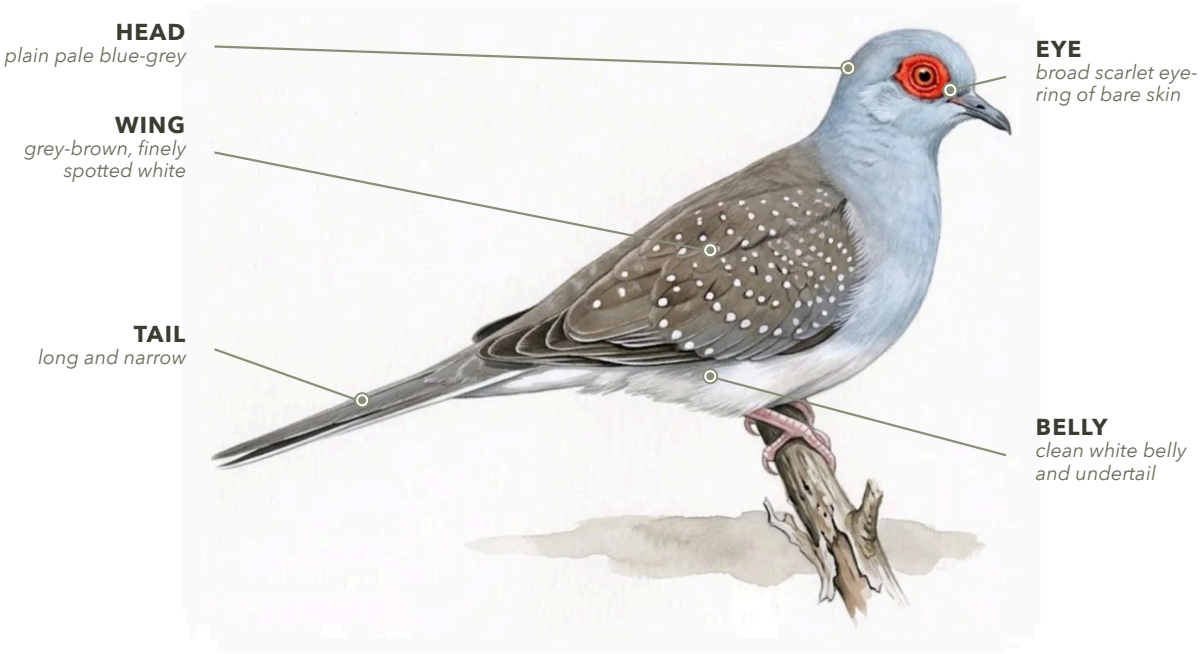
DISTRIBUTION

Inland eastern QLD. Southern ssp. scripta from the Burdekin–Lynd divide south through the Brigalow Belt to the NSW border, west to Hughenden, Longreach and Charleville; northern peninsulae north of it.

BREEDING

Year-round in good years; peak Apr–Oct (dry season). Shallow scrape under grass, shrub or log, sparsely lined. Clutch 2 cream eggs; incubation ~17 days.

Southern scripta (threatened) south of the Burdekin–Lynd divide; northern peninsulae (Least Concern) to the north; broad intergrade zone.



ADULT ♂ (♀ BROWNER) NO. XXVI

Diamond Dove

Geopelia cuneata

COLUMBIDAE · PIGEONS & DOVES

19–24 cm



NO. XXVI

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D **Any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Eye** – broad scarlet eye-ring of bare skin
- **Head** – plain pale blue-grey; neck and breast too
- **Wing** – grey-brown, finely spotted white
- **Tail** – long and narrow; white outer feathers
- **Belly** – clean white belly and undertail

Male: blue-grey head and breast, grey-brown wings finely spotted white, broad scarlet eye-ring. Female browner, with narrower, duller eye-ring. Juvenile brownish, barred and scalloped buff, with few white spots and a dull grey-brown eye-ring.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats tiny seeds of grasses and herbs picked from bare ground, plus some insects. Pairs and small flocks, larger at water. Dispersive, following rain; common in the west, irregular further east. Popular aviary bird, so escapes occur.



Western & central-west inland

Woodland · Arid scrub · Spinifex · Rivers & creeks

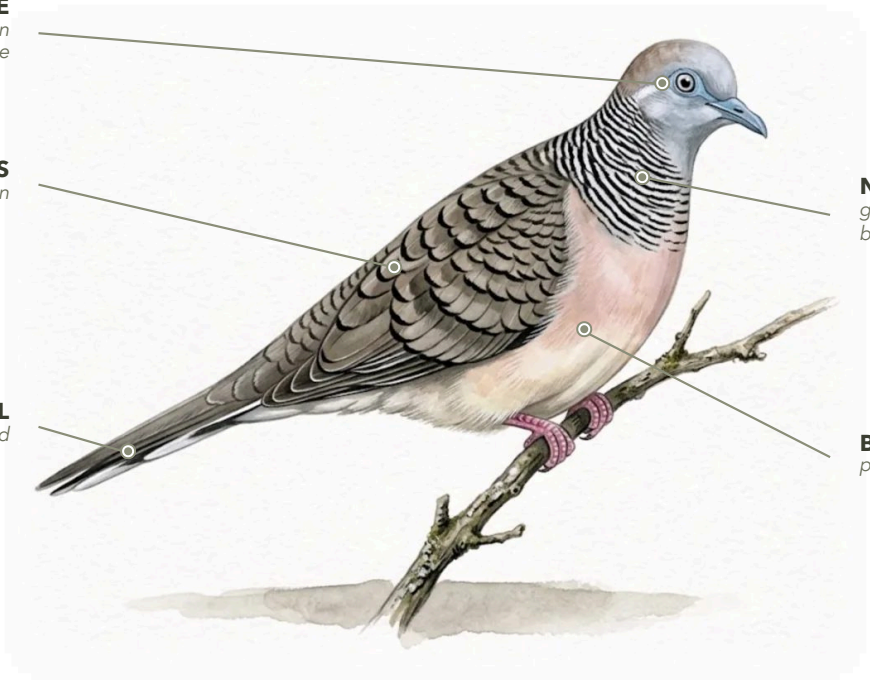
DISTRIBUTION

Western and central QLD: Channel Country, Mitchell-grass downs and north-west uplands, east to the Desert Uplands and Brigalow Belt; nomadic, sometimes reaching the Darling Downs, Gulf and coast after inland rains.

BREEDING

Any time after good rain. Small, flimsy platform of fine twigs or grass in a low shrub or tree. Clutch 2 white eggs; both sexes incubate (~13 days).

Monotypic; endemic to mainland Australia.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. XXVII

Peaceful Dove

Geopelia placida

COLUMBIDAE · PIGEONS & DOVES

19–23 cm

NO. XXVII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D — **Mainly Sep–Feb; any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Eye** – bare blue-grey skin around pale eye
- **Neck** – grey, finely barred black and white
- **Upperparts** – grey-brown; each feather barred black
- **Belly** – plain pinkish-buff; lower breast and belly
- **Tail** – long, graduated; broad white corners

Sexes alike; female marginally duller. Adult grey-brown above with fine black barring, grey face and finely barred neck and breast, pinkish belly, blue-grey eye skin. Juvenile browner with buff-tipped feathers, fainter barring and duller eye skin.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats small seeds of grasses and sedges with some insects, foraging on bare ground along tracks, lawns and paddocks. Usually in pairs or small groups; common and confiding. Sedentary, though small flocks form locally.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Woodland · Rivers & creeks · Farmland · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Throughout QLD in suitable habitat, from Torres Strait and Cape York down the coast and inland along timbered watercourses; common in Cairns, Townsville and Brisbane suburbs, scarcer in the arid far south-west.

BREEDING

Any month, mainly spring–summer. Frail platform of twigs, grass and roots in a tree or shrub, built by both sexes. Clutch 2 white eggs.

placida in most of QLD, papua on Cape York (AFD); split from Zebra Dove.



ADULT NON-BREEDING – SEXES ALIKE NO. XXVIII

Pheasant Coucal

Centropus phasianinus

CUCULIDAE · CUCKOOS & COUCALS

50–70 cm; ♀ larger



NO. XXVIII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Sep–Mar

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – streaky rufous-brown; pale shaft streaks
- **Eye** – deep red iris in adults
- **Bill** – heavy, decurved; pale horn when non-breeding
- **Wing** – short, rounded; rufous barred black and cream
- **Tail** – very long and broad; dark, finely barred buff

Sexes alike in plumage; female much larger. Breeding: black head, neck and underparts, black bill. Non-breeding: head, back and underparts rufous-buff with pale shaft streaks, horn bill. Juvenile like non-breeding but paler, spotted rufous, duller eye.

BEHAVIOUR

Hunts on the ground for large insects, frogs, lizards, eggs and nestlings, sometimes small mammals. Solitary or in pairs, skulking in dense grass. Common in the north and along the coast; benefits from weedy and cane-field cover.



Northern & eastern coastal wetlands

Grassland | Wetlands | Woodland | Farmland

DISTRIBUTION

Northern and eastern QLD: Torres Strait, Cape York and the Gulf plains (inland to the Cloncurry and Flinders rivers), then down the coast and ranges to the NSW border; sparse further inland.

BREEDING

Sep–Mar (wet season). Platform of grass and sticks in dense grass, stems pulled over as a canopy. Clutch 3–5 white eggs; male incubates ~15 days.

Nominate phasianinus in eastern QLD; larger, darker-tailed melanurus from the Burdekin north, on Cape York and the Gulf.



ADULT ♂ (♀ SPOTTED BROWN) NO. XXIX

Pacific Koel

Eudynamys orientalis

CUCULIDAE · CUCKOOS & COUCALS

39–46 cm



NO. XXIX

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Sep–Mar

DESCRIPTION

- **Plumage** – ♂ entirely glossy blue-black
- **Eye** – striking crimson-red iris
- **Bill** – stout, pale ivory to greenish-horn
- **Tail** – long, broad and round-tipped
- **Legs** – dark blue-grey legs and feet

Male glossy blue-black with red eye and pale bill. Female glossy brown above, densely spotted white, with black crown and moustache and a buff stripe between; underparts buff, finely barred black. Juvenile rufous-buff, spotted and barred, eye dark.

BEHAVIOUR

Feeds in the canopy on fruit, especially native and introduced figs, with some insects. Solitary and shy, but very vocal by day and night when breeding. Common in coastal QLD and increasing in towns.



Eastern Queensland

Rainforest · Rivers & creeks · Mangroves · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Breeding migrant (Sep–Apr) to northern and eastern QLD: Torres Strait, Cape York and the Gulf down the coast to SEQ, and inland along watercourses and towns; very common in coastal cities. A few overwinter in the north.

BREEDING

Sep–Mar. Brood parasite: one egg in each host nest (friarbirds, figbirds, Magpie-lark, wattlebirds). Chick evicts host young and is fed for weeks.

cyanocephalus in central-east and SE QLD; subcyanocephalus in the north. WildNet name: Eastern Koel.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. XXX

White-throated Nightjar

Eurostopodus mystacalis

CAPRIMULGIDAE · NIGHTJARS

30–35 cm; largest Australian nightjar



NO. XXX

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S **O N D** Mainly Oct–Dec

DESCRIPTION

- **Throat** – white throat patches; one each side
- **Plumage** – blackish; vermiculated silver-grey, buff, rufous
- **Eye** – large dark eye; red eyeshine in torchlight
- **Wings** – no white spots; wingtips reach tail tip
- **Tail** – long, dark-barred; no white corners

Sexes alike: blackish-grey, finely vermiculated silver-grey, buff and rufous; scalloped wing coverts; white throat patches; no white in wing or tail. Female averages slightly smaller. Juvenile paler and more rufous, with finer pattern and smaller throat patches.

BEHAVIOUR

Hawks moths, beetles and other flying insects at dusk and night over the canopy, clearings and watercourses. Solitary or in pairs; loose groups of up to ~20 on migration. Common but easily overlooked; very faithful to its day-roost sites.



Eastern Queensland

Open forest · Woodland · Heath

DISTRIBUTION

Eastern Queensland from Cape York to the NSW border, mainly on the coast and ranges but reaching several hundred km inland. Many Qld birds are resident; southern breeders winter in north Qld and New Guinea.

BREEDING

Mainly Oct–Dec (Sep–Jan). Single cream egg, spotted dark purple-brown, laid on bare ground or litter, often beside a log or rock; no nest. Both parents incubate ~23–28 days.

Nominate mystacalis in Australia; island forms on the Solomons and New Caledonia are sometimes split as separate species.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. XXXI

Spotted Nightjar

Eurostopodus argus

CAPRIMULGIDAE · NIGHTJARS

25–31 cm



NO. XXXI

BREEDING J F M A M J J A **S O N D** Sep-Dec

DESCRIPTION

- **Throat** – large white throat patch; paired ovals
- **Crown** – grey; black streaks down the centre
- **Collar** – rufous-buff hind-neck collar
- **Coverts** – big buff spots on dark coverts
- **Wingtips** – fall well short of the tail tip

Sexes similar: grey above, streaked tawny and black; coverts boldly spotted buff; rufous collar; white throat patches; white patch on four outer primaries. Female slightly paler, more tawny, with smaller wing patch. Juvenile redder and finer-patterned; wing patch small, ochre-edged.

BEHAVIOUR

Hawks moths, beetles, grasshoppers and other flying insects within ~30 m of the ground; also hunts around lights and campfires. Usually single. Northern birds sedentary or nomadic; southern birds winter in the north. Fairly common; declining in the south.



Western & central-west inland

Arid scrub · Spinifex · Woodland

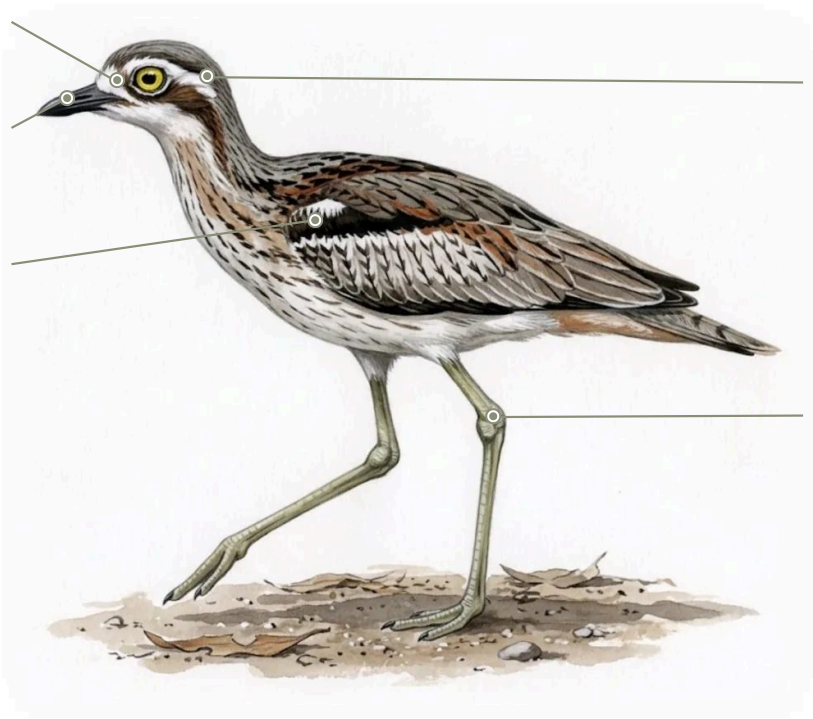
DISTRIBUTION

Western and central Queensland – Channel Country, Mitchell Grass Downs, the Gulf country and north-west uplands – east to the Brigalow Belt and Einasleigh Uplands. Largely absent east of the Divide in the south-east.

BREEDING

Mainly Sep–Dec, earlier in the north; tied to rain in the arid zone. Single pale yellow-green egg blotched purple-brown, on bare ground or litter; no nest. Both sexes incubate ~30 days.

Monotypic. Listed as Eurostopodus guttatus in many older Australian field guides.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. XXXII

Bush Stone-curlew

Burhinus grallarius

BURHINIDAE · STONE-CURLEWS

52–58 cm



NO. XXXII

BREEDING J F M A M J **J A S O N D** Jul–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Eye** – huge yellow eye; staring expression
- **Face** – white brow above a dark eye-stripe
- **Bill** – short, stout and black
- **Wing** – black shoulder bar; white panel below
- **Legs** – long, pale olive-grey; thick 'knees'

Sexes alike: grey-brown above, streaked black and rufous; black shoulder bar over a white wing panel; whitish below with bold dark streaks; white brow; huge yellow eye. Juvenile paler and browner, fluffier, with softer streaking and a less distinct shoulder pattern.

BEHAVIOUR

Forages at night on insects, spiders, molluscs, frogs, small lizards and seeds, all taken from the ground. Roosts by day in pairs or small groups; loose flocks after breeding. Sedentary territorial pairs. Common in N Qld towns, sparse in farmland.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Woodland · Mangroves · Parks & gardens

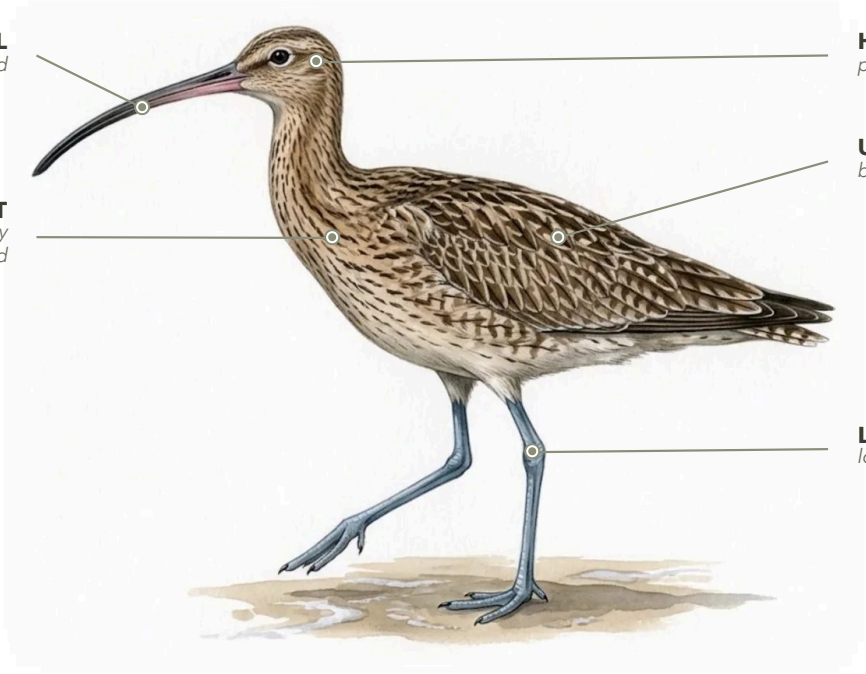
DISTRIBUTION

Widespread across Queensland from Cape York and the Gulf to the south-east in open woodland; scarce in the arid far south-west. Strong urban populations in Cairns, Townsville and Brisbane; declining in cleared farmland.

BREEDING

Jul–Jan. Clutch usually 2 (1–3), blotched buff eggs in a bare scrape on the ground, often beside a log or tree base. Both parents incubate ~4 weeks.

Monotypic. Also called Bush Thick-knee; listed as Burhinus magnirostris in older books.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE; ♀ LONGER BILL NO. XXXIII

Eastern Curlew

Numenius madagascariensis

SCOLOPACIDAE · SANDPIPERS & ALLIES

60–66 cm; ♀ bill c. 18–19 cm



NO. XXXIII

BREEDING J F M A **M** **J** **J** A S O N D **Breeds in north-east Asia (May–Jul)**

DESCRIPTION

- **Bill** – huge, down-curved; pinkish base
- **Head** – plain, streaky; no crown stripes
- **Upperparts** – brown; heavily streaked, notched buff
- **Breast** – buff-brown, densely streaked
- **Legs** – long, blue-grey; tibia partly bare

Sexes alike in plumage: brown, heavily streaked and mottled, with brown rump and barred underwing. Female larger, with a markedly longer bill (average ~185 mm). Juvenile has a shorter bill and neater, buff-fringed upperparts. Breeding adults only slightly more rufous.

BEHAVIOUR

Probes mud and sand for crabs, ghost shrimps and molluscs, feeding by day and night. Singles or loose groups; roosts in flocks at high tide. Very wary of people and dogs. Uncommon and declining; occurs only in the East Asian–Australasian Flyway.



Coastal fringe

Coast & mudflats · Mangroves

DISTRIBUTION

Coastal Queensland from Torres Strait and the Gulf to the NSW border, mainly Aug–Mar. Key sites include Moreton Bay, Great Sandy Strait, Port Curtis and the Cairns Esplanade; some young birds stay through winter.

BREEDING

Breeds May–Jul on boggy marshes in eastern Russia and NE China. Clutch usually 4 in a grass-lined scrape. Does not breed in Australia; arrives Aug–Sep, leaves Feb–Mar.

Monotypic. Named Far Eastern Curlew by the IOC and BirdLife Australia.



ADULT ♀ (♂ HAS DARK EYE) NO. XXXIV

Black-necked Stork

Ephippiorhynchus asiaticus

CICONIIDAE · STORKS

129–137 cm; wingspan c. 2 m; ~4 kg

NO. XXXIV

BREEDING J F **M A M** J J A S O N D — **Mainly Mar–May**

DESCRIPTION

- **Neck** – glossy black; green and purple sheen
- **Bill** – massive, straight black dagger
- **Eye** – yellow iris (♀); dark brown in ♂
- **Wing** – broad black band across white wing
- **Legs** – very long, coral-red

Male: head and neck black glossed green and purple; white body; black wing band and tail; black bill; coral-red legs; dark brown eye. Female identical but with a yellow eye. Juvenile dull brown with a greyish-white belly and dusky legs; adult plumage gained over several years.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats fish, eels, crustaceans, frogs, reptiles and insects, stalking in water 5–30 cm deep and lunging or leaping at prey. Single birds, pairs or family groups; sedentary or partly nomadic. Fairly common in the north, scarce in the south-east.



Northern & eastern coastal wetlands

Wetlands · Coast & mudflats · Mangroves · Farmland

DISTRIBUTION

Coastal and subcoastal wetlands of northern and eastern Queensland – Gulf plains, Cape York, the Burdekin and Fitzroy floodplains south to SEQ; sparser inland along rivers and waterholes to the north-west.

BREEDING

In Qld mostly Mar–Aug, laying chiefly Mar–May. Clutch 2–4 white eggs. Huge stick platform high in a tall tree near water, often reused; both parents incubate and feed the young.

Ssp. australis in Australia and New Guinea; nominate asiaticus in South and South-east Asia.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE; ♀ LARGER NO. XXXV

Pacific Baza

Aviceda subcristata

ACCIPITRIDAE · HAWKS, KITES & EAGLES

35–46 cm; wingspan 80–105 cm



NO. XXXV

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D — Mainly Oct–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Crest** – short, pointed crest on the nape
- **Eye** – golden-yellow, prominent, 'pop-eyed'
- **Head** – grey head, neck and upper breast
- **Underparts** – white, boldly barred rufous-brown
- **Vent** – rufous-buff thighs and undertail

Adult grey head, neck, upper breast and back; white underparts with bold rufous-brown bars; rufous thighs and vent; nape crest; golden-yellow eye. Sexes similar; female heavier with browner crown. Juvenile browner, with fainter barring and brownish eye.

BEHAVIOUR

Takes large insects – especially stick insects and mantids – plus frogs, small lizards and occasionally fruit, snatched from foliage. Often in pairs or family parties; noisy when soaring, quiet in canopy. Fairly common in eastern and northern QLD.



Eastern seaboard

Rainforest · Rivers & creeks · Open forest · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Coastal and subcoastal eastern Queensland from Torres Strait and Cape York to the NSW border, west to the Gulf coast and inland along wooded rivers. Common in the tropics and increasingly in suburban SEQ.

BREEDING

Sep–Feb, mainly Oct–Jan. Clutch 2–3. Flimsy flat stick nest high among leafy outer branches; the sitting bird's long tail juts over the rim.

Australian birds are nominate subcristata; NW Australian njikena is sometimes recognised. Also called Crested Hawk.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE; ♀ LARGER NO. XXXVI

Black-shouldered Kite

Elanus axillaris

ACCIPITRIDAE · HAWKS, KITES & EAGLES

35–38 cm; wingspan 80–100 cm

NO. XXXVI

BREEDING J F M A M J **J A S O N D** **Mainly Jul–Dec; any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Shoulder** – black patch on the folded wing
- **Eye** – red, set in a black 'comma'
- **Head** – white face, head and underparts
- **Upperparts** – pale ash-grey back and wings
- **Legs** – short, bright yellow; yellow cere

Adult white head and underparts, pale grey back and wings, black shoulder patch, red eye with black comma; yellow cere and legs. Sexes alike; female larger. Juvenile with rufous-brown wash on head and breast, brown-scalloped back, and browner eye.

BEHAVIOUR

Hunts mainly house mice and other small rodents, plus grasshoppers, by hovering and dropping feet-first; most active early and late in the day. Single, in pairs or small loose groups; nomadic. Common across QLD farmland.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Grassland · Farmland · Wetlands · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Throughout Queensland in open country – farmland, coastal grasslands and inland plains from Cape York to the NSW border; most numerous on cleared farmland. Nomadic, irrupting where mice plague.

BREEDING

Mainly Jul–Dec, but any month when mice are plentiful. Clutch 3–4 (2–5). Untidy shallow stick cup high in a tree, or on a pole or bridge.

Monotypic; formerly lumped with the Old World Black-winged Kite E. caeruleus.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE; ♀ LARGER NO. XXXVII

Black Kite

Milvus migrans

ACCIPITRIDAE · HAWKS, KITES & EAGLES

47–55 cm; wingspan 1.2–1.5 m

NO. XXXVII

BREEDING J F M A M **J J A S O N D** Jun–Dec

DESCRIPTION

- **Plumage** – dark brown; looks black at a distance
- **Head** – paler, buff-streaked head; dark eye
- **Bill** – black bill; yellow cere and gape
- **Shoulder** – pale buff bar across the inner wing
- **Tail** – long, shallow-forked; notch shows at rest

Adult dark brown with rufous and buff streaking on head, neck and underparts; pale bar across upperwing coverts; black bill, yellow cere and legs. Sexes alike; female slightly larger. Juvenile paler and more heavily buff-streaked, with buff tips to coverts and a shallower tail fork.

BEHAVIOUR

Opportunist scavenger and hunter of insects (especially grasshoppers), lizards, small mammals and birds; hawks flushed prey at fires and snatches scraps from tips and roads. Highly gregarious, in flocks of hundreds or thousands. Abundant in northern and inland QLD.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Grassland · Woodland · Rivers & creeks · Parks & gardens

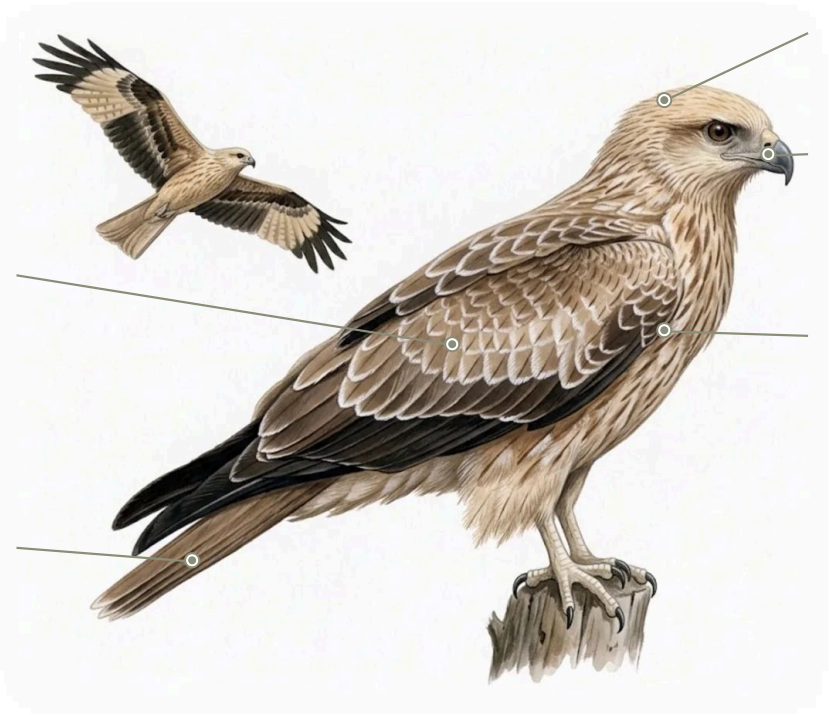
DISTRIBUTION

Throughout most of Queensland; abundant across the north, Gulf and the inland, gathering at towns, tips, stockyards and fires. Scarcer on the south-east coast, though now regular around SEQ and expanding.

BREEDING

Mainly Jun–Dec (dry season in the north). Clutch usually 2–3. Bulky stick cup lined with wool, fur or rubbish, in a tree fork; often loose colonies.

Australian birds are M. m. affinis (also New Guinea and Sulawesi).



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE; ♀ LARGER NO. XXXVIII

Whistling Kite

Haliastur sphenurus

ACCIPITRIDAE · HAWKS, KITES & EAGLES

50–60 cm; wingspan 1.2–1.45 m



NO. XXXVIII

BREEDING J F M A M J **J A S O N D** Jul–Dec

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – pale sandy, finely streaked; scruffy look
- **Bill** – small, dark grey; brown eye
- **Wings** – sandy-brown coverts; dark flight feathers
- **Underparts** – pale sandy-buff, finely streaked
- **Tail** – long, rounded, plain pale brown

Adult sandy-brown with pale, finely streaked head and underparts; dark brown flight feathers; cream legs, brown eye. Sexes alike; female larger. Juvenile more rufous and boldly streaked, with pale-spotted coverts and spotted upperparts.

BEHAVIOUR

Opportunist: carrion (roadkill, dead fish), plus live rabbits, rodents, birds, fish, reptiles and insects; robs other birds of prey. Usually alone, in pairs or small groups; congregates at abundant food. Common and widespread across QLD.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Woodland · Farmland · Wetlands · Rivers & creeks

DISTRIBUTION

Common throughout Queensland in suitable habitat – coastal wetlands and estuaries from Cape York to the NSW border, Gulf floodplains and inland rivers, bores and swamps of the arid west. Partly nomadic in the south.

BREEDING

Mainly Jul–Dec, often earlier in the tropics. Clutch usually 2 (1–3). Bulky stick platform lined with green leaves, high in a tall tree near water; reused for years.

Monotypic; also New Guinea and New Caledonia.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE; ♀ LARGER NO. XXXIX

Brahminy Kite

Haliastur indus

ACCIPITRIDAE · HAWKS, KITES & EAGLES

45–51 cm; wingspan 1.1–1.25 m



NO. XXXIX

BREEDING J F M **A M J J A S O** N D Apr–Oct

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – white head and breast; unstreaked
- **Body** – rich chestnut body and wings
- **Wingtips** – black primary tips at the wingtip
- **Bill** – pale horn-yellow, strongly hooked
- **Tail** – short, rounded, chestnut; pale tip

Adult white head, neck and breast; chestnut body, wings and tail; black primary tips; pale horn bill, dark eye, yellow legs. Sexes alike; female larger. Juvenile dull brown with pale streaking on head and breast; adult plumage gained over 2–3 years.

BEHAVIOUR

Scavenges dead fish, crabs, offal and refuse; also takes live fish, frogs, insects and small reptiles from the water or ground surface. Pirates food from gulls, terns, Osprey and other kites. Single or in pairs; common in coastal north QLD.



Coastal fringe

Mangroves · Coast & mudflats · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

The whole Queensland coastline from Torres Strait and Cape York south to the NSW border, including the Gulf of Carpentaria coast and offshore islands. Common in the tropics, fewer around SEQ; rarely far inland.

BREEDING

Mainly Apr–Oct. Clutch 1–2. Stick nest lined with seaweed, leaves or rubbish, in a mangrove or tall tree near water; both parents incubate.

Australian birds are H. i. girrenera – head and breast white, without the dark streaks of Asian races.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE; ♀ LARGER NO. XL

White-bellied Sea-Eagle

Icthyophaga leucogaster

ACCIPITRIDAE · HAWKS, KITES & EAGLES

75–85 cm; wingspan 1.8–2.2 m



NO. XL

BREEDING J F M A **M** **J** **J** **A** **S** **O** N D **May–Oct**

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – white head, neck and underparts
- **Wings** – slate-grey back and folded wings
- **Bill** – large, grey with a darker tip
- **Legs** – bare, cream-white; black talons
- **Tail** – short wedge; grey base, white tip

Adult white head, neck, underparts and tail tip; slate-grey back and wings; black flight feathers; grey bill, dark brown eye, cream legs. Sexes alike; female larger. Juvenile brown with buff head and pale tail; adult plumage gained patchily by the fourth year.

BEHAVIOUR

Hunts fish, sea snakes, turtles, waterbirds and mammals up to swan size, snatched from the surface; also carrion and stolen prey. Permanent pairs hold territories year-round; feeds alone, in pairs or family groups. Common along the QLD coast.



Coastal fringe

Coast & mudflats · Mangroves · Rivers & creeks · Wetlands

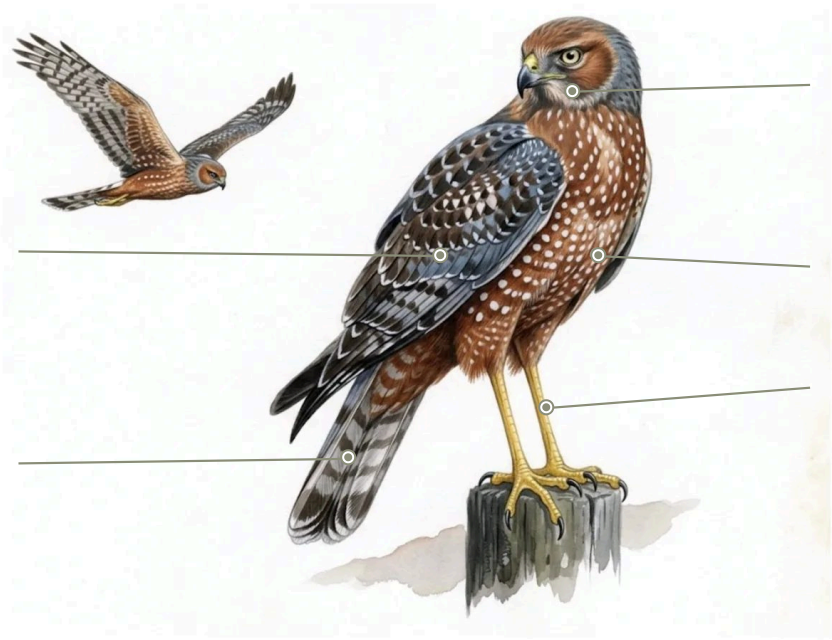
DISTRIBUTION

The entire Queensland coastline, islands and Torres Strait, including the Gulf of Carpentaria; also inland along major rivers, lakes and large dams such as Wivenhoe. Pairs resident year-round.

BREEDING

Mainly May–Oct. Clutch usually 2; often one young raised. Huge stick nest high in a tall tree (to 30 m), or on rocks or the ground on islands; reused for years.

Monotypic. Formerly Haliaeetus leucogaster; IOC now places sea-eagles in Icthyophaga.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE; ♀ LARGER NO. XLI

Spotted Harrier

Circus assimilis

ACCIPITRIDAE · HAWKS, KITES & EAGLES

50–61 cm; wingspan 1.2–1.47 m



NO. XLI

BREEDING J F M A M J J **A S O N D** Aug–Dec

DESCRIPTION

- **Facial disc** – chestnut owl-like disc; yellow eye
- **Underparts** – chestnut, densely white-spotted
- **Wings** – blue-grey, spotted and barred darker
- **Tail** – long, wedge-tipped; boldly dark-barred
- **Legs** – very long, slender, bright yellow

Adult blue-grey above, mottled darker and spotted white; chestnut facial disc and underparts spotted white; long barred tail; yellow eye and long yellow legs. Sexes similar; female larger. Juvenile brown above, buff below with streaks, dark eye, rufous facial disc.

BEHAVIOUR

Hunts by low, slow quartering with sudden drops onto ground birds (quail, button-quail, pipits, songlarks), rodents, rabbits and reptiles. Usually alone or in pairs; nomadic, following prey. Sparse but widespread across inland QLD grasslands.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Grassland · Woodland · Farmland · Arid scrub

DISTRIBUTION

Widespread but sparse over inland Queensland – Mitchell-grass downs, Channel Country, Gulf plains and Brigalow Belt – east to the Darling Downs and Burnett; scarce on the wetter east coast. Nomadic.

BREEDING

Mainly Aug–Dec, or after rain. Clutch usually 3 (2–4). Shallow stick platform lined with green leaves, in the outer foliage of a tree 2–15 m up.

Monotypic; no geographic variation recognised across its range.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE; ♀ LARGER NO. XLII

Wedge-tailed Eagle

Aquila audax

ACCIPITRIDAE · HAWKS, KITES & EAGLES

89–106 cm; wingspan 1.8–2.3 m



NO. XLII

BREEDING J F M **A** **M** **J** **J** **A** **S** O N D Apr–Sep

DESCRIPTION

- **Plumage** – blackish-brown overall
- **Nape** – tawny-bronze hackles on the nape
- **Bill** – massive; pale cream-pink base
- **Legs** – feathered to the toes; cream feet
- **Tail** – long, wedge-shaped (diamond-tipped)

Adult blackish-brown with tawny-bronze nape and paler wing-covert bar; legs feathered to the toes; pale cream bill, brown eye. Female larger and often slightly paler. Juvenile and immature golden-brown with rufous nape, darkening over 10+ years.

BEHAVIOUR

Takes rabbits, hares, wallabies, foxes, large birds and reptiles, and readily scavenges carrion and roadkill, where up to 20 may gather. Hunts alone, in pairs or cooperatively. Territorial pairs sedentary; fairly common throughout QLD.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Woodland · Grassland · Arid scrub · Farmland

DISTRIBUTION

Throughout Queensland from Cape York and the Gulf to the NSW border and the far south-west deserts; commonest in open inland country, scarce in rainforest and densely settled coastal areas.

BREEDING

Mainly Apr–Sep in QLD. Clutch usually 2 (1–3); often only one chick fledges. Huge stick platform lined with leaves in the tallest tree; reused for years.

Mainland nominate audax in QLD; Tasmanian fleayi is EPBC Endangered.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE

NO. XLIII

Southern Boobook

Ninox boobook

STRIGIDAE · HAWK-OWLS

27–36 cm



NO. XLIII

BREEDING J F M A M J J **A** **S** **O** N D **Aug-Oct**

DESCRIPTION

- **Facial disc** – dark brown mask; pale eyebrows
- **Eye** – large, greenish-yellow to hazel
- **Head** – rounded; no ear tufts
- **Upperparts** – dark brown; white spots on scapulars
- **Underparts** – buff, heavily blotched rufous-brown

Adult dark brown above with white-spotted scapulars and wings; buff underparts with rufous-brown blotches; pale facial disc with dark mask and whitish brows; eye greenish-yellow. Sexes alike; female often larger. Juvenile fluffy, paler with whitish underparts and dark mask.

BEHAVIOUR

Nocturnal; hawks moths and beetles, often under lights, and takes small mammals, birds and geckos from a perch. Roosts singly or in pairs in dense foliage or tree hollows. Common and widespread throughout QLD; sedentary pairs.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Open forest · Woodland · Rainforest · Parks & gardens

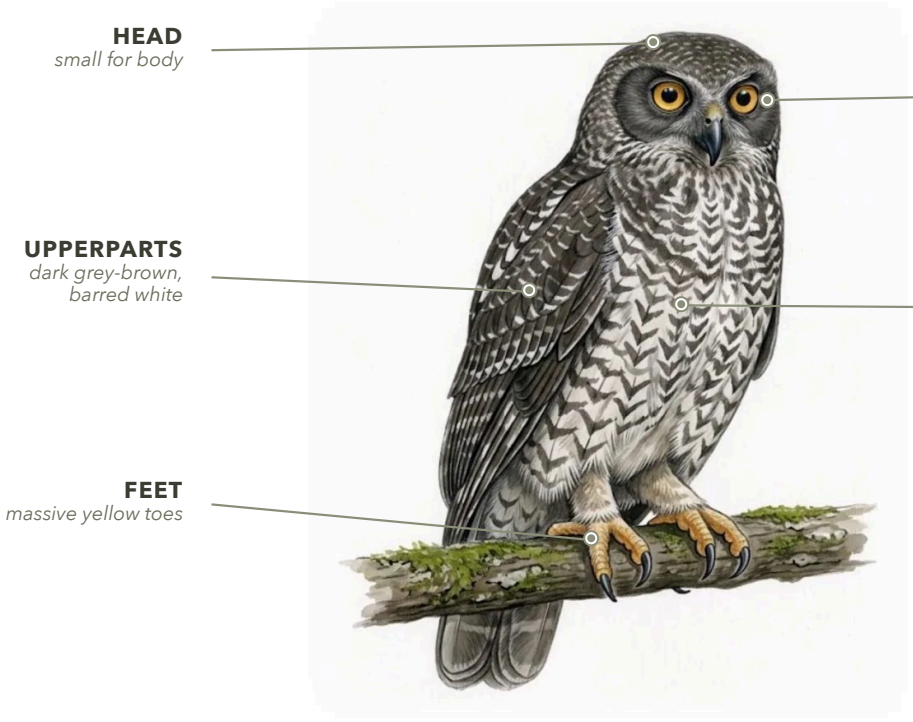
DISTRIBUTION

Throughout Queensland wherever there are trees – coast, ranges and inland watercourses from Cape York to the NSW border. Scarcer in the treeless south-west. Dark rufous Red Boobook in Wet Tropics rainforest.

BREEDING

Eggs Aug–Oct in QLD. Clutch 2–3 (1–5). Unlined tree hollow 1–20 m up, mostly in eucalypts; female incubates while the male brings food.

QLD: nominate boobook (south-east), ocellata (north and west), lurida Red Boobook (Wet Tropics); IOC name Australian Boobook.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE; ♂ LARGER NO. XLIV

Powerful Owl

Ninox strenua

STRIGIDAE · HAWK-OWLS

45–60 cm; wingspan to 1.4 m



NO. XLIV

BREEDING J F M **A** **M** **J** **J** **A** **S** O N D Apr–Sep

DESCRIPTION

- **Eye** – large, yellow; dark grey-brown mask
- **Underparts** – off-white with bold dark V-chevrons
- **Upperparts** – dark grey-brown, barred white
- **Feet** – massive yellow toes; dark claws
- **Head** – small for body; no ear tufts

Adult dark grey-brown above with white barring; off-white below with bold dark chevrons; yellow eye in dark mask; massive yellow-orange feet. Sexes alike in plumage; male larger, broader-headed. Juvenile downy white head and underparts, sparse streaks, short tail.

BEHAVIOUR

Nocturnal; takes arboreal mammals – ringtail possums, greater gliders, sugar gliders – plus roosting birds and flying-foxes, seized from branches. Pairs mate for life and defend year-round territories. Sparse; QLD Vulnerable.



South-east & central-east

Open forest · Woodland · Rivers & creeks

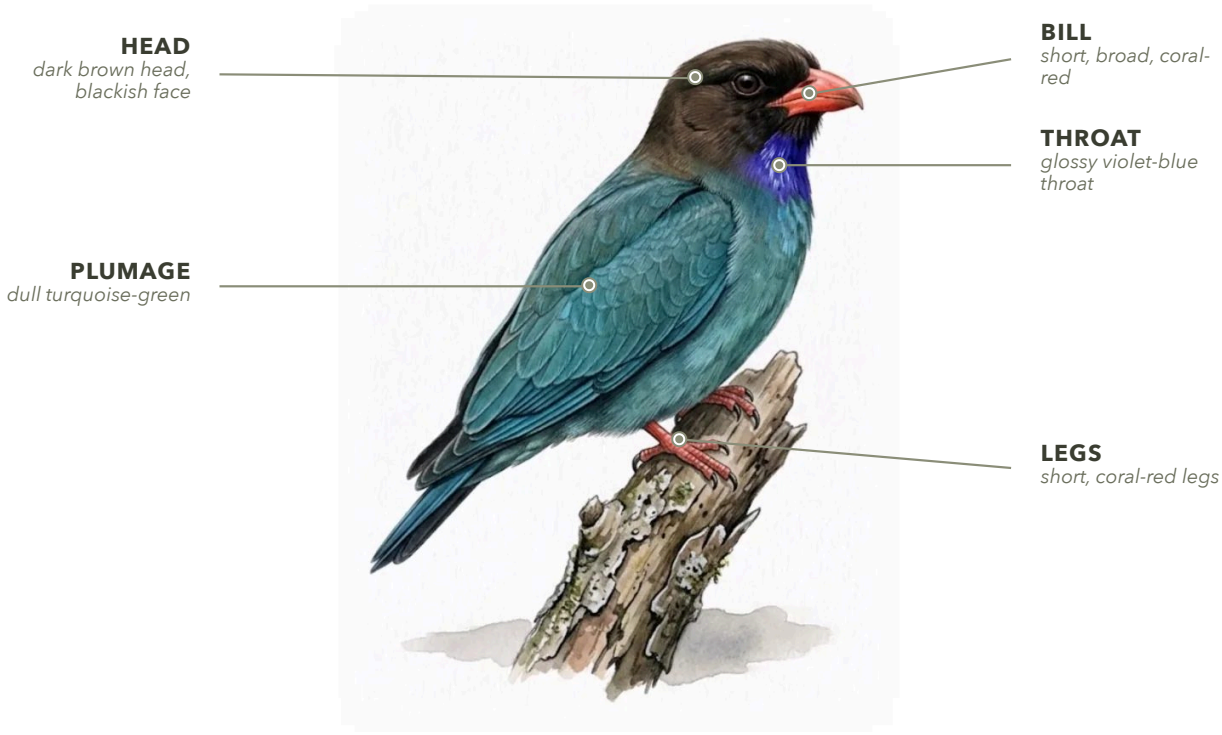
DISTRIBUTION

South-east and central-east Queensland, mainly east of the Great Dividing Range, from the NSW border north to the Clarke Range near Eungella (west of Mackay), inland to the Bunya Mountains and Carnarvon Range.

BREEDING

Mainly Apr–Sep. Clutch 2, rarely 1. Deep vertical hollow in a large old eucalypt; male prepares the hollow and feeds the incubating female.

Monotypic; endemic to eastern and south-eastern Australia.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. XLV

Dollarbird

Eurystomus orientalis

CORACIIDAE · ROLLERS

27–31 cm

NO. XLV

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Oct–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Bill** – short, broad, coral-red; dark tip
- **Head** – dark brown head, blackish face
- **Throat** – glossy violet-blue throat
- **Plumage** – dull turquoise-green; back and underparts
- **Legs** – short, coral-red legs

Sexes alike; female slightly duller. Adult dark brown head, blue-green body, violet-blue throat, red bill and legs. Juvenile duller and browner, lacks the bright throat gloss, with dark brownish bill and legs.

BEHAVIOUR

Hawks large flying insects from a high exposed perch, often returning to the same perch; rarely takes prey on the ground. Usually solitary or in pairs; loose groups gather before migration. Common summer visitor.



Eastern Queensland

Open forest | Woodland | Rivers & creeks | Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Breeding migrant (Sep–Apr) across northern and eastern QLD: Cape York, the Gulf and the east coast to the NSW border, inland along timbered rivers to the central west; a few overwinter in the far north.

BREEDING

Mainly Oct–Jan. Nests in an unlined hollow high in a tree, often reused. Clutch 3–4 white eggs; both sexes incubate and feed the young.

Australian breeders are E. o. pacificus, which winters in New Guinea and Indonesia.



ADULT ♂ (♀ YELLOW HEAD PATCHES) NO. XLVI

Glossy Black-Cockatoo

Calyptorhynchus lathami

CACATUIDAE · COCKATOOS

46–50 cm; smallest black-cockatoo



NO. XLVI

BREEDING J F **M A M J J A** S O N D **Mar–Aug**

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – dull brown head and neck (♂)
- **Bill** – very broad, bulbous grey bill
- **Crest** – small, rounded, hardly visible
- **Body** – sooty black body and wings
- **Tail** – bright red panels; unbarred in males

Male sooty black with brown-washed head and plain bright red tail panels. Female browner, with irregular yellow patches on head and neck, and orange-red tail panels barred black. Juvenile like female but spotted yellow on breast, belly and flanks; young males gradually lose the yellow.

BEHAVIOUR

Specialist on she-oak seed, crushing closed cones with the bulbous bill and feeding for much of the day. Pairs, trios or small groups; larger gatherings at drinking sites before roosting. Quiet and inconspicuous; uncommon and patchily distributed.



South-east & central-east

Open forest · Woodland · Farmland

DISTRIBUTION

South-east and central-east Queensland: nominate lathami from the SEQ coast and islands inland to the Mitchell–Carnarvon area; ssp. erebus in central-east ranges from Kroombit Tops north to the Clarke–Connors Ranges.

BREEDING

Mainly Mar–Aug (sometimes other months). Single white egg in a deep hollow of a large old eucalypt, often reused; female incubates ~30 days; young fledge at ~3 months.

Nominate lathami in SEQ (EPBC Vulnerable); erebus in central-east Qld (QLD Vulnerable only); halmaturinus on Kangaroo Island.



ADULT ♂ (♀ MASK BROWN) NO. XLVII

Yellow-throated Scrubwren

Neosericornis citreogularis

ACANTHIZIDAE · THORNBILLS & SCRUBWRENS

12–15 cm

NO. XLVII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Aug–Feb

DESCRIPTION

- **Mask** – black mask from forehead through eye
- **Eyebrow** – yellow eyebrow; whiter above the bill
- **Throat** – bright lemon-yellow throat
- **Upperparts** – dark olive-brown; flight feathers edged yellow
- **Legs** – long, pale pinkish-cream legs

Male: black mask and forehead bordered by a white-and-yellow eyebrow, bright yellow throat. Female similar but mask dark brown and less contrasting. Juvenile duller, with weaker face pattern and underparts washed fawn.

BEHAVIOUR

Forages almost entirely on the ground, raking leaf litter for insects, spiders and other invertebrates, plus some seeds. In pairs or family groups; sedentary and common in suitable rainforest. Joins other ground-foraging birds.



Eastern seaboard

Rainforest · Wet forest

DISTRIBUTION

Two separate populations: the Wet Tropics from Cooktown to the Paluma Range (ssp. cairnsi), and the south-east QLD ranges from the Bunya Mtns and Blackall Range to Lamington and the Border Ranges.

BREEDING

Mainly Aug–Feb. Bulky domed nest with hooded side entrance, hung 1–10 m up from a vine or branch, often over water. Clutch 2–3 brownish eggs.

cairnsi in the Wet Tropics; intermedius in SEQ. Formerly Sericornis, as still used by WildNet.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE

NO. XLVIII

Blue-faced Honeyeater

Entomyzon cyanotis

MELIPHAGIDAE · HONEYEATERS

26–32 cm



NO. XLVIII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Jun–Feb

DESCRIPTION

- **Face** – bare bright-blue skin around the eye
- **Head** – black crown, nape and throat bib
- **Nape** – narrow white nape crescent
- **Mantle** – golden olive-green back and wings
- **Underparts** – clean white; white stripe below eye

Sexes alike: black head and bib, white nape crescent and malar stripe, golden olive-green upperparts, white underparts; bare blue face skin, deeper cobalt below the eye. Juvenile has yellow-green face skin, brownish crown and paler grey bib.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats insects and other invertebrates gleaned from bark and foliage, plus nectar and fruit. Pairs or noisy parties of up to ~7, sometimes more; often with friarbirds and miners. Sedentary in the north, locally nomadic in the south. Common.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Open forest · Woodland · Mangroves · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Throughout most of Queensland – common across the east and north from Cape York and the Gulf to the NSW border, and inland along timbered watercourses into the central west; scarce in the arid far south-west.

BREEDING

Jun–Feb. Clutch 2, rarely 3. Usually takes over another species' old nest; otherwise builds a rough cup of bark. Both parents, sometimes with helpers, feed young.

Nominate cyanotis in eastern Qld; griseigularis on Cape York; white-winged albipennis in the Gulf and north-west.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. XLIX

Noisy Miner

Manorina melanocephala

MELIPHAGIDAE · HONEYEATERS

24–28 cm

NO. XLIX

BREEDING J F M A M J **J A S O N D** Jul–Dec

DESCRIPTION

- **Crown** – black crown and cheek mask
- **Eye** – bare yellow skin behind the eye
- **Bill** – short, bright yellow
- **Breast** – grey, finely scalloped paler
- **Wing** – olive-yellow edging on wing feathers

Sexes alike: grey with black crown and cheeks; yellow bill, legs and bare skin behind the eye; olive-yellow edging to wing feathers; breast finely scalloped. Juvenile duller and browner, with a dark grey (not black) crown and smaller, paler yellow eye patch.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats insects, nectar, lerp, manna and fruit, gleaned in trees or on the ground. Lives in large, complex colonies that defend communal territories against most other birds. Very common and increasing, especially in fragmented habitat.



Eastern Queensland

Woodland Farmland Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Eastern Queensland from the Atherton Tableland and Einasleigh Uplands south to the NSW border, including the coast, Brigalow Belt and Darling Downs; absent from Cape York, the Gulf and the arid west.

BREEDING

Jul–Dec, often several broods. Clutch 2–4. Female builds a cup of twigs and grass in a tree fork and incubates alone; both sexes and helpers feed the young.

Coastal nominate in SEQ; lepidota inland; titaniota on the NE uplands (Atherton–Einasleigh); leachi in Tasmania.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. L

Eastern Yellow Robin

Eopsaltria australis

PETROICIDAE · AUSTRALASIAN ROBINS

15–17 cm

NO. L

BREEDING J F M A M J **J A S O N D** Jul–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – grey crown, face and nape; grey back
- **Throat** – off-white chin and throat
- **Underparts** – bright yellow breast and belly
- **Rump** – bright yellow rump in Qld birds
- **Bill** – short and black; dark eye

Sexes alike, female slightly smaller: grey head and back, off-white throat, bright yellow underparts; rump bright yellow in Qld birds. Pale wingbar in flight. Juvenile rufous-brown, streaked and spotted paler; later pale streaks are confined to the wings.

BEHAVIOUR

Perch-and-pounce hunter of insects, spiders and other arthropods, mostly taken from the ground. Single birds, pairs or family groups; tame, often approaching people. Common; some altitudinal movement to the lowlands in winter.



Eastern Queensland

Open forest · Woodland · Rainforest · Parks & gardens

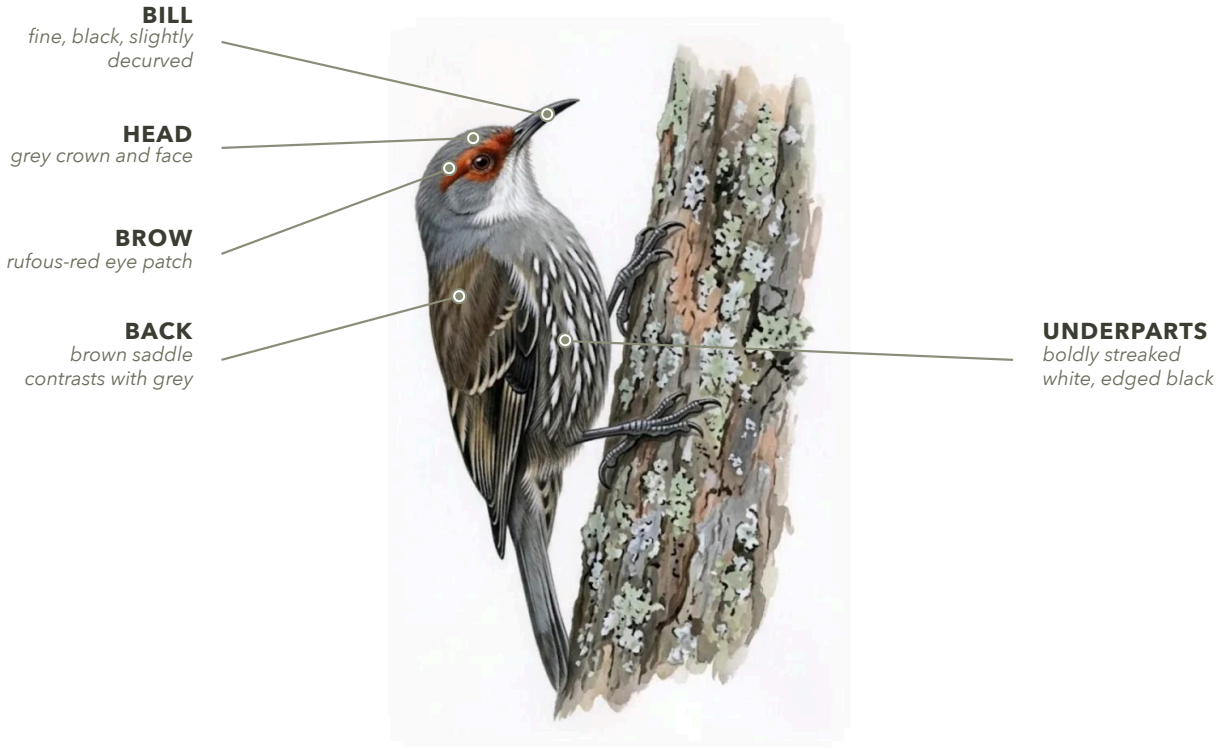
DISTRIBUTION

Eastern Queensland from the Cooktown area and Atherton Tableland south to the NSW border, mostly on the coast and ranges but extending inland to the Carnarvon and Blackdown ranges and the Bunya Mountains.

BREEDING

Jul–Jan; up to three broods. Clutch 2–3. Female builds a neat cup of bark and grass bound with web, decorated with lichen and bark strips, in an upright fork usually <5 m up.

Qld birds are ssp. chrysorrhoa (bright yellow rump); nominate australis, with an olive rump, in Vic and southern NSW.



ADULT ♂ (♀ RUFOUS BREAST STREAKS) NO. LI

Red-browed Treecreeper

Climacteris erythrops

CLIMACTERIDAE · AUSTRALASIAN TREECREEPERS

14–16 cm

NO. LI

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D **Mainly Sep–Jan**

DESCRIPTION

- **Brow** – rufous-red eye patch; reaches ear-coverts
- **Head** – grey crown and face; white throat
- **Back** – brown saddle contrasts with grey
- **Underparts** – boldly streaked white, edged black
- **Bill** – fine, black, slightly decurved

Male: broad rufous eye patch reaching the ear-coverts; upper breast brownish-grey. Female: darker red-brown patch not extending behind the eye; upper breast white, broadly streaked rufous. Both: grey head, brown saddle. Juvenile near-adult within two months.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats insects, chiefly ants, gleaned and probed from bark as it hops up trunks and along branches; sometimes on the ground. Pairs or small cooperative groups holding year-round territories. Sedentary; uncommon to locally common.



South-east & central-east

Wet forest Open forest

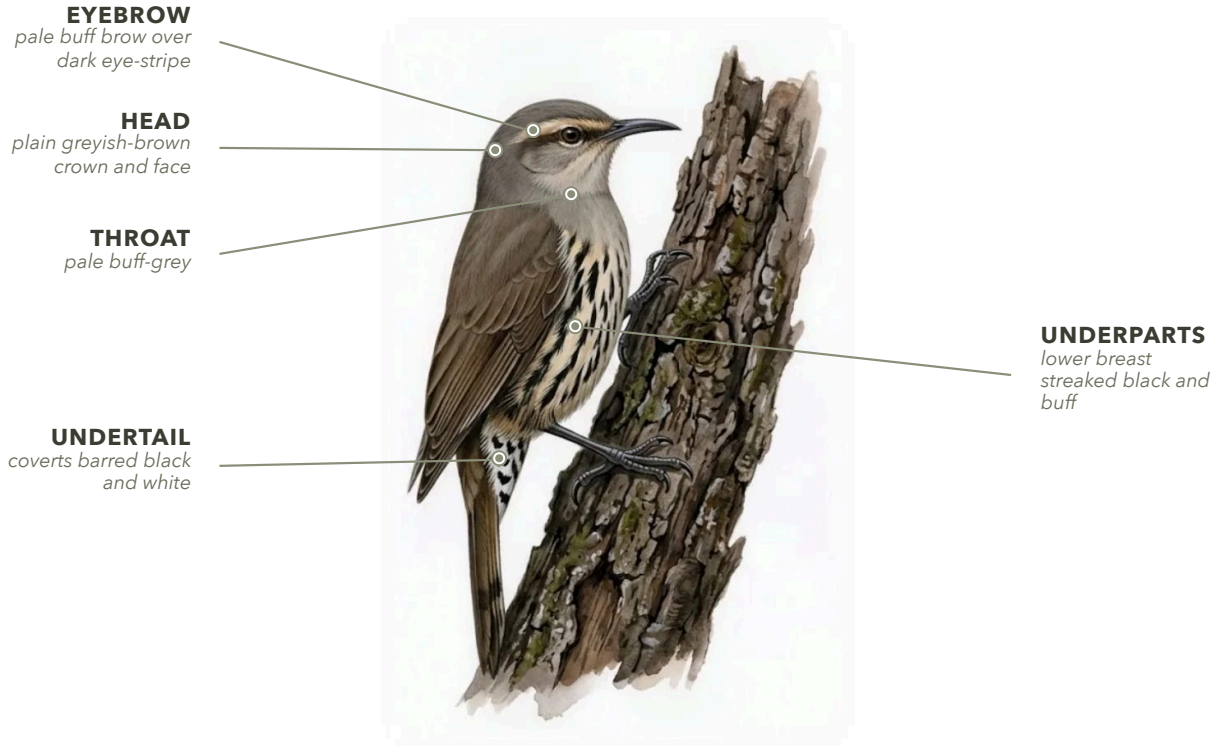
DISTRIBUTION

South-east Queensland only: ranges and foothills from the Jimna–Conondale area south through the D'Aguilar, Main and McPherson Ranges (Lamington, Springbrook), west to the Granite Belt (Girraween).

BREEDING

Late Aug–early Feb. Clutch 2. Nest of bark fibre and grass lined with fur, at the bottom of a hollow in a near-vertical trunk or limb; female incubates.

Monotypic; endemic to eastern Australia (SE Qld to eastern Victoria).



ADULT – SEXES NEARLY ALIKE NO. LII

Brown Treecreeper

Climacteris picumnus

CLIMACTERIDAE · AUSTRALASIAN TREECREEPERS

16–18 cm

NO. LII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Jun–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Eyebrow** – pale buff brow over dark eye-stripe
- **Head** – plain greyish-brown crown and face
- **Throat** – pale buff-grey; ♂ black streaks below
- **Underparts** – lower breast streaked black and buff
- **Undertail** – coverts barred black and white

Sexes nearly alike: buff brow, dark eye-stripe, streaked lower breast. Male has a short band of black-edged streaks on the upper breast; female's are rufous. Juvenile duller, with fainter streaking and a pale rufous lower belly. Cape York birds much darker.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats insects, mostly ants, probed from bark as it hops up trunks or picked from the ground and fallen logs; sometimes pounces from a perch. Sedentary family groups on permanent territories. Common in good woodland, declining in fragments.



Inland eastern Queensland

Woodland · Rivers & creeks · Arid scrub

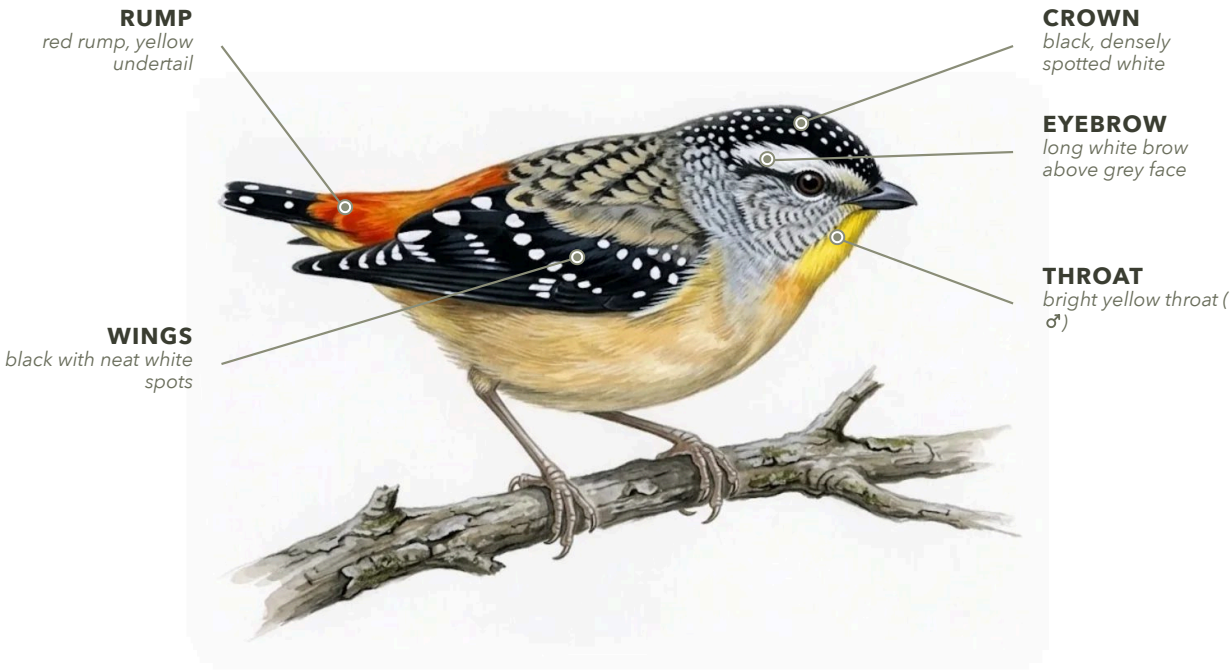
DISTRIBUTION

Eastern and central Queensland west of the wet coast: Brigalow Belt, Darling Downs, Einasleigh and Desert Uplands and mulga west to about Cunnamulla–Longreach; patchy on Cape York; SE ssp. only near the NSW border (Granite Belt).

BREEDING

Jun–Jan; often two broods. Clutch 2–3. Grass, feathers and fur in a tree hollow, stump or post; female incubates, male helpers feed her and the young.

melanotus (dark) on Cape York; picumnus over most of Qld; victoriae (EPBC & QLD Vulnerable) on the southern border.



ADULT ♂ (♀ DULLER) NO. LIII

Spotted Pardalote

Pardalotus punctatus

PARDALOTIDAE · PARDALOTES

8–10 cm

NO. LIII

BREEDING J F M A M J J **A S O N D** Aug–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Crown** – black, densely spotted white
- **Eyebrow** – long white brow above grey face
- **Throat** – bright yellow throat (♂)
- **Wings** – black with neat white spots
- **Rump** – red rump; yellow undertail

♂ black crown, wings and tail spotted white; white brow, grey face, bright yellow throat, buff underparts, red rump. ♀ duller, with buff-yellow crown spots and a pale cream to yellowish throat. Juvenile duller still, crown dull and largely unspotted, throat pale.

BEHAVIOUR

Gleans lerps, psyllids and other small insects, plus sugary leaf exudates, from eucalypt foliage high in the canopy. Pairs or small groups, joining mixed flocks in winter. Common in SEQ; largely sedentary with some altitudinal movement.



Eastern Queensland

Open forest · Woodland · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

South-east QLD, the Darling Downs and the eastern Brigalow Belt (Carnarvon and Blackdown ranges), north via the Eungella ranges to the Wet Tropics uplands near Cooktown. Commonest in the south-east.

BREEDING

Aug–Jan. Clutch 3–5, usually 4, white. Bark-lined chamber at the end of a tunnel 0.5–1.5 m long dug into a bank; occasionally a tree hollow.

Nominate punctatus in SE and central QLD; militaris (smaller, larger-billed) in the Wet Tropics uplands.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. LIV

Red-browed Pardalote

Pardalotus rubricatus

PARDALOTIDAE · PARDALOTES

10–12 cm

NO. LIV

BREEDING J F M A M J **J A S O N D** Jul–Dec

DESCRIPTION

- **Crown** – black, finely spotted white
- **Eyebrow** – orange-red at front; buff behind eye
- **Eye** – pale straw-yellow iris
- **Wings** – golden-orange panel in folded wing
- **Breast** – whitish; yellow patch on centre breast

Sexes alike: black crown spotted white; brow orange-red before the eye, buff-yellow behind; pale yellow iris; grey-buff back; golden-orange wing panel; whitish below with yellow breast patch. Juvenile paler, crown duller, brow dull orange-yellow, eye olive.

BEHAVIOUR

Gleans insects and lerps from eucalypt foliage with its scoop-shaped bill; also beetles, ants and bugs. Alone, in pairs or small groups of up to six; sedentary. Fairly common along inland watercourses but easily overlooked.



Western & central-west inland

Rivers & creeks · Woodland · Arid scrub

DISTRIBUTION

Western and northern QLD: Channel Country, Mulga Lands and Mitchell Grass Downs, NW Highlands and Gulf Plains, east to the Einasleigh and Desert Uplands, and north through central and western Cape York Peninsula.

BREEDING

Mainly Jul–Dec, or after rain in arid areas. Clutch up to 4, white. Grass- and bark-lined chamber at the end of a tunnel in a bank, gully or dune.

Nominate rubricatus in inland QLD; yorki (smaller, brighter orange wing panel) on Cape York, from the base of the Gulf.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. LV

Striated Pardalote

Pardalotus striatus

PARDALOTIDAE · PARDALOTES

9.5–11.5 cm

NO. LV

BREEDING J F M A M J **J A S O N D** Jul–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Crown** – black; unstreaked in E QLD form
- **Eyebrow** – white brow; orange-yellow fore-spot
- **Throat** – white chin; yellow throat and breast
- **Wing** – white stripe with small red spot
- **Back** – plain olive-grey; buff rump

Sexes nearly alike: black crown, white brow with orange-yellow fore-spot, white chin, yellow throat, olive-grey back, white wing stripe with red (or yellow) spot. Female crown slightly duller. Juvenile much paler, crown grey-brown and finely streaked, face pattern faint.

BEHAVIOUR

Gleans insects, larvae and lerps from eucalypt leaves, mainly high in the canopy, sometimes lower in shrubs. In pairs when breeding; flocks of tens in winter, when southern birds disperse. Abundant in eastern QLD.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Open forest · Woodland · Arid scrub · Parks & gardens

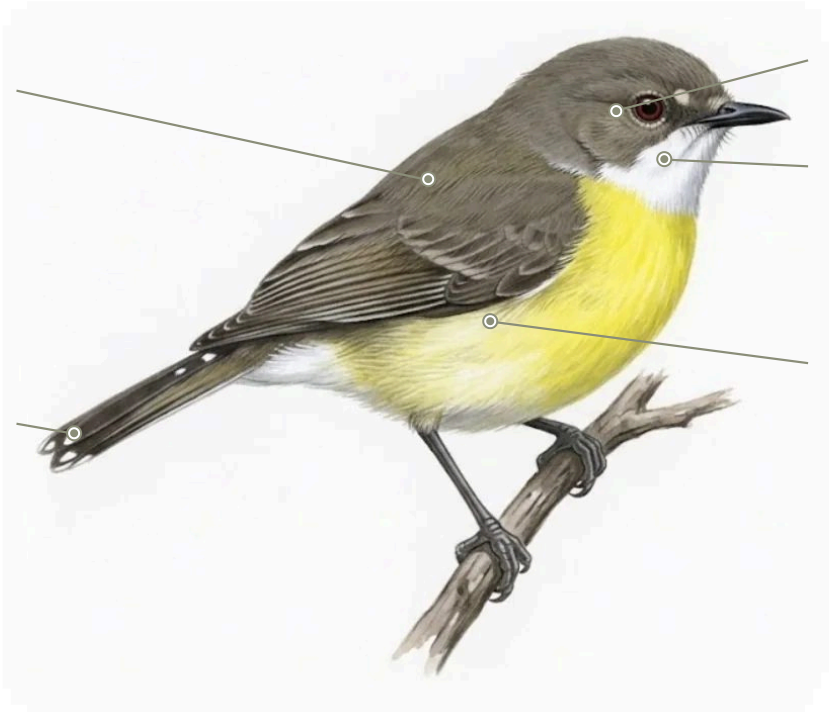
DISTRIBUTION

Throughout QLD wherever there are trees, from Cape York and the Gulf to the Channel Country and the south-east coast; scarcest in treeless downs and the driest dunefields. Very common in SEQ.

BREEDING

Jul–Jan in QLD. Clutch 3–5, white. Cup or domed nest of bark and grass in a tree hollow, earth-bank tunnel or crevice in a building; both sexes incubate.

melanocephalus in central & SE QLD; uropygialis on Cape York & NE QLD; substriatus in the central-west (streaked crown).



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. LVI

White-throated Gerygone

Gerygone olivacea

ACANTHIZIDAE · THORNBILLS & GERYGONES

10–11.5 cm

NO. LVI

BREEDING J F M A M J J A **S O N D** Sep–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Throat** – clean white throat; sharp edge to yellow
- **Underparts** – bright lemon-yellow breast and belly
- **Eye** – red iris; small pale spot above lores
- **Upperparts** – plain grey-brown; wings slightly darker
- **Tail** – dark; white spots near tip of outer feathers

Sexes alike: grey-brown above, white throat, bright yellow from breast to belly with white undertail; red eye; white spots near tail tip. Juvenile lacks the white throat – yellow from chin to belly, with a pale eye-ring and dull brown eye.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats insects and spiders, gleaned from leaves and bark or snatched while hovering at the outer foliage. In pairs or alone, often in mixed feeding flocks with thornbills and pardalotes. Common but easily overlooked when not singing.



Eastern Queensland

Open forest · Woodland · Rivers & creeks

DISTRIBUTION

Widespread in eastern QLD from the NSW border to Cape York, inland through the Brigalow Belt and Einasleigh Uplands, and west across the Gulf Plains to the NT border. Absent from the arid south-west and Channel Country.

BREEDING

Sep–Jan in the south; longer in the north. Clutch 2–3. Pendulous oval nest of bark strips bound with cobweb, hooded side entrance and trailing tail, hung in outer foliage.

olivacea in eastern QLD; rogersi in the Gulf country; cinerascens on Cape York Peninsula (H&M4).



ADULT ♂ (♀ PALE-THROATED) NO. LVII

Fairy Gerygone

Gerygone palpebrosa

ACANTHIZIDAE · THORNBILLS & GERYGONES

10–11.5 cm

NO. LVII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Sep-Feb

DESCRIPTION

- **Throat** – black chin and throat; Cape York ♂
- **Face** – short white whisker below the eye
- **Eye** – red iris; tiny white spot before eye
- **Underparts** – lemon-yellow breast and belly
- **Upperparts** – olive-green back; browner wings and tail

♂ olive above, yellow below, red eye; Cape York ♂ (personata) has a black chin and throat with a white whisker stripe; southern ♂ (flavida) throat yellowish to dusky, black reduced or absent. ♀ lacks dark throat, has white loral spot. Juvenile duller, eye brown.

BEHAVIOUR

Feeds on small insects and spiders, gleaned from leaves or taken while hovering at foliage tips. In pairs or small family parties, sometimes with mixed flocks. Fairly common in the Wet Tropics and on Cape York; scarcer south of Mackay.



Eastern seaboard

Rainforest · Vine scrub · Rivers & creeks · Mangroves

DISTRIBUTION

Coastal eastern QLD from the tip of Cape York south through the Wet Tropics and the Townsville–Mackay coast to the Rockhampton area, thinning to the Sunshine Coast and Gympie hinterland. Mainly lowlands and foothills.

BREEDING

Mainly Sep–Feb. Clutch 2–3. Pendulous domed nest with hooded side entrance and long loose 'tail', hung from a twig, often beside a wasp nest.

personata on Cape York south to the Cairns area; flavida from Cairns to the Rockhampton area and beyond (H&M4).



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. LVIII

Western Gerygone

Gerygone fusca

ACANTHIZIDAE · THORNBILLS & GERYGONES

10–11.5 cm

NO. LVIII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A **S O N D** Mainly Sep–Dec

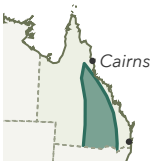
DESCRIPTION

- **Tail** – white base and broad black band; white tips
- **Face** – pale grey; thin white eye-ring and brow
- **Eye** – dark red iris in adults
- **Upperparts** – plain brownish-grey, browner rump
- **Underparts** – whitish, greyer on the breast

Sexes alike: brownish-grey above, pale grey face with thin white eye-ring and short whitish brow, whitish underparts, dark red eye; tail white-based with a black band and white tips. Juvenile has a faint yellowish wash to the face and underparts and a brown eye.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats small insects and spiders, gleaned from outer foliage or snapped up in short fluttering sallies and hovers. Alone or in pairs, joining mixed flocks in winter. Uncommon to locally common in inland QLD; partly migratory or dispersive.



Inland eastern Queensland

Open forest · Woodland · Rivers & creeks · Arid scrub

DISTRIBUTION

Inland southern and central QLD west of the Divide: Darling Downs, Maranoa, Mulga Lands and Brigalow Belt north to the Desert Uplands, with sparse records to the Mt Isa area. Some move east to SEQ hinterland in winter.

BREEDING

Aug–Feb, mostly Sep–Dec. Clutch 2–4. Compact domed nest of grass and bark fibre bound with cobweb, hooded side entrance and wispy tail, hung 2–10 m up.

QLD birds belong to the eastern inland forms (exsul / mungi, H&M4); nominate fusca is in SW Australia.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. LIX

Brown Gerygone

Gerygone mouki

ACANTHIZIDAE · THORNBILLS & GERYGONES

9.5–11 cm

NO. LIX

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Aug–Feb

DESCRIPTION

- **Face** – grey face; short white brow over lores
- **Eye** – red-brown iris in adults
- **Upperparts** – olive-brown crown and back
- **Flanks** – pale grey-white below; flanks buff-brown
- **Tail** – dark subterminal band; white tips

Sexes alike: olive-brown above (greyer olive in the northern race), grey face with a short white brow, pale grey-white underparts with buff-brown flanks, red-brown eye; dark tail band with white tips. Juvenile duller and browner-faced, with a weaker brow and dark eye.

BEHAVIOUR

Gleans and hover-gleans small insects and spiders from foliage at all heights, mostly mid-storey to canopy. In pairs or groups of up to about eight, often leading mixed flocks. Common and sedentary in suitable forest.



Eastern seaboard

Rainforest · Wet forest · Rivers & creeks · Parks & gardens

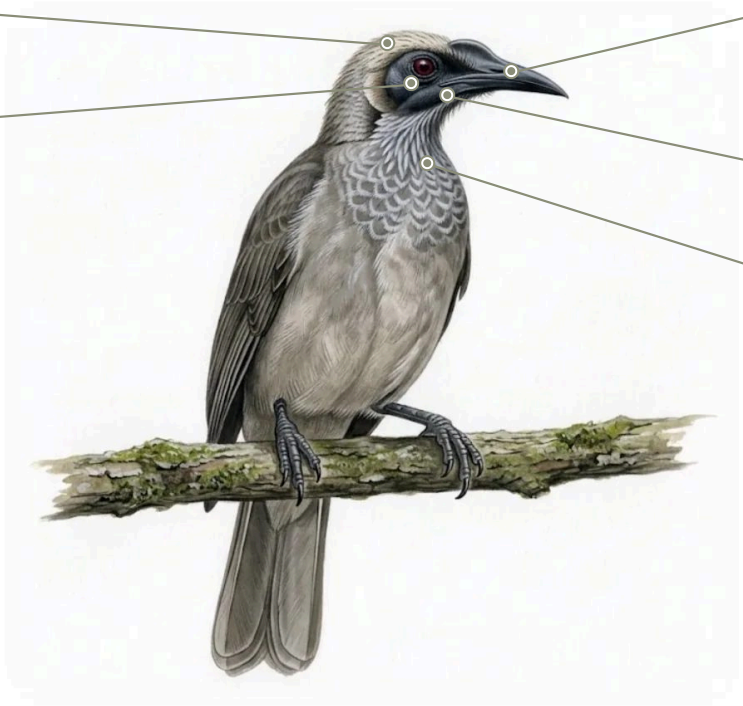
DISTRIBUTION

Three separate eastern populations: the Wet Tropics (Cooktown to Paluma), the Clarke Range around Eungella, and south-east QLD from Kroombit Tops and the Bunya Mtns to the Border Ranges and the coast.

BREEDING

Aug–Feb. Clutch 2–3. Rounded domed nest of roots, fibre, moss and cobweb with a hooded side entrance and tapering 'tail', hung from a low branch or vine.

mouki in the Wet Tropics; amalia in east-central QLD; richmondi in SE QLD to Vic (H&M4).



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. LX

Helmeted Friarbird

Philemon buceroides yorki

MELIPHAGIDAE · HONEYEATERS

32–36 cm



NO. LX

BREEDING J F M A M J J A **S O N D** Sep–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Face** – bare blackish-grey facial skin
- **Bill** – long, heavy, black; low sloping casque
- **Eye** – deep red iris; brownish in young birds
- **Throat** – silvery-grey hackles, streaked dark
- **Crown** – feathered grey-buff, finely streaked

Sexes alike; males longer-winged and heavier. Adult grey-brown with bare blackish facial skin, red iris, heavy black bill and low casque; silvery hackles on throat. Juvenile: grey or dull brown iris, little or no casque; immature has whitish fringes on the back.

BEHAVIOUR

Takes nectar, fruit, seeds and insects, also spiders and small lizards, mostly in the outer canopy. Gregarious, in pairs to large noisy flocks at blossom; aggressive towards other honeyeaters. Common and largely sedentary.



Northern & eastern coastal wetlands

Rainforest · Mangroves · Woodland · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Coastal and near-coastal NE Queensland: Cape York Peninsula (incl. Weipa and Iron Range) south through the Wet Tropics, Townsville and the Whitsundays to about Sarina; scarce further south and inland.

BREEDING

Mainly Sep–Jan. Clutch 2–4. Deep cup of bark strips and grass bound with web, slung from a leafy outer fork, often over water.

 Qld birds are ssp. yorki ('Hornbill Friarbird'; P. yorki in IOC 2006–24). BirdLife Australia and IOC 15.1+ keep it in P. buceroides.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. LXI

Noisy Friarbird

Philemon corniculatus

MELIPHAGIDAE · HONEYEATERS

31–35 cm



NO. LXI

BREEDING J F M A M J **J A S O N D** Jul–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – entirely bare black head and neck
- **Bill** – black, with a prominent upright knob
- **Eye** – red iris in bare black face
- **Throat** – silvery-white hackles; throat and breast
- **Tail** – grey-brown, tipped whitish

Sexes alike; female slightly smaller. Adult: bare black head and neck, red iris, knobbed black bill, silvery throat hackles, white-tipped tail. Juvenile: knob inconspicuous, forehead and nape feathered, khaki-brown iris, breast feathers edged lemon; immature has a smaller knob.

BEHAVIOUR

Takes nectar, insects, fruit and sometimes eggs or nestlings, feeding high in the canopy and rarely on the ground. Pairs to large noisy flocks, often with Little Friarbirds and wattlebirds; aggressive. Common; partly migratory.



Eastern Queensland

Open forest · Woodland · Heath · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Eastern Queensland from Cape York Peninsula south to the NSW border, inland through the Einasleigh Uplands, Desert Uplands and Brigalow Belt to the Darling Downs and Maranoa; sparse in the arid west.

BREEDING

Jul–Jan; one or two broods. Clutch 2–4, usually 3. Female builds a large deep cup of bark and grass bound with web, slung from a fork, and incubates alone.

Nominate corniculatus on Cape York (and S New Guinea); monachus over central and southern Qld.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. LXII

Little Friarbird

Philemon citreogularis

MELIPHAGIDAE · HONEYEATERS

25–29 cm

NO. LXII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Aug–Apr

DESCRIPTION

- **Face** – bare blue-grey face; below and behind eye
- **Bill** – slender, curved and black; no casque
- **Crown** – grey-brown crown, finely scaled
- **Breast** – pale grey with fine white streaks
- **Upperparts** – plain grey-brown; paler collar

Sexes alike in plumage and size. Adult grey-brown above with paler collar, bare blue-grey face patch, brown eye, pale grey underparts finely white-streaked on the breast. Juvenile browner, with yellow chin and throat and darker blue-black facial skin.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats nectar and insects, also flowers, fruit and seeds, almost always in tree canopies. Alone, in pairs or small flocks, often with other honeyeaters; aggressive at blossom. Common and widespread; resident in the north, partly migratory in the south.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Woodland · Rivers & creeks · Wetlands · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Throughout most of Queensland: Cape York and the Gulf through the tropics and down the east coast to SEQ, and inland along timbered watercourses to the Channel Country; sparse in the far south-west.

BREEDING

Aug–Apr; may raise two broods. Clutch 2–3, rarely 4. Both build a deep, often see-through cup of bark and grass near or over water; female incubates.

Nominate citreogularis over most of Qld; sordidus in the far north-west (Gulf country).



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. LXIII

Varied Sittella

Daphoenositta chrysoptera leucocephala

NEOSITTIDAE · SITTELLAS

10–12 cm



NO. LXIII

BREEDING J F M A M J J **A S O N D** Aug–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – white head and nape in both sexes
- **Eye** – orange-yellow iris and eye-ring
- **Bill** – slender, slightly upturned; dark tip
- **Wing** – orange-rufous band, bold in flight
- **Feet** – yellow, long-toed for clinging

White-headed form: sexes alike, both with white head; female reportedly more heavily streaked below. In Striated, White-winged and Black-capped forms the male has a dark cap and the female a dark hood. Juveniles paler, pale-spotted above.

BEHAVIOUR

Gleans and probes for insects and spiders in bark crevices, working head-down along branches and trunks. Always in chattering flocks of 5–20 that move swiftly between trees. Fairly common, but has declined with woodland clearing.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Woodland · Open forest · Arid scrub

DISTRIBUTION

Throughout Queensland wherever there is woodland, from Cape York and the Gulf to SEQ and west along timbered creeks; the White-headed form is the common bird of central and south-east Qld.

BREEDING

Mainly Aug–Jan. Clutch usually 3. Cone-shaped cup of bark and web, decorated with bark flakes, in an upright fork high in a tree; group feeds the young.

White-headed leucocephala (C & SE Qld) shown; striata on Cape York/NE, leucoptera NW, pileata SW; intergrades in central Qld.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE

NO. LXIV

Black-faced Cuckoo-shrike

Coracina novaehollandiae

CAMPEPHAGIDAE · CUCKOO-SHRIKES & TRILLERS

30–36 cm

NO. LXIV

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Aug–Feb

DESCRIPTION

- **Face** – solid black mask; forehead to throat
- **Mantle** – soft blue-grey; grey crown above mask
- **Wing** – blue-grey; blackish, pale-edged flight feathers
- **Underparts** – pale grey breast; white belly and vent
- **Bill** – stout, black and slightly hooked

Sexes alike. Adult: black forehead, face and throat; blue-grey crown, back, wings and breast; white belly and undertail. Immature: mask reduced to a black stripe through the eye, throat pale grey; juvenile faintly barred on the breast. Full mask acquired in about a year.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats insects and other invertebrates such as caterpillars, beetles and grasshoppers, gleaned from foliage, hawked or snatched from the ground; also some fruit and seeds. Pairs or family groups; flocks of up to 100 after breeding. Common; partly nomadic and migratory.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Open forest · Woodland · Farmland · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Throughout Queensland, from Cape York and the Gulf to the Channel Country and the south-east, in almost any wooded country. Numbers swell in winter as southern birds move north; some continue to New Guinea.

BREEDING

Aug–Feb; opportunistic in arid areas. Clutch 2–3. Small, shallow saucer of sticks and bark bound with cobweb on a horizontal fork; both sexes build and rear the young.

Ssp. melanops across mainland QLD; nominate novaehollandiae breeds in Tasmania and winters on the mainland.



ADULT PALE MORPH – SEXES ALIKE NO. LXV

White-bellied Cuckoo-shrike

Coracina papuensis

CAMPEPHAGIDAE · CUCKOO-SHRIKES & TRILLERS

26–28 cm

NO. LXV

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Aug–Mar

DESCRIPTION

- **Face** – narrow black mask; bill to just behind eye
- **Throat** – white to very pale grey
- **Mantle** – pale blue-grey; crown, back and coverts
- **Underparts** – pale grey breast; clean white belly
- **Bill** – black; slimmer than Black-faced's

Sexes alike; adult ♂ has a tiny white spot above the rear of the eye. Pale morph: grey above, black mask bill-to-eye, white throat and belly. Dark morph (mainly south-east): black head, throat and breast, barred below. Juvenile browner and mottled, with a faint mask.

BEHAVIOUR

Gleans insects and other invertebrates from foliage and hawks them in flight; also takes some fruit, seeds and nectar. Single birds, pairs or small groups; mostly resident with some seasonal movement. Fairly common in the north, scarcer in the south.



Eastern Queensland

Open forest · Woodland · Rivers & creeks · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Northern and eastern Queensland: Cape York Peninsula and the Gulf country west to Mount Isa, south through the Wet Tropics, Einasleigh Uplands and Brigalow Belt to the south-east; sparse in the south-west.

BREEDING

Aug–Mar. Clutch 1–3. Shallow cup of grass, twigs and bark bound with web and decorated with lichen, on a horizontal fork 7–10 m up; both sexes incubate 21–22 days.

QLD: oriomo (Cape York and NE), hypoleuca (Gulf and NW), artamoides (central and SE). Dark morph mostly in robusta of NSW–SA.



ADULT – SEXES SIMILAR

NO. LXVI

Barred Cuckoo-shrike

Coracina lineata

CAMPEPHAGIDAE · CUCKOO-SHRIKES & TRILLERS

24–28 cm



NO. LXVI

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S **O N D** Oct–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Eye** – bright yellow iris; blackish lores
- **Head** – slate blue-grey head and throat
- **Underparts** – boldly barred black and white
- **Mantle** – dark slate-grey back and wings
- **Tail** – long, dark grey; barred undertail coverts

Adult: slate blue-grey head, throat and upperparts, yellow eye, blackish lores; breast to undertail barred black and white. Sexes similar; female's barring may reach higher on the breast. Juvenile: dark eye, scalloped upperparts, whitish underparts with finer, broken barring.

BEHAVIOUR

Feeds mainly on fruit, especially native figs, plucked in quick sallies through the canopy; also takes insects from foliage. Gregarious, in pairs or flocks of up to ~20, and roosts communally. Uncommon; most numerous in the Wet Tropics.



Eastern seaboard

Rainforest · Wet forest · Rivers & creeks

DISTRIBUTION

Eastern Queensland: patchy on eastern Cape York Peninsula (Iron and McIlwraith Ranges), commonest in the Wet Tropics, then south along the coast and ranges via the Mackay hinterland to the south-east.

BREEDING

Mainly Oct–Jan. Clutch 1–2. Small, shallow cup of twigs and bark bound with cobweb, placed high in a tree fork and hard to see.

Nominate lineata in eastern Australia; nine other races in New Guinea and the Solomon Islands.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE

NO. LXVII

Ground Cuckoo-shrike

Coracina maxima

CAMPEPHAGIDAE · CUCKOO-SHRIKES & TRILLERS

33–37 cm



NO. LXVII

BREEDING J F M A M J J **A S O N** D Aug–Nov

DESCRIPTION

- **Eye** – pale yellow iris; small black lores
- **Head** – pale ash-grey head, neck and breast
- **Wing** – black, contrasting with grey back
- **Underparts** – white, finely barred black; rump barred
- **Tail** – long, black and distinctly forked

Sexes alike: pale grey head, mantle and breast; black lores and wings; belly, rump and undertail white, finely barred black; forked black tail; pale yellow eye. Juvenile: dark eye and dark eye-line, with fine broken black barring on the throat and upperparts.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats mainly insects (grasshoppers, locusts, mantids, beetles, caterpillars) and spiders, taken while walking and running over bare ground. Lives in small family groups, often three or four. Uncommon, thinly spread and partly nomadic.



Inland eastern Queensland

Woodland · Grassland · Arid scrub · Farmland

DISTRIBUTION

Thinly across inland Queensland west of the Divide, from the Gulf country and Mount Isa uplands through the Mitchell Grass Downs and Channel Country to the Darling Downs; east to the Lockyer and South Burnett.

BREEDING

Aug–Nov. Clutch 2–3 (up to 5), glossy olive, spotted brown. Shallow cup of grass, bark and stems bound with web in a fork 3–15 m up; helpers feed the young.

Monotypic; endemic to mainland Australia. Sometimes placed in its own genus, Pteropodocys.



ADULT ♂ (♀ BROWNER)

NO. LXVIII

Varied Triller

Lalage leucomela

CAMPEPHAGIDAE · CUCKOO-SHRIKES & TRILLERS

18–20 cm

NO. LXVIII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Aug–Feb

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – white eyebrow; black crown and eye-stripe
- **Back** – glossy black in ♂; brownish-grey in ♀
- **Wing** – black; white covert streaks and edges
- **Underparts** – white; fine grey barring on breast, flanks
- **Vent** – cinnamon-buff; lower belly and undertail

Male glossy black above with white eyebrow, black eye-stripe and white-streaked wing coverts; white below, finely barred grey, vent cinnamon-buff. Female browner-grey above with buff brow; underparts greyer, more heavily barred. Juvenile like female, mottled buff above.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats fruit (notably figs) plus insects, seeds and some nectar, mostly in the outer foliage of the mid to upper canopy, occasionally near the ground. Single birds or pairs. Sedentary; common in the Wet Tropics and on Cape York, less so in the south-east.



Eastern seaboard

Rainforest · Vine scrub · Mangroves · Wetlands

DISTRIBUTION

Eastern Queensland from the tip of Cape York south through the Wet Tropics and the coast and ranges to the NSW border; also down western Cape York Peninsula to the south-east Gulf. Rare far inland of the Divide.

BREEDING

Mainly Aug–Feb. Single egg in a tiny, shallow cup of twigs, tendrils and bark bound with web, on a slender horizontal fork, often in a paperbark or mangrove.

Ssp. yorki from Cape York south to about Mackay; nominate leucomela further south. Rufous-vented races occur in the NT and Kimberley.



ADULT ♂ NON-BREEDING (♀ SIMILAR) NO. LXIX

White-winged Triller

Lalage tricolor

CAMPEPHAGIDAE · CUCKOO-SHRIKES & TRILLERS

16–19 cm

NO. LXIX

BREEDING J F M A M J J A **S O N D** Sep-Dec

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – grey-brown; faint pale brow, dark eye-line
- **Wing** – black; white shoulder bar and edgings
- **Back** – grey-brown when non-breeding; grey rump
- **Underparts** – white to buff-white, unmarked
- **Bill** – short, slender and black

Breeding ♂ glossy black crown, face and back, black wings with broad white shoulder and edgings, grey rump, white below. Non-breeding (eclipse) ♂ grey-brown above but keeps black-and-white wings. Female brown above, buff-white below, wings brown edged buff. Juvenile mottled buff.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats mainly insects, gleaned from foliage, hawked in the air or taken on the ground; also some fruit, seeds and nectar. Pairs or loose flocks; strongly nomadic and migratory, appearing in numbers where insects are plentiful. Common, especially inland.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Woodland · Arid scrub · Rivers & creeks · Farmland

DISTRIBUTION

Throughout Queensland in open country, from Cape York and the Gulf to the Channel Country and south-east; commonest inland. Present all year in the north and inland; mainly a spring–summer breeding visitor in the south-east.

BREEDING

Sep–Dec in the south; after rain inland. Clutch 2–3. Small, frail cup of bark and grass bound with web on a horizontal branch or fork; both sexes incubate ~14 days.

Monotypic. Formerly lumped in White-shouldered Triller L. sueurii; older books use that name.





FEMALE ♀

ADULT ♂ (♀ YELLOW-SPOTTED) NO. LXX

Red-tailed Black-Cockatoo

Calyptorhynchus banksii

CACATUIDAE · COCKATOOS

55–60 cm



NO. LXX

BREEDING J F M A **M** **J** **J** **A** **S** O N D May–Sep

DESCRIPTION

- **Crest** – full rounded helmet crest; raised when alert
- **Bill** – massive dark-grey bill (♂); whitish in ♀
- **Body** – glossy black, unspotted in adult ♂
- **Tail** – scarlet panels (♂); black centre and tip
- **Eye** – dark brown eye; no bare coloured eye-ring

Adult ♂ glossy black with dark-grey bill and scarlet tail panels. ♀ brownish-black, spotted pale yellow on head, neck and wing coverts, barred yellow below, with orange-yellow tail panels barred black and a whitish bill. Juvenile like ♀; young ♂ gain red tail over ~4 years.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats seeds of eucalypts (especially bloodwoods), casuarinas, acacias and grevilleas, plus fruit; often feeds on the ground on fallen seed and weeds. Gregarious, from pairs to flocks of hundreds; common in the north, declined in SEQ and NSW.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Woodland · Open forest · Rivers & creeks · Parks & gardens

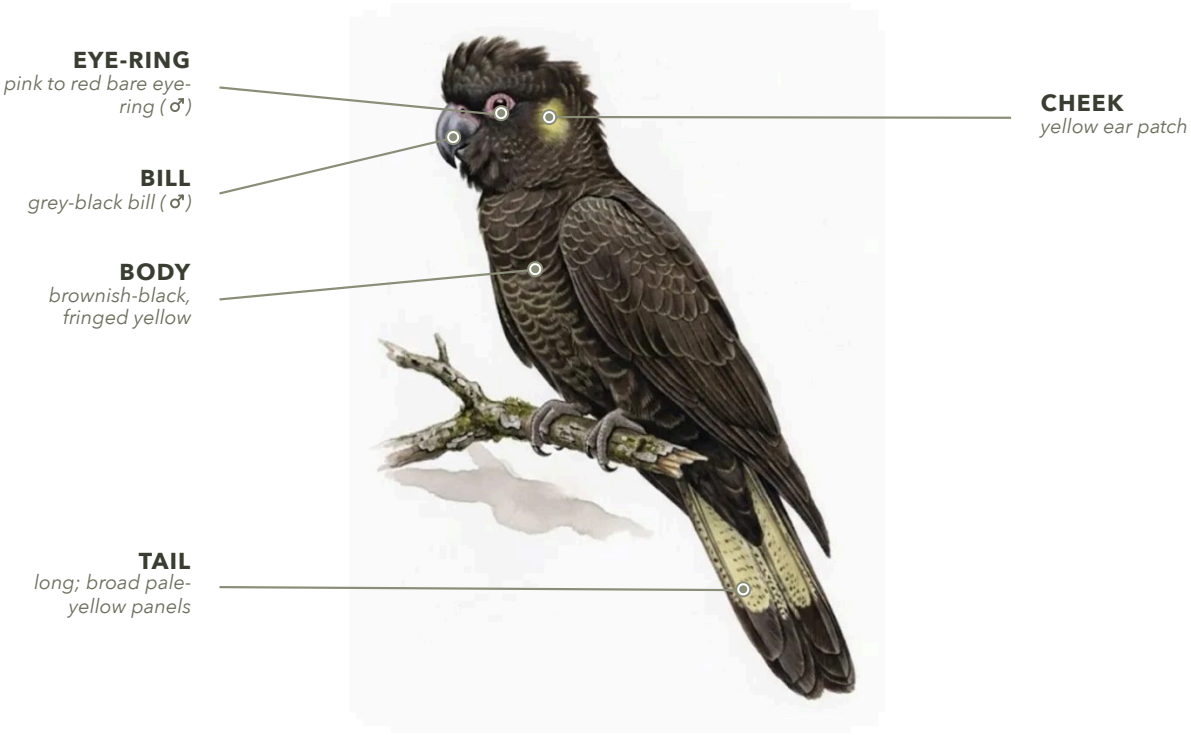
DISTRIBUTION

Northern and eastern QLD: Cape York, the Gulf plains, Wet Tropics and the Townsville–Mackay–Rockhampton coast and woodlands inland; now patchy in SEQ. Ssp. samueli along Channel Country rivers in the south-west.

BREEDING

Mainly autumn–winter (c. May–Sep) in QLD. Lays 1 white egg (rarely 2) in a deep vertical hollow of a tall, often dead eucalypt; ♀ alone incubates c. 30 days.

QLD: nominate banksii in the north and east (incl. former macrorhynchus); samueli on SW rivers. EPBC-listed graptogyne and naso absent.



ADULT ♂ (♀ PALE BILL, GREY RING) NO. LXXI

Yellow-tailed Black-Cockatoo

Zanda funerea

CACATUIDAE · COCKATOOS

55–65 cm



NO. LXXI

BREEDING J F M **A** **M** **J** **J** A S O N D Apr–Jul

DESCRIPTION

- **Cheek** – yellow ear patch; small and dull in ♂
- **Eye-ring** – pink to red bare eye-ring (♂)
- **Bill** – grey-black bill (♂); pale horn in ♀
- **Body** – brownish-black; feathers fringed yellow
- **Tail** – long; broad pale-yellow panels, flecked

Adult ♂: small, dull yellow ear patch, pink-red eye-ring, grey-black bill, yellow tail panels lightly flecked. ♀: larger, brighter cheek patch, grey eye-ring, pale horn bill, more heavily flecked tail panels. Juvenile like ♀; young ♂ bill darkens by 2–4 years.

BEHAVIOUR

Feeds on seeds of banksias, hakeas, casuarinas, eucalypts and plantation pines, and on wood-boring larvae. Pairs and family groups join flocks, sometimes 100+ outside breeding. Common in SEQ, scarce further north; declining in parts of its range.



South-east & central-east

Open forest · Woodland · Heath · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

South-east Queensland from the NSW border and Granite Belt to the Sunshine Coast, Bunya Mtns and Burnett, thinning north to Gladstone, the Berserker Range near Rockhampton and the Carnarvon–Blackdown ranges.

BREEDING

Mainly autumn–winter in QLD (c. Apr–Jul). 1–2 white eggs in a large hollow high in an old eucalypt; ♀ incubates c. 4 weeks while ♂ feeds her. Usually one young raised.

Nominate funerea throughout QLD; xanthanotus (incl. whiteae of some authors) in SA, western Vic and Tasmania.



ADULT ♂ (♀ RED-PINK EYE) NO. LXXII

Pink Cockatoo

Lophochroa leadbeateri

CACATUIDAE · COCKATOOS

35–40 cm



NO. LXXII

BREEDING J F M A M J J **A S O N D** Aug-Dec

DESCRIPTION

- **Crest** – tall; white folded, red & yellow raised
- **Head** – salmon-pink face, neck and breast
- **Mantle** – white back and wings; faint pink wash
- **Bill** – pale horn-white bill
- **Eye** – dark brown in ♂; pinkish-red in ♀

Sexes similar. ♂ has dark brown iris and narrower yellow crest band; ♀ pinkish-red iris and broader yellow band. Juvenile duller and paler pink, with brown iris and a less clearly banded crest. Rarely hybridises with Galah.

BEHAVIOUR

Feeds mostly on the ground on seeds of native grasses, melons, cypress pine and saltbush, plus roots, bulbs and insect larvae. Pairs or small parties; larger flocks where food is rich. Uncommon and declining; largely sedentary near water.



Western & central-west inland

Arid scrub · Woodland · Rivers & creeks

DISTRIBUTION

South-west Queensland, mainly south of about 25°S: Mulga Lands and Channel Country around Cunnamulla (Bowra, Currawinya), Thargomindah, Quilpie, Charleville and St George, north to Windorah and Isisford.

BREEDING

Mainly Aug–Dec. 2–4 white eggs (usually 3–4) in a deep hollow of a large old eucalypt or cypress pine; both sexes incubate c. 26 days. Pairs nest well apart.

Eastern nominate leadbeateri in QLD (EPBC Endangered); mollis in central and WA. QLD WildNet still uses Cacatua.



ADULT ♂ (♀ PINK-RED EYE)

NO. LXXIII

Galah

Eolophus roseicapilla

CACATUIDAE · COCKATOOS

34–38 cm



NO. LXXIII

BREEDING J **F M A M J J A S O N D** Feb–Dec

DESCRIPTION

- **Crest** – pale pink to whitish cap; short crest
- **Face** – deep rose-pink face, neck and breast
- **Eye** – bare pinkish eye-ring; dark-brown iris (♂)
- **Wings** – silver-grey back, wings and rump
- **Bill** – pale horn bill; grey legs

Sexes alike except iris: dark brown in ♂, pink to red-brown in ♀. Juvenile duller, with greyish wash on crown, crest and breast, smooth whitish eye-ring and brown iris. Western roseicapilla has a grey-white, not pink, eye-ring.

BEHAVIOUR

Feeds mainly on the ground on grass and weed seeds and spilt grain, also roots, shoots and insect larvae. Pairs bond for life; gathers in flocks of hundreds outside breeding. Abundant and increasing; a crop pest in places.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Grassland · Farmland · Woodland · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Throughout Queensland, from the Channel Country and Gulf plains to the east coast; abundant on inland plains and farmland and now common in Brisbane, Townsville and Cairns. Sparse on northern Cape York.

BREEDING

Feb–Jul in the north; Jul–Dec in the south. 2–5 (usually 3–4) white eggs in a tree hollow lined with leaves; both sexes incubate c. 25 days.

albiceps over most of QLD; kuhli (paler, smaller, shorter crest) in the north, from the Gulf to the Burdekin and s. Cape York.



ADULT ♂ (♀ GREY FACE) NO. LXXIV

Cockatiel

Nymphicus hollandicus

CACATUIDAE · COCKATOOS

30–33 cm; half is tail



NO. LXXIV

BREEDING J F M A M J J **A S O N D** Mainly Aug–Dec; any month

DESCRIPTION

- **Crest** – long, thin, upswept crest; grey-yellow
- **Face** – bright yellow face and forehead (♂)
- **Cheek** – round orange ear patch
- **Wing** – bold white panel on folded wing
- **Tail** – long, pointed, dark grey; plain below (♂)

Adult ♂: bright yellow face, forehead and crest, vivid orange ear patch, plain dark tail. ♀: face greyish with faint yellow wash, duller ear patch, undertail barred yellow and flight feathers spotted yellow. Juvenile like ♀; young ♂ moult to adult face at 6–9 months.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats seeds of grasses, herbs, acacias and crops such as sorghum and sunflower, mostly gathered on the ground. In pairs or flocks, up to hundreds at water. Common inland; strongly nomadic, with influxes after good rain.



Western & central-west inland

Woodland · Grassland · Arid scrub · Farmland

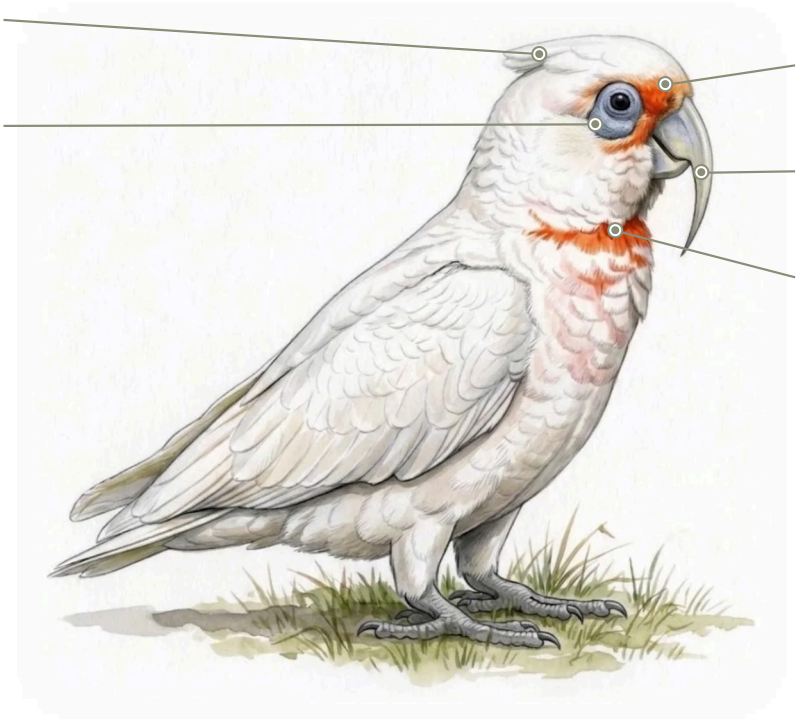
DISTRIBUTION

Throughout inland Queensland west of the ranges – Channel Country, Mulga Lands, Mitchell-grass downs, Gulf plains and Brigalow Belt – reaching the coast in dry years. Scarce on the wet east coast and Cape York.

BREEDING

Any month after good rain inland; mainly Aug–Dec in the south. 4–7 white eggs in a tree hollow near water; both sexes incubate c. 3 weeks.

Monotypic; sole member of Nymphicus, placed in its own subfamily (Nymphicinae) within the cockatoos.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. LXXV

Long-billed Corella

Cacatua tenuirostris

CACATUIDAE · COCKATOOS

38–41 cm



NO. LXXV

BREEDING J F M A M J **J A S O N** D Jul–Nov

DESCRIPTION

- **Bill** – very long, slender upper mandible
- **Face** – orange-red lores and forehead
- **Eye-ring** – bare blue-grey skin around the eye
- **Throat** – orange-red band across throat
- **Crest** – short white crest, rarely raised

Sexes alike; ♂ averages slightly larger with a longer bill. Plumage white with orange-red lores, forehead and throat band, yellow wash under wings and tail, and bare blue-grey eye-ring. Juvenile similar but with a shorter bill and less red.

BEHAVIOUR

Digs for roots, corms, bulbs and seeds on lawns and pasture, also takes grain and fallen fruit; often mixes with Little Corellas and Galahs. Highly social. In QLD local and mostly urban; can damage turf, crops and fittings.



South-east & central-east

Parks & gardens · Woodland · Farmland

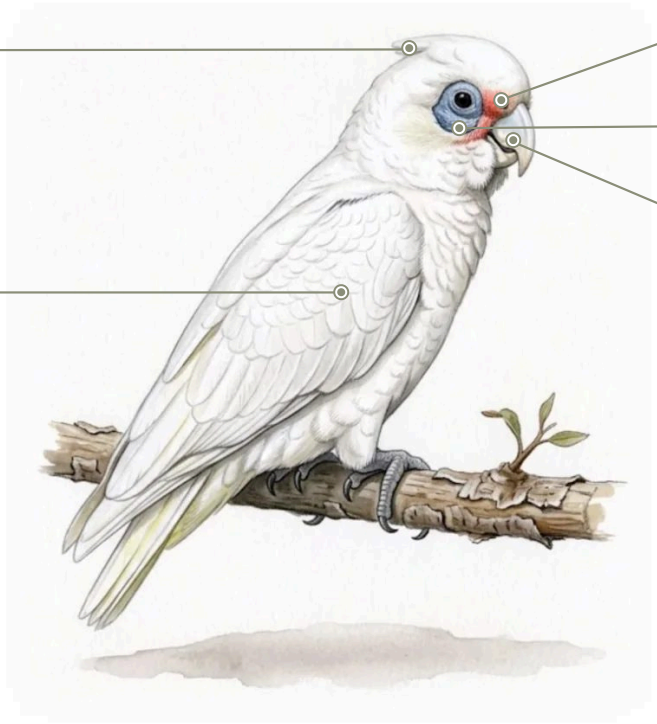
DISTRIBUTION

Not native: feral flocks from aviary escapes, centred on Brisbane, Ipswich, Logan, Moreton Bay and the Gold Coast, with smaller groups at Toowoomba, Bundaberg, Rockhampton–Yeppoon, Townsville and Cairns.

BREEDING

Jul–Nov in native range. 2–3 white eggs on decayed wood in a hollow of a large old eucalypt; both sexes incubate c. 24 days. Breeding in QLD feral flocks is little documented.

Monotypic. QLD birds descend from escaped or released captives; closest relative is the Western Corella of WA.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. LXXVI

Little Corella

Cacatua sanguinea

CACATUIDAE · COCKATOOS

35–42 cm



NO. LXXVI

BREEDING J F M A **M** **J** **J** **A** **S** **O** N D May–Oct

DESCRIPTION

- **Eye** – bare blue-grey eye-skin; baggiest below eye
- **Lores** – pink-red smudge between eye and bill
- **Bill** – short, stubby, horn-white bill
- **Crest** – short white crest, usually laid flat
- **Plumage** – all white; faint yellow wash under tail

Sexes alike in plumage; female slightly smaller, with a smaller bare eye-ring. Juvenile like adult but eye-skin less extensive and paler, lores less pink. Eastern gymnopis has more extensive bluish eye-skin and pinker lores than northern birds; normantoni is slightly smaller.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats grass and herb seeds, cereal grain, bulbs and roots, mostly dug or picked from the ground; also seeds in trees. Highly gregarious, roosting communally and mixing with Galahs and Sulphur-crested Cockatoos. Common to abundant; can be a crop and town pest.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Woodland · Grassland · Farmland · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Most of Qld: common across the west, inland and Gulf country (ssp. normantoni on western Cape York and the south-east Gulf); now widespread on the SEQ and central coasts. Scarce in Wet Tropics rainforest.

BREEDING

Mainly May–Oct (earlier in the north), opportunistically after rain. 2–4 eggs in a tree hollow, sometimes a cliff crevice; often in loose colonies. Both sexes incubate ~25 days.

gymnopis in central, southern and eastern Qld; normantoni on western Cape York and the Gulf plains, intergrading near the south-east Gulf.



ADULT ♂ (♀ RED-BROWN EYE)

NO. LXXVII

Sulphur-crested Cockatoo

Cacatua galerita

CACATUIDAE · COCKATOOS

45–50 cm



NO. LXXVII

BREEDING J F M A **M** **J** **J** **A** **S** **O** **N** **D** May–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Crest** – long sulphur-yellow crest; tips curl up at rest
- **Bill** – large, hooked, grey-black bill
- **Eye** – bare white eye-ring; dark iris (♂)
- **Ear-coverts** – faint pale-yellow wash on cheeks
- **Plumage** – all white; yellow wash under tail

Sexes alike in plumage; at close range the male's iris is dark brown to black and the female's red-brown. Juveniles closely resemble adults. Ssp. fitzroyi of the southern Gulf/NW Qld has a pale blue (not white) bare eye-ring and a slightly longer crest.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats seeds of grasses, herbs and crops, plus nuts, berries, roots, bulbs and insect larvae, often dug from the ground or torn from trees. Pairs and family groups join flocks of tens to hundreds; common to abundant, often a crop and urban pest.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Open forest · Woodland · Farmland · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Throughout Qld wherever there are tall trees: abundant in the east and on Cape York, through the Gulf and along inland watercourses; scarce on treeless downs and in the far south-west. Ssp. fitzroyi in the Gulf west of the Flinders.

BREEDING

May–Sep in the north, Aug–Jan in the south. 1–3 eggs in a large tree hollow prepared by both sexes; both incubate ~30 days; young leave the nest at ~9 weeks.

Nominate galerita across eastern and northern Qld incl. Cape York; fitzroyi (pale blue eye-ring) from the NT east to the Flinders R. and Selwyn Ra.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. LXXVIII

Scaly-breasted Lorikeet

Trichoglossus chlorolepidotus

PSITTACULIDAE · LORIKEETS

22–24 cm

NO. LXXVIII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Aug-Feb

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – all-green head; no blue or red
- **Bill** – bright coral-red, hooked bill
- **Breast** – yellow crescents scale green breast and neck
- **Eye** – orange-red iris; narrow grey eye-ring
- **Tail** – long, pointed, all-green tail

Sexes alike. Adult bright green with heavy yellow scaling on the breast and neck, red bill and orange-red iris; orange-red underwing coverts show only in flight. Juvenile duller, with less yellow scaling, a brownish-orange bill and brown iris.

BEHAVIOUR

Feeds on nectar and pollen of eucalypts, melaleucas, bottlebrushes, banksias and umbrella trees, plus fruit, seeds and insects. In pairs or noisy flocks, often with Rainbow Lorikeets, which can crowd it out at feeders. Sedentary but local numbers track flowering.



Eastern seaboard

Open forest | Woodland | Heath | Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Eastern Qld from Cooktown and the Atherton Tableland south along the coast and ranges to the NSW border, inland to the eastern Brigalow Belt; sparse north through Cape York to the tip. Commonest in SE coastal lowlands.

BREEDING

Mainly Aug–Feb. 2 eggs on decayed wood in a eucalypt hollow 3–25 m up; female incubates ~24 days while the male feeds her; young fledge at ~6 weeks.

Monotypic. Wild hybrids with Rainbow Lorikeet occur occasionally.



ADULT ♂ (♀ LESS BLUE ON CROWN) NO. LXXIX

Musk Lorikeet

Glossopsitta concinna

PSITTACULIDAE · LORIKEETS

20–23 cm



NO. LXXIX

BREEDING J F M A M J J **A S O N D** Aug–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Face** – red forehead and band through eye to ear
- **Crown** – blue crown patch (smaller in ♀)
- **Breast** – yellow patch on side of breast
- **Bill** – black bill with red tip
- **Nape** – bronze-olive wash on nape and mantle

Sexes similar; the female has less blue on the crown and is slightly duller. Juvenile duller overall, with less extensive red on the face, little or no blue on the crown and a brownish bill. In flight all show a golden-yellow underside to the tail.

BEHAVIOUR

Feeds mainly on eucalypt nectar and pollen taken with a brush-tipped tongue; also fruit, seeds, insects and larvae, and sometimes orchard fruit. Gregarious and noisy, often with other lorikeets; nomadic, following flowering. Uncommon in Qld.



South-east & central-east

Open forest · Woodland · Rivers & creeks · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Uncommon in far south-east Qld, mostly south of 27°S: Granite Belt, Border Rivers and Darling Downs east to Main Range, Scenic Rim and the Brisbane–Gold Coast hinterland; sparse north to Gympie and the Bunya Mtns.

BREEDING

Aug–Jan. 2 white eggs on chewed wood in a hollow of a living eucalypt, often near water, entered by a tiny hole; female incubates ~22 days; young fledge at ~7 weeks.

Nominate concinna on the mainland incl. Qld; didimus in Tasmania. AviList 2025 moves it to Trichoglossus (T. concinnus).



ADULT ♂ (♀ DULLER)

NO. LXXX

Little Lorikeet

Parvipsitta pusilla

PSITTACULIDAE · LORIKEETS

15–18 cm



NO. LXXX

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D — May–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Face** – red forehead, lores, eye-surround and throat
- **Bill** – small, all-black bill
- **Eye** – golden or orange-yellow iris
- **Nape** – bronze-olive wash on nape and mantle
- **Body** – bright green; yellower green below

Sexes nearly alike; female slightly duller, with less extensive red. Juvenile duller, with a paler orange-red face, brown iris and brownish bill. In flight all show yellowish-green underwings and a green tail. Smallest of the Australian lorikeets.

BEHAVIOUR

Feeds on nectar and pollen of eucalypts, melaleucas, bloodwoods and angophoras, plus fruit such as mistletoe berries. Usually in small, fast flocks, often mixed with other lorikeets; nomadic, following flowering. Uncommon to locally common.



Eastern Queensland

Open forest · Woodland · Rivers & creeks · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Eastern Qld from the Atherton Tableland and Mt Molloy south to the NSW border, on the coast, ranges and inland slopes of the Great Dividing Range; patchy and nomadic in the north, more regular in the south-east.

BREEDING

May–Nov in the north, Jun–Jan in the south. 3–5 (usually 4) eggs on decayed wood in a small eucalypt hollow; female incubates ~3 weeks.

Monotypic. IOC uses Parvipsitta; BirdLife Australia retains Glossopsitta pusilla; AviList 2025 uses Psitteuteles pusillus.



ADULT ♂ (♀ SLIGHTLY DULLER) NO. LXXXI

Swift Parrot

Lathamus discolor

PSITTACULIDAE · OLD WORLD PARROTS

c. 25 cm; slim, with long pointed tail



NO. LXXXI

BREEDING J F M A M J J A **S O N D** Sep–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Face** – crimson forehead, chin and throat, edged yellow
- **Crown** – dull violet-blue crown patch
- **Shoulder** – red patch at bend of wing
- **Wing** – blue wing coverts; dark blue flight feathers
- **Tail** – long, slender, pointed; dull red above

Male bright green with crimson forehead, chin and throat bordered yellow, blue crown, red shoulder, red underwing coverts and red undertail. Female slightly duller, with less red on the face and a pale underwing bar. Juvenile duller still, with a brown (not pale) iris.

BEHAVIOUR

Feeds mainly on eucalypt nectar and lerps (sugary psyllid covers), plus some seeds and fruit, in the outer canopy. Highly nomadic, tracking flowering across the winter range in small flocks, often with lorikeets. In QLD usually only a few birds in most winters.



South-east & central-east

Open forest · Woodland · Parks & gardens

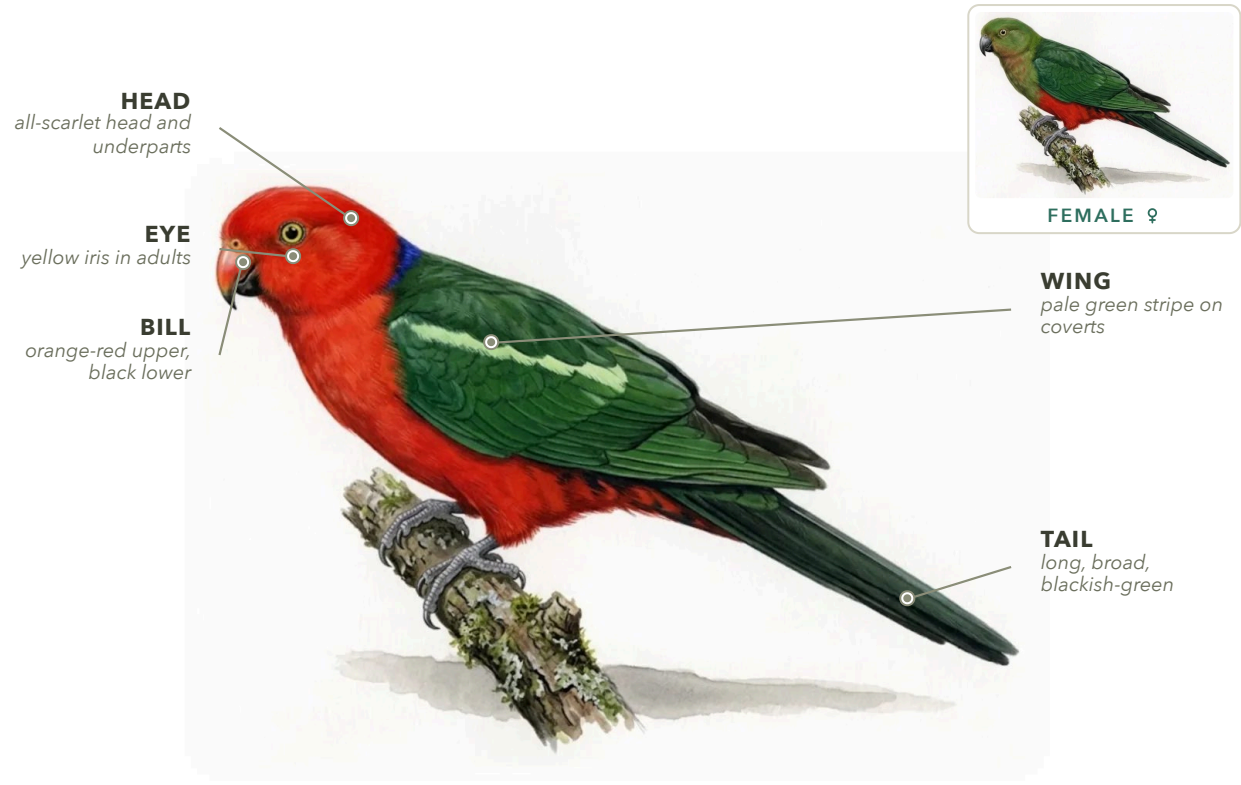
DISTRIBUTION

Rare, irregular winter visitor (May–Sep, mostly Jun–Aug) to south-east QLD: Brisbane, Logan, Ipswich, Gold Coast, Toowoomba and the Southern Downs; strays north to Bundaberg. Numbers vary greatly between years.

BREEDING

Tasmania only, Sep–Jan, mainly on the east and south-east coasts. Nests in hollows of old eucalypts; usually 3–5 white eggs (max 6). Does not breed in QLD.

Monotypic: one freely interbreeding migratory population across Tasmania and the mainland.



ADULT ♂ (♀ GREEN-HEADED) NO. LXXXII

Australian King-Parrot

Alisterus scapularis

PSITTACULIDAE · OLD WORLD PARROTS

41–43 cm; far-northern birds smaller



NO. LXXXII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A **S O N D** Sep–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – all-scarlet head, neck and underparts (♂)
- **Bill** – orange-red upper mandible; black lower mandible
- **Eye** – yellow iris in adults; brown in juveniles
- **Wing** – deep green; pale green stripe on coverts
- **Tail** – long, broad, blackish-green

Male: scarlet head, neck and underparts, blue band on hindneck, blue rump, pale green shoulder stripe, orange-red and black bill, yellow iris. Female: green head and breast, red belly and undertail, dark grey bill, small or no shoulder stripe. Juvenile like female, with brown iris.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats seeds, fruit, berries, nuts, blossoms and buds, mostly in trees but also on the ground; raids orchards and visits feeders. In pairs or small family groups, larger flocks in autumn–winter. Common in SEQ; tame around habitation.



Eastern seaboard

Rainforest · Wet forest · Open forest · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Coast and ranges from Mt Amos near Cooktown south through the Wet Tropics uplands, Paluma, Eungella and the central-east ranges to SEQ and the NSW border; inland to Carnarvon Gorge, the Bunya Mts and Darling Downs.

BREEDING

Sep–Jan. Deep hollow in a large tree, eggs laid on wood dust far below the entrance; up to 6 white eggs (usually ~5); female incubates ~20 days; young fledge at ~5 weeks.

Smaller minor in NE QLD uplands (Mt Amos to the Paluma Ra); nominate scapularis from central QLD south.



ADULT ♂ (♀ GREEN-BACKED)

NO. LXXXIII

Red-winged Parrot

Aprosmictus erythropterus

PSITTACULIDAE · OLD WORLD PARROTS

31–33 cm

NO. LXXXIII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D — Mainly Aug–Feb

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – bright lime-green head and underparts
- **Mantle** – black back and scapulars (♂)
- **Wing** – large scarlet patch on wing coverts
- **Bill** – coral-red bill; orange-red iris
- **Tail** – green, square-ended; narrow yellow tip

Male: lime-green with black mantle and scapulars, deep blue rump, large scarlet wing patch, red bill and eye. Female: duller green including the back, red reduced to a narrow strip along the wing edge, paler blue rump. Juvenile female-like, with yellowish bill and pale brown eye.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats seeds of eucalypts, acacias and hopbush, plus mistletoe berries, fruit, nectar, blossoms and insects, mostly in the canopy, sometimes on the ground. In pairs or small parties, larger flocks after breeding; partly nomadic. Fairly common.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Woodland · Rivers & creeks · Arid scrub · Mangroves

DISTRIBUTION

Widespread over most of QLD, from Cape York and the Gulf across the inland to the Mulga Lands and Darling Downs; scarce on the SEQ coast and in Wet Tropics rainforest, and sparse in the far south-west Channel Country.

BREEDING

Mainly Aug–Feb, earlier (Apr–Jul) in the far north. Deep hollow in a living or dead tree, often near water; 3–6 white eggs; female incubates while the male feeds her.

Nominate erythropterus in eastern and inland QLD; coccineopterus on Cape York and in the Gulf country west to the Kimberley.



ADULT ♂ (♀ DULLER)

NO. LXXXIV

Australian Ringneck

Barnardius zonarius

PSITTACULIDAE · OLD WORLD PARROTS

c. 33–37 cm; long tail



NO. LXXXIV

BREEDING J F M A M J J **A S O N D** Mainly Aug–Dec

DESCRIPTION

- **Forehead** – narrow red band (absent in Cloncurry form)
- **Collar** – yellow band across the hindneck
- **Mantle** – dark slaty blue-black back
- **Belly** – irregular orange-yellow band across belly
- **Wing** – pale yellow-green coverts; blue outer wing

Mallee male: green head, red forehead band, yellow hind-collar, dark blue-black mantle, orange-yellow belly band. Female duller, with greyer olive-tinged mantle, often a pale underwing bar. Juvenile duller still, with wing bar. Cloncurry form: no red band, paler, broad yellow belly.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats seeds of grasses, herbs and trees, plus fruit, blossoms, nectar, insect larvae and spilt grain, feeding mostly on the ground. Usually in pairs or small family groups; resident or locally nomadic. Common along inland watercourses.



Western & central-west inland

Rivers & creeks · Woodland · Arid scrub · Spinifex

DISTRIBUTION

Mallee Ringneck across the south-west and central-west (Mulga Lands, Channel Country margins), east to St George–Goondiwindi and north to Longreach–Winton; Cloncurry Ringneck in the north-west, Mt Isa–Cloncurry to Boulia.

BREEDING

Mainly Aug–Dec, often triggered by rain; earlier (Jun–Jul) in the north. Hollow in a living or dead eucalypt; 4–6 white eggs; female incubates ~20 days.

Mallee Ringneck barnardi (south-west to central-west) and Cloncurry Ringneck macgillivrayi (north-west); intermediates where they meet.



ADULT ♂ (♀ DULLER)

NO. LXXXV

Eastern Rosella

Platycercus eximius

PSITTACULIDAE · OLD WORLD PARROTS

28–32 cm



NO. LXXXV

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Aug–Feb

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – bright red head, neck and upper breast
- **Cheek** – clean white cheek patch
- **Breast** – yellow lower breast; pale green belly
- **Mantle** – black feathers edged golden-yellow, scalloped
- **Wing** – violet-blue shoulder and outer wing

Male: red head and breast, white cheeks, yellow lower breast, pale green belly, red undertail, black back edged gold, blue wings. Female similar but duller, with less intense red and usually a pale underwing bar. Juvenile duller still, with green on the nape and an underwing bar.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats grass and weed seeds, eucalypt and acacia seed, fruit, buds, flowers, nectar and insects, mostly on the ground. In pairs or small flocks, larger groups after breeding. Locally common on the Granite Belt; scarce elsewhere in QLD.



South-east & central-east

Woodland · Farmland · Parks & gardens

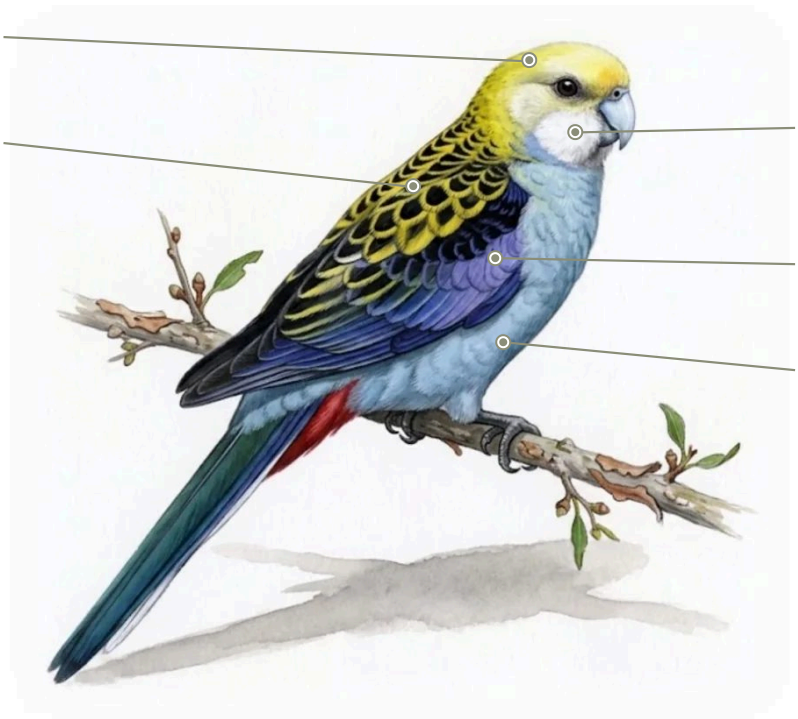
DISTRIBUTION

South-east QLD only: commonest on the Granite Belt and Southern Downs (Stanthorpe–Warwick) and west along the Border Rivers to about Goondiwindi; also the Scenic Rim and McPherson Ra; scattered birds farther north.

BREEDING

Aug–Feb. Tree hollow, sometimes a stump, post or nest box; 4–8 (usually 5) white eggs; female incubates ~19 days while the male feeds her.

QLD birds are elecica ('Golden-mantled Rosella', NE NSW–SE QLD); nominate eximius farther south; diemenensis in Tasmania.



ADULT ♂ SOUTHERN SSP. (♀ DULLER) NO. LXXXVI

Pale-headed Rosella

Platycercus adscitus

PSITTACULIDAE · OLD WORLD PARROTS

28–34 cm



NO. LXXXVI

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Mainly Sep–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – pale lemon to creamy white; no red
- **Cheek** – white patch; blue lower edge in far north
- **Mantle** – black feathers edged yellow; scalloped
- **Shoulder** – violet-blue shoulder and wing edge
- **Underparts** – pale blue breast and belly; red vent

Sexes similar; female slightly smaller and duller and keeps a pale underwing bar that adult males lack. Juvenile duller, with scattered orange-red feathers on the head and a yellowish to brownish bill; full adult plumage is attained in the second year.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats seeds of grasses, thistles and trees, plus fruit, flowers, insects and larvae; feeds mostly on the ground in shade, also in shrubs and trees. Usually in pairs or family parties. Common and largely sedentary; has adapted well to farmland and suburbs.



Eastern Queensland

Woodland · Rivers & creeks · Farmland · Parks & gardens

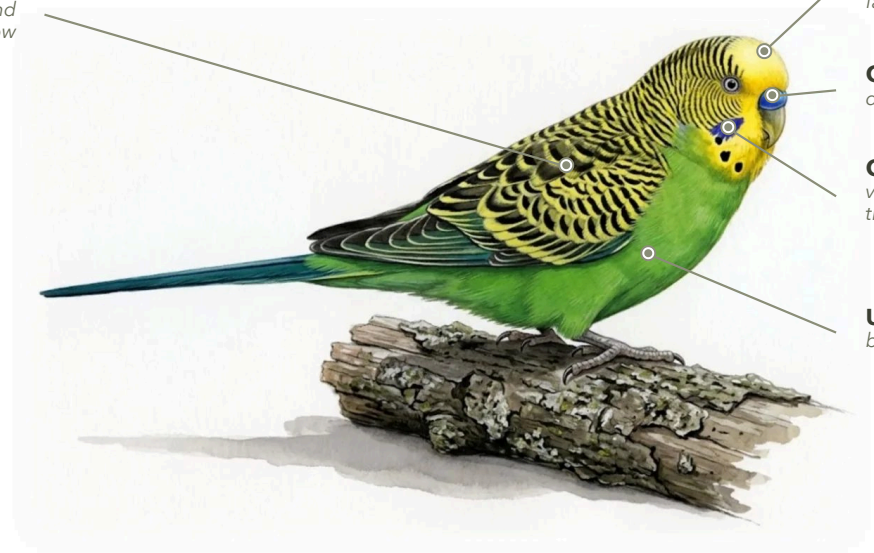
DISTRIBUTION

Eastern half of Qld, from the tip of Cape York to the NSW border; west to the Gulf country (Croydon–Normanton) in the north and to about Charleville inland in the south. Absent from the arid south-west.

BREEDING

South: mainly Sep–Jan; Cape York (nominate) mainly Feb–Jun. Lays 4–8 white eggs on wood dust in a deep tree hollow, often near water; female incubates ~19 days.

Nominate adscitus on Cape York (to ~Cooktown); palliceps from ~Mackay south; broad intergrade zone between. Sometimes lumped with Eastern Rosella.



ADULT ♂ (♀ CERE PALE/BROWN) NO. LXXXVII

Budgerigar

Melopsittacus undulatus

PSITTACULIDAE · OLD WORLD PARROTS

17–18 cm

NO. LXXXVII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D — **Any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Face** – yellow forehead, face and throat; unbarred
- **Cheek** – violet-blue spot; black throat spots
- **Cere** – deep blue in ♂; pale blue/brown in ♀
- **Upperparts** – barred black and yellow; nape to wings
- **Underparts** – bright grass-green; long blue-green tail

Plumage alike. Adult ♂ cere deep blue; ♀ cere pale blue-white, turning buff-brown when breeding. Adults have a pale iris ring. Juvenile duller, with barring down to the cere, all-dark eyes and small throat spots; young males have a pinkish-violet cere.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats seeds of grasses and herbs such as spinifex and saltbush, taken mostly from the ground. Gregarious, in flocks of a few to 100+, at times tens of thousands. Drinks often, mainly in the morning. Abundant but erratic, moving with rain.



Western & central-west inland

Grassland · Spinifex · Arid scrub · Woodland

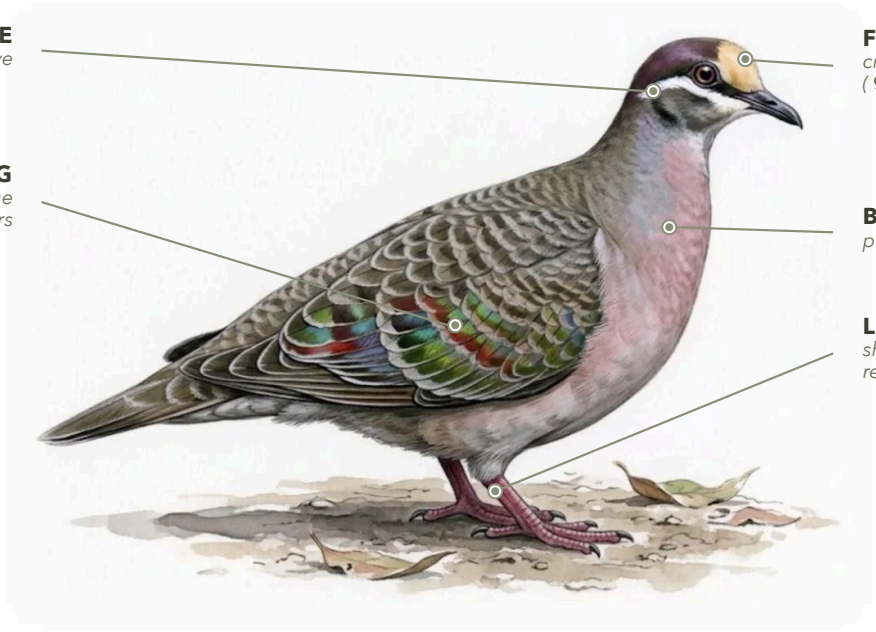
DISTRIBUTION

Inland and western Qld: Channel Country, Mitchell Grass Downs, Mulga Lands and Gulf plains, reaching east to the Brigalow Belt and Darling Downs in good seasons. Birds near the coast are mostly escaped cage birds.

BREEDING

Breeds whenever rain brings seeding grass; can raise several broods. Lays 4–8 white eggs in a bare hollow in a tree, stump or log; female incubates; young fledge at ~35 days.

Monotypic. Wild birds are uniformly green-and-yellow across Australia; all other colours are captive mutations.



ADULT ♂ (♀ GREY FOREHEAD) NO. LXXXVIII

Common Bronzewing

Phaps chalcoptera

COLUMBIDAE · PIGEONS & DOVES

30–36 cm



NO. LXXXVIII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D — **Mainly Aug–Jan; any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Forehead** – cream-buff in ♂; grey in ♀
- **Face** – white line under eye; dark eye-stripe
- **Breast** – pinkish-grey in ♂; greyer in ♀
- **Wing** – metallic green, blue and copper bars
- **Legs** – short and pinkish-red

Male has a cream-buff forehead, purplish-brown crown and pinkish-grey breast. Female duller, with a grey forehead and a greyer, less pink breast. Both sexes have a white line under the eye. Juvenile duller and browner, with little or no metallic sheen in the wing.

BEHAVIOUR

Feeds on the ground on seeds of acacias, grasses, herbs and weeds, plus some leaves. Usually alone, in pairs or small groups; drinks regularly, often at dusk. Common and widespread; tolerates cleared land wherever some shrub cover remains.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Open forest · Woodland · Heath · Farmland

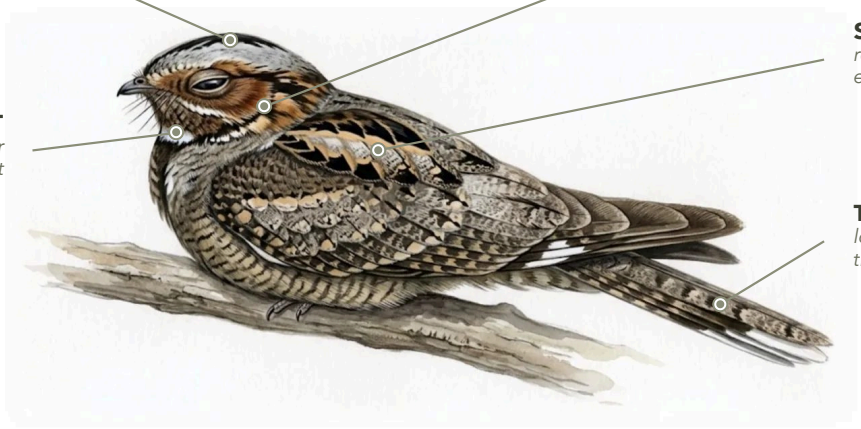
DISTRIBUTION

Throughout Qld in suitable habitat, from the NSW border north to southern Cape York and west to the NT border. Scarce on northern Cape York and in the Wet Tropics; absent from dense rainforest and treeless plains.

BREEDING

Mainly Aug–Jan but can breed in any month. Two white eggs on a flimsy stick platform, usually low in a tree or shrub; both sexes incubate for ~15 days.

Monotypic; no geographic subspecies recognised.



ADULT ♂ (♀ BUFF TAIL SPOTS) NO. LXXXIX

Large-tailed Nightjar

Caprimulgus macrurus

CAPRIMULGIDAE · NIGHTJARS

25–29 cm



NO. LXXXIX

BREEDING J F M A M J J **A S O N D** Aug–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Crown** – greyish; bold dark central streak
- **Ear patch** – rich rufous-brown ear-coverts
- **Throat** – white patch on lower throat
- **Scapulars** – row of black feathers edged buff
- **Tail** – long; ♂ broad white outer tips

Male has large white patches on the outer primaries and broad white tips to the outer tail feathers. Female very similar but slightly paler, with smaller buff wing patches and narrower buff tail tips. Juvenile paler and buffier, with dusky, indistinct tail patches.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats flying insects (moths, beetles, crickets, termite swarms), caught in sallies from a low perch or in flight over clearings, roads and around lights. Solitary or in pairs; sedentary and territorial. Common within its range.



Northern & eastern coastal wetlands

Rainforest · Wetlands · Mangroves · Woodland

DISTRIBUTION

Coastal and subcoastal N and E Qld: Torres Strait and Cape York Peninsula (west coast south to the Norman River), through the Wet Tropics to Mackay–Sarina; sparse south to Fraser Coast, recently Sunshine Coast–Moreton Bay.

BREEDING

Mainly Aug–Jan in Qld. No nest: 1–2 pinkish-buff, sparsely marked eggs laid on bare ground or leaf litter, often in shade. Both sexes incubate.

C. m. schlegelii in Qld (and NT, New Guinea); yorki is a synonym. IOC has split off Andaman, Mees's and Jerdon's nightjars.



ADULT GREY MORPH (♀ MAY BE RUFOUS) NO. XC

Australian Owlet-nightjar

Aegotheles cristatus

AEGOTHELIDAE · OWLET-NIGHTJARS

21–25 cm



NO. XC

BREEDING J F M A M J J **A S O N D** Aug-Dec

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – two black crown bands; meet on nape
- **Eye** – large, dark brown; no eyeshine
- **Bill** – tiny; hidden in fine whisker bristles
- **Underparts** – whitish, finely barred grey
- **Tail** – long, finely barred grey and dusky

Sexes similar. Grey morph commonest; a rufous (russet-brown) morph occurs mostly in females, mainly in northern and inland Australia, and grey females are often rufous-tinged. Juvenile like adult, with blurred face and nape bands and more spotting.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats insects, chiefly beetles, grasshoppers and ants, caught in short sallies from a perch or snatched from the ground and foliage. Usually alone or in pairs, holding territories year-round. Common, but heard far more often than seen.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Open forest · Woodland · Arid scrub · Farmland

DISTRIBUTION

Throughout Qld, from the NSW border to the tip of Cape York and west to the NT border, including the arid south-west; anywhere with trees old enough to hold hollows. Common but seldom seen.

BREEDING

Mainly Aug–Dec, one brood. Lays 3–4 (2–5) white eggs on a bed of green leaves in a tree hollow or crevice; incubation ~4 weeks; young fledge at ~4 weeks.

A. c. cristatus throughout Qld (also S New Guinea); tasmanicus in Tasmania. Desert birds are paler.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. XCI

White-faced Heron

Egretta novaehollandiae

ARDEIDAE · HERONS & EGRETS

60–70 cm; ~500–550 g

NO. XCI

BREEDING J F M A M J J **A S O N D** **Mainly Aug–Dec; any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Face** – white face; forehead, cheeks and chin
- **Bill** – slender, pointed, grey-black bill
- **Body** – pale blue-grey; flight feathers darker
- **Breast** – buff-chestnut plumes; brightest when breeding
- **Legs** – long, dull olive-yellow

Sexes alike; female slightly smaller. Adult: white face, pale blue-grey body, grey back plumes and buff-chestnut breast plumes, longer and brighter when breeding, when the legs flush pinkish-orange. Juvenile duller, with little or no white on the face, a pinkish-buff wash below and no plumes.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats fish, frogs, insects, crustaceans and worms, stalking slowly, standing and waiting, or stirring the bottom with a foot. Usually alone or in pairs; loose flocks gather on flooded ground after rain. Common and widespread throughout Queensland.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Wetlands · Coast & mudflats · Mangroves · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Throughout Queensland, from Torres Strait and Cape York to the Channel Country and the NSW border, wherever there is water – coast, inland rivers, bores and claypans. The most frequently seen heron statewide.

BREEDING

Mostly Aug–Dec, but recorded in almost any month after rain. Usually solitary. Untidy stick platform 4–40 m up in a tree. Clutch 3–5 blue-green eggs; both sexes incubate.

Usually treated as monotypic. Also occurs in New Zealand, New Guinea, New Caledonia and eastern Indonesia.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. XCII

White-necked Heron

Ardea pacifica

ARDEIDAE · HERONS & EGRETS

76–106 cm; 650–900 g

NO. XCII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D — **Mainly Sep–Mar; any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Neck** – white; double row of black spots on foreneck
- **Head** – all-white head; greenish-yellow eye
- **Back** – slate-black; maroon plumes when breeding
- **Bill** – long, dagger-like, black
- **Legs** – long, black legs and feet

Sexes alike; female averages smaller. Adult: white head and neck with a double row of black spots down the foreneck, slate-black body, dark underparts streaked white. Breeding: maroon plumes on back and breast. Juvenile: neck washed grey, heavier spotting, no plumes.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats frogs, fish, crustaceans, insects and small reptiles, walking slowly or standing in shallow water and wet grass, then lunging. Usually single or in pairs, defending feeding spots; flocks form at flooded sites. Common but nomadic.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Wetlands · Farmland · Grassland

DISTRIBUTION

Throughout Queensland, from Cape York and the Gulf plains to the Channel Country, Darling Downs and SEQ. Nomadic, flocking to inland floodplains after rain; most numerous in the south and centre-west.

BREEDING

Any month after good rain; mostly Sep–Feb in the south, Dec–Mar in the north. Loose stick platform in a tree over water, alone or in colonies. Clutch usually 4 (2–6).

Monotypic; breeds only in Australia. Alternative name Pacific Heron.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. XCIII

Pied Heron

Egretta picata

ARDEIDAE · HERONS & EGRETS

43–55 cm; 225–280 g



NO. XCIII

BREEDING J **F** **M** **A** M J J A S O N D **Mainly Feb–Apr**

DESCRIPTION

- **Cap** – dark slate cap; drooping nape plumes
- **Neck** – white throat and neck; sharply defined
- **Bill** – yellow, dagger-shaped; dusky base
- **Body** – dark slate-blue body and wings
- **Legs** – yellow to orange-yellow

Sexes alike; male slightly heavier. Adult: dark slate cap with nape plumes, white throat and neck, slate-blue body. In courtship bill and legs turn bright yellow and the eye orange-red. Immature: white head without cap or crest, browner back; kept for over a year.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats mainly insects, also small fish, frogs and crustaceans, gleaning from vegetation, stabbing in shallow water or following cattle. Often in loose flocks and mixed egret aggregations; uses rice fields, sewage ponds and tips. Common in the Gulf.



Northern & eastern coastal wetlands

Wetlands · Coast & mudflats · Mangroves

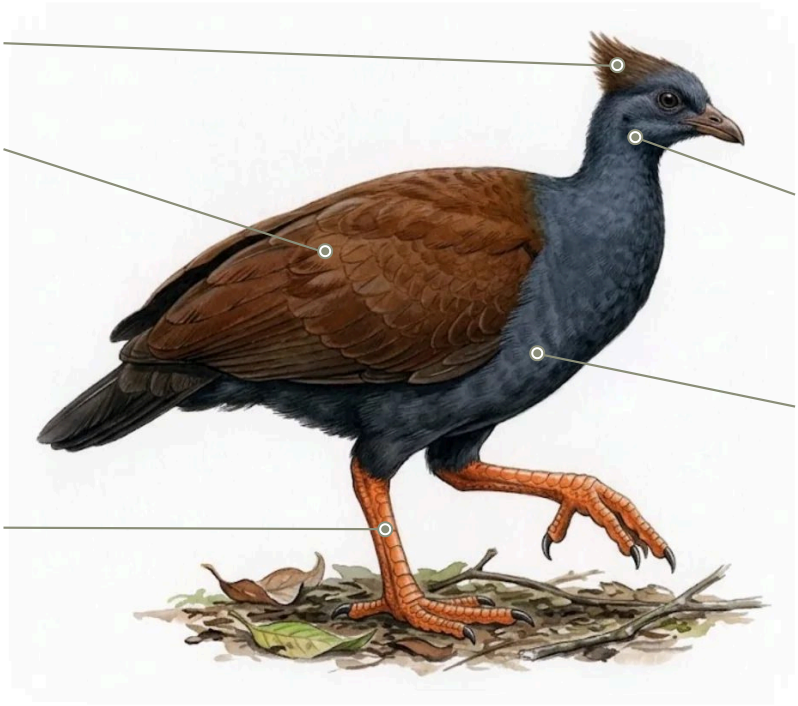
DISTRIBUTION

Coastal and subcoastal wetlands of the Gulf of Carpentaria, Cape York and Torres Strait; sparse down the east coast to about Townsville and Broad Sound, vagrant further south. Moves inland to swamps in the wet.

BREEDING

Mainly Feb–Apr in the late wet season (Jan–Jun). Colonial, in mangroves with other waterbirds. Small stick platform 2–5 m above water; clutch 2–4 blue-green eggs.

Monotypic. Sometimes placed in Ardea. Also occurs in New Guinea and Wallacea.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. XCIV

Orange-footed Scrubfowl

Megapodius reinwardt

MEGAPODIIDAE · MOUND-BUILDERS

42–47 cm; ~0.9 kg



NO. XCIV

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D **Jul–Mar**

DESCRIPTION

- **Crest** – short, pointed brown crest; rear crown
- **Head** – small; dark slate-grey head and neck
- **Back** – rich chestnut-brown back and wings
- **Underparts** – dark slate-grey breast and belly
- **Legs** – massive orange legs; big feet

Sexes alike; female slightly smaller. Adult: dark slate-grey head, neck and underparts, short pointed brown crest, chestnut-brown back and wings, short dark tail, orange legs. Juvenile: smaller and duller, browner, with a reduced crest. Chicks are fully feathered and independent.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats seeds, fallen fruit, roots and invertebrates such as snails and beetles, raking deep into leaf litter. Sedentary pairs hold territories year-round, advertising with loud calls, often at night. Common in the Wet Tropics; tame around Cairns.



Northern & eastern coastal wetlands

Rainforest · Vine scrub · Mangroves · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Torres Strait and Cape York Peninsula south through the Wet Tropics and coastal north Queensland to the Whitsundays, Mackay district and about Yeppoon; also many offshore islands. Mainly lowlands.

BREEDING

Mainly Jul–Mar. Pairs build and tend a huge mound of soil, sand and litter, warmed by decomposition; eggs are buried in it at intervals through the season. No parental care.

Qld birds: yorki (Cape York) and castanonotus (Cooktown–Yeppoon; chestnut back); tumulus in NT and WA. Limits debated.



ADULT ♂ (♀ CREAM-THROATED) NO. XCV

Stubble Quail

Coturnix pectoralis

PHASIANIDAE · QUAILS & PHEASANTS

16–20 cm; 75–125 g



NO. XCV

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D — **Mainly Aug–Apr; any month**

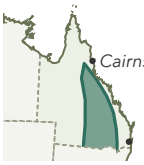
DESCRIPTION

- **Throat** – ♂ orange-buff face and throat; ♀ cream
- **Breast** – ♂ black central patch; white streaks
- **Upperparts** – grey-brown; bold cream-white shaft streaks
- **Head** – pale crown stripe and eyebrow
- **Legs** – pale pinkish legs and feet

Male: orange-buff face and throat, black central breast patch and black-streaked flanks, all crossed by white shaft streaks. Female: slightly larger, cream throat, breast buff with dark spotting and no black patch. Juvenile like female but duller and more mottled.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats seeds, grain, green shoots and some insects, scratching on the ground by day. In pairs or small coveys; highly nomadic, moving with rainfall and crop growth. Common in good seasons on the Darling Downs; reluctant to fly until flushed.



Inland eastern Queensland

Grassland Farmland

DISTRIBUTION

Mainly southern and central Queensland: Darling Downs, Brigalow Belt and central highlands west to the Mitchell-grass downs and Channel Country. Nomadic and irruptive after rain; scarce in the tropical north.

BREEDING

Aug–Apr, or any month after rain. Grass-lined scrape in tussock grass or crop, hidden by pulled-over grass. Clutch 5–14; female incubates about 21 days.

Monotypic; endemic to Australia. Also called Pectoral Quail or Grey Quail.



ADULT ♂ (♀ BLOTCHED BLACK ABOVE) NO. XCVI

Brown Quail

Synoicus ypsilophorus

PHASIANIDAE · QUAILS & PHEASANTS

17–22 cm; 80–140 g

NO. XCVI

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D — **Mainly Sep–Mar; any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Plumage** – rich brown; fine black wavy barring
- **Back** – thin white shaft streaks on brown
- **Eye** – iris red to orange-yellow
- **Bill** – short, stout, blackish-grey
- **Legs** – orange-yellow legs and feet

Sexes similar; colour varies from grey-brown to rufous. Male: plainer, finely barred below with wavy black chevrons. Female: upperparts with large black blotches and bolder white streaks, flanks more boldly barred. Juvenile duller and more mottled.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats grass and weed seeds, green shoots and insects, foraging on the ground under cover, mainly early and late in the day. Pairs and family coveys; sedentary or locally nomadic, keeping to a home range. Common in SEQ and coastal grasslands.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Grassland · Wetlands · Heath · Woodland

DISTRIBUTION

Widespread in coastal and subcoastal Queensland, from Torres Strait and Cape York through the Gulf country and the whole east coast to SEQ; also inland in wetter grasslands. Sparse in the arid south-west.

BREEDING

Mostly spring–summer in the south and the wet season in the north, or after rain. Grass-lined scrape hidden in a tussock. Clutch 7–12; female incubates about 21 days.

Mainland ssp. australis; nominate ypsilophorus in Tasmania. Formerly Coturnix ypsilophora.



ADULT ♀ (♂ PALE-FACED) NO. XCVII

Black-breasted Button-quail

Turnix melanogaster

TURNICIDAE · BUTTONQUAILS

17–19 cm; ♀ larger

NO. XCVII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Sep-Apr

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – ♀ black face and throat; white-flecked
- **Breast** – ♀ black, with bold white crescents
- **Eye** – pale white-to-cream iris
- **Upperparts** – chestnut, streaked and spotted white
- **Legs** – bright yellow legs and feet

Reversed dimorphism. Female larger: black face, throat and breast, the breast boldly marked with white crescents; chestnut upperparts streaked white. Male smaller: whitish face and throat speckled black, breast scalloped black and white, far less black. Juvenile like a dull male.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats beetles, ants, earwigs and other invertebrates, pivot-feeding in deep leaf litter. Females hold territories of about 2–10 ha. In pairs or small groups; sedentary, secretive and reluctant to fly. Uncommon and very patchily distributed.



South-east & central-east

Vine scrub

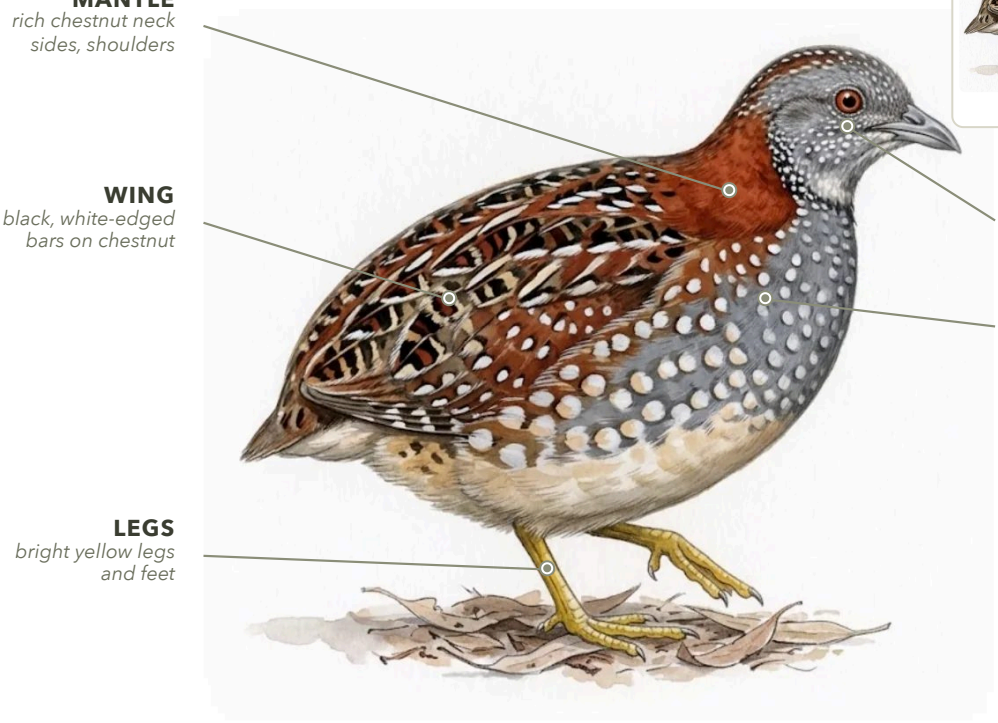
DISTRIBUTION

South-east Qld (and far NE NSW): from Byfield near Rockhampton south to the Border Ranges, west to Palmgrove NP, Barakula SF and the Bunya Mountains, east to Cooloola and K'gari. Patchy.

BREEDING

Mainly Sep–Apr, linked to rain. Leaf- or moss-lined scrape hidden at a tree base or under a shrub. Clutch 3-4 (to 5); the male alone incubates, for about 2–3 weeks.

Monotypic; endemic to SE Qld and NE NSW. Listed as Black-breasted Button-quail. NSW Critically Endangered (2026 review proposes Vulnerable).



ADULT ♀ (♂ DULLER, SMALLER) NO. XCVIII

Painted Button-quail

Turnix varius

TURNICIDAE · BUTTON-QUAILS

17–23 cm; ♀ larger

NO. XCVIII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Aug–Feb

DESCRIPTION

- **Eye** – orange-red iris; stout grey bill
- **Mantle** – rich chestnut neck sides, shoulders
- **Breast** – grey, boldly spotted white
- **Wing** – black, white-edged bars on chestnut
- **Legs** – bright yellow legs and feet

Reversed dimorphism. Female larger and brighter, with rich chestnut on the neck sides, shoulders and back. Male smaller and duller, the chestnut largely replaced by buff and grey-brown. Both have red eyes and grey breasts spotted white. Juvenile duller, more mottled.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats seeds, fallen fruit, leaves and insects, raking the litter by spinning on alternate legs. Active mainly at dusk, night and early morning; usually in pairs or small family parties. Resident or locally dispersive; fairly common but easily overlooked.



Eastern Queensland

Open forest · Woodland

DISTRIBUTION

Eastern QLD from the NSW border north through the south-east, Darling Downs and Brigalow Belt to the Mackay hinterland, and on the Atherton Tableland and Einasleigh Uplands; sparse on Cape York, absent from the arid west.

BREEDING

Mainly Aug–Feb. Female builds a domed nest of grass and leaves under a tussock, rock or sapling. Clutch 3–4; the male alone incubates (c. 13 days) and tends the chicks.

Nominate varius throughout QLD; scintillans is confined to the Houtman Abrolhos, WA. IOC/AviList spelling: Painted Buttonquail.



MALE ♂



ADULT ♀ (♂ PALER, BARRED)

NO. XCIX

Red-chested Button-quail

Turnix pyrrhothorax

TURNICIDAE · BUTTON-QUAILS

12–16 cm; ♀ larger

NO. XCIX

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Sep–Jul

DESCRIPTION

- **Eye** – pale cream iris; stout blue-grey bill
- **Face** – orange-buff face and throat
- **Breast** – plain orange-rufous; flanks finely barred
- **Upperparts** – grey-brown, finely streaked buff
- **Legs** – pinkish legs and feet

Reversed dimorphism. Female larger and brighter: rich orange-rufous throat, breast and flanks, flank barring fine and rarely reaching the breast. Male smaller and paler, breast dull orange-buff with bold black bars and crescents on its sides. Juvenile darker above, scalloped breast.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats grass and crop seeds plus insects, scratching and pivoting on one foot in litter and grass. Mostly crepuscular and nocturnal; alone, in pairs or groups of up to five. Partly nomadic; uncommon to locally common, often overlooked.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Grassland · Woodland · Farmland

DISTRIBUTION

Much of QLD: Cape York and the Gulf Plains, Einasleigh Uplands and Burdekin, central QLD, the Darling Downs and south-east grasslands; sparse and erratic in the arid south-west, nomadic after rain.

BREEDING

N QLD mainly Feb–Jul; south Sep–Feb, or after good rain. Female builds a grass-lined scrape under a tussock. Clutch usually 4; male incubates 13–18 days.

Monotypic; endemic to mainland Australia. IOC/AviList spelling: Red-chested Buttonquail.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. C

Eastern Barn Owl

Tyto alba delicatula

TYTONIDAE · BARN & MASKED OWLS

30–39 cm



NO. C

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D **Any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Facial disc** – white, heart-shaped; thin buff rim
- **Eye** – small, dark; pale pinkish bill
- **Upperparts** – grey and golden-buff; fine black-white dots
- **Underparts** – white to cream; sparse small dark spots
- **Legs** – long, feathered halfway; greyish toes

Sexes alike in pattern; females slightly larger. Females tend to be darker and buffier below with more, larger dark flecks; males paler and whiter, but the two overlap widely. Juvenile resembles adult once feathered; nestlings are downy white.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats mainly small mammals, especially introduced house mice and rats, plus some birds, insects, frogs and lizards; locates prey by ear, often from flight. Nocturnal, solitary or in pairs. Moderately common across QLD, rising and falling with rodents.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Grassland · Farmland · Woodland · Rivers & creeks

DISTRIBUTION

Throughout QLD, from Cape York to the NSW border and west to the Channel Country and Gulf; commonest in open farmland, cane fields and grassland, and abundant inland during rodent plagues.

BREEDING

Any month, in response to food; often twice a year. Nest an unlined tree hollow, cave or building cavity. Clutch 3–6, rarely up to 12; female incubates.

BirdLife Aust.: Tyto alba delicatula. IOC/AviList and QLD WildNet treat it as a full species, Eastern Barn Owl Tyto javanica.



ADULT – SEXES SIMILAR; ♀ LARGER NO. CI

Eastern Grass Owl

Tyto longimembris

TYTONIDAE · BARN & MASKED OWLS

32–42 cm; ♀ larger; wingspan 1–1.16 m



NO. CI

BREEDING J F **M** **A** **M** **J** J A S O N D **Mainly Mar–Jun; any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Facial disc** – long heart-shape; whitish to buff
- **Upperparts** – dark chocolate-brown; small pale spots
- **Wing** – golden-buff primaries, barred dark
- **Underparts** – white to buff; few small dark spots
- **Legs** – very long, sparsely feathered, pale

Female larger and darker, with a cream-buff to orange-buff, speckled facial disc and buffier underparts; male has a mostly white disc with white edge and whiter underparts. Juveniles have a darker facial disc than adults and a narrow, pointed outer primary.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats mostly rodents, especially long-haired and cane rats, plus insects and small birds, caught by quartering and hovering over grass at night. Solitary or in pairs; dispersive, numbers fluctuating with rodent plagues. Uncommon and patchy in QLD.



Eastern seaboard

Grassland Wetlands Farmland

DISTRIBUTION

Patchy along the east: Cape York floodplains (Lakefield), Wet Tropics and Atherton Tableland grasslands, Burdekin, Mackay–Proserpine and Wide Bay cane districts and SE QLD; irrupts inland in rat plagues.

BREEDING

Mainly Mar–Jun, but any month after rain and rodent booms. Ground nest: a trampled platform under dense tussock or sedge, entered by tunnels. Clutch 3–8; female incubates.

Australian birds are nominate longimembris. BirdLife Aust. name Eastern Grass Owl; IOC/AviList Australasian Grass Owl.



ADULT PALE MORPH; ♀ LARGER, DARKER NO. CII

Masked Owl

Tyto novaehollandiae

TYTONIDAE · BARN & MASKED OWLS

35–50 cm; ♀ larger; wingspan 0.9–1.2 m



NO. CII

BREEDING J F **M A M J J A** S O N D **Mainly Mar–Aug; any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Facial disc** – rounded; white, rimmed dark brown
- **Eye** – dark eyes in dusky smudges
- **Upperparts** – grey-brown, mottled buff; fine pale spots
- **Underparts** – white to rufous; sparse dark spots
- **Feet** – legs fully feathered; massive feet

Polymorphic: pale (white face and underparts), intermediate and dark (chestnut face, rufous below) forms. Females markedly larger and generally darker, though pale birds are not always males. Fledglings white to cream; first-year birds more heavily marked.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats mainly terrestrial mammals such as rats and bandicoots, plus possums, birds and reptiles, taken from low perches. Pairs sedentary in large territories (1,000 ha or more). Uncommon to rare and sparse in QLD; more often heard than seen.



Eastern seaboard

Open forest | Woodland | Farmland

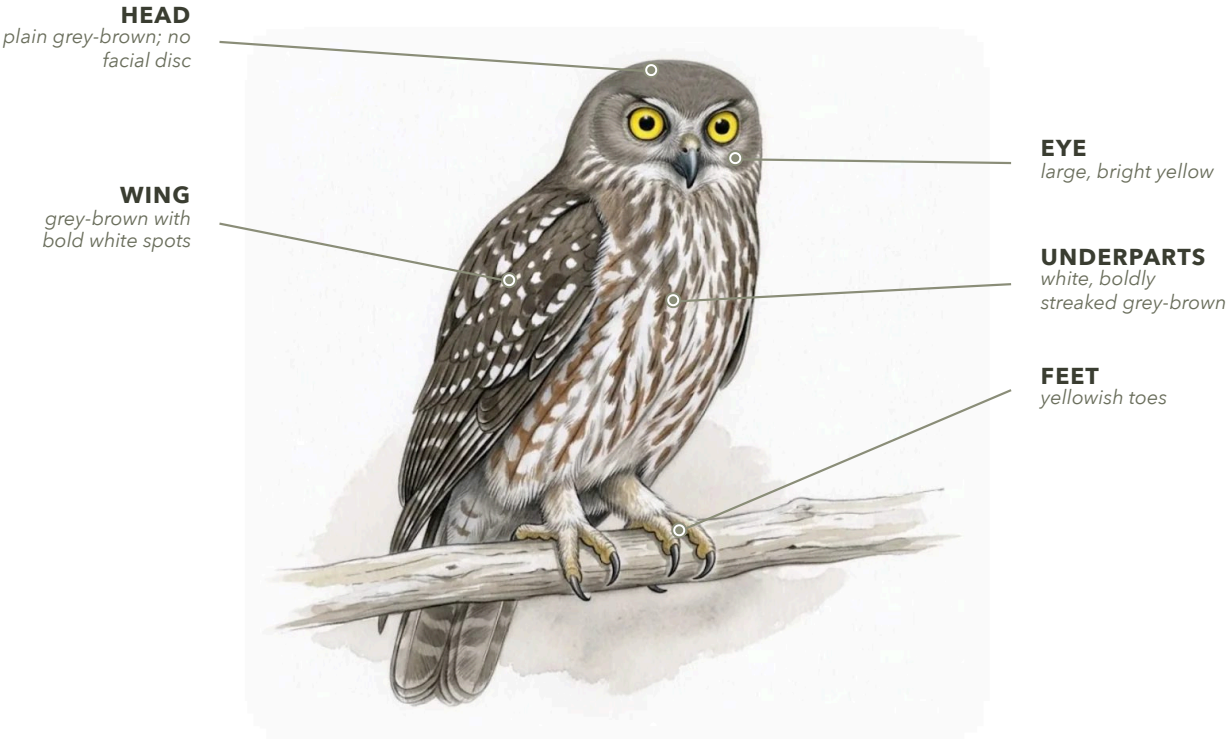
DISTRIBUTION

Coastal and subcoastal eastern QLD, from Cape York through the Wet Tropics, Townsville and Mackay districts to the south-east and NSW border, inland to the Bunya Mts; rare and scattered further west.

BREEDING

Mainly autumn–winter in the east, but whenever food is plentiful. Nest a deep hollow in a large old tree. Clutch 2–3; female incubates (c. 33 days) while male hunts.

QLD: novaehollandiae (south); N QLD birds galei (BirdLife, AFD) but kimberli in WildNet (EPBC & QLD Vulnerable). IOC: Australian Masked Owl.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE; ♂ LARGER NO. CIII

Barking Owl

Ninox connivens

STRIGIDAE · HAWK-OWLS

35–45 cm; wingspan 0.85–1.2 m



NO. CIII

BREEDING J F M A M J **J A S O** N D Jul–Oct

DESCRIPTION

- **Eye** – large, bright yellow
- **Head** – plain grey-brown; no distinct disc
- **Underparts** – white, boldly streaked grey-brown
- **Wing** – grey-brown with bold white spots
- **Feet** – yellowish toes; strong dark talons

Sexes alike in plumage; males slightly heavier and deeper-voiced. Grey-brown above with white wing spots, white below with bold grey-brown streaks; yellow eyes. Juvenile less streaked below, with mottled white and grey-brown hindneck.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats mammals (gliders, bats, rabbits), birds and many insects, mostly insects outside the breeding season; hunts from perches or in flight in the first hours of night and before dawn. Pairs hold territories year-round. Fairly common in N QLD.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Woodland · Rivers & creeks · Farmland

DISTRIBUTION

Widespread in wooded country across Cape York, the Gulf and eastern QLD from the Wet Tropics to the NSW border, and west along inland river systems to the Channel Country; scarce in the arid south-west.

BREEDING

Jul–Sep in the north, Aug–Oct in the south. Nest an open hollow in a large old eucalypt, often near water. Clutch 2–3; female incubates while the male hunts.

QLD: nominate connivens in the south and east, peninsularis in the north, intergrading around the Forsyth Ra.; assimilis in Torres Strait.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. CIV

Singing Honeyeater

Gavicalis virescens

MELIPHAGIDAE · HONEYEATERS

17–24 cm

NO. CIV

BREEDING J F M A M J J **A S O N** D **Mainly Aug–Nov; any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Mask** – black eye-stripe from bill to neck
- **Cheek** – yellow streak below the black mask
- **Breast** – grey-white, streaked grey-brown
- **Wing** – grey-brown; olive-yellow feather edges
- **Bill** – black, slightly down-curved

Sexes alike, female slightly smaller. Grey-brown above with olive-yellow edges to wing and tail feathers; black mask from bill to neck over a yellow streak; whitish throat; grey-white breast streaked brown. Juvenile duller, with a narrower, fainter face pattern and paler crown.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats insects, nectar and fruit, foraging in low shrubs and on the ground, lower than most honeyeaters. Usually alone, in pairs or small noisy groups; aggressive towards other birds. Sedentary; common to abundant in inland QLD.



Western & central-west inland

Arid scrub · Woodland · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Inland QLD west of the Great Divide: Channel Country, Mitchell-grass downs, Mulga Lands and Mt Isa uplands, east to the western Darling Downs and Brigalow Belt and north to the Gulf; absent from the east coast.

BREEDING

Aug–Nov near the coast, otherwise after rain. Flimsy cup of grass lined with hair or wool, slung in a shrub. Clutch usually 2 (1–3); female incubates c. 13 days.

QLD: forresti (west and Gulf) and sonorus (Murray–Darling basin in the south). Formerly placed in Lichenostomus.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. CV

Yellow Honeyeater

Stomiopera flava

MELIPHAGIDAE · HONEYEATERS

17–19 cm

NO. CV

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Aug–Feb

DESCRIPTION

- **Face** – dusky lores; brighter yellow face and throat
- **Bill** – black, slightly down-curved bill
- **Body** – plain olive-yellow; no plume or streaks
- **Wing** – olive-green wings; yellow feather edges
- **Tail** – long, plain olive-yellow tail

Sexes alike in plumage; males average slightly larger. Adult plain olive-yellow, brightest yellow on forehead, face and throat, with dusky lores, dark eye and black bill. Juvenile duller and greener, with a yellowish base to the bill and a pale yellow gape.

BEHAVIOUR

Takes nectar from eucalypts, bottlebrushes, grevilleas and mistletoes, insects gleaned from foliage, and some fruit. Usually alone, in pairs or small loose groups; noisy and aggressive at flowering trees. Common, sedentary or locally nomadic.



Northern & eastern coastal wetlands

Rivers & creeks · Wetlands · Woodland · Parks & gardens

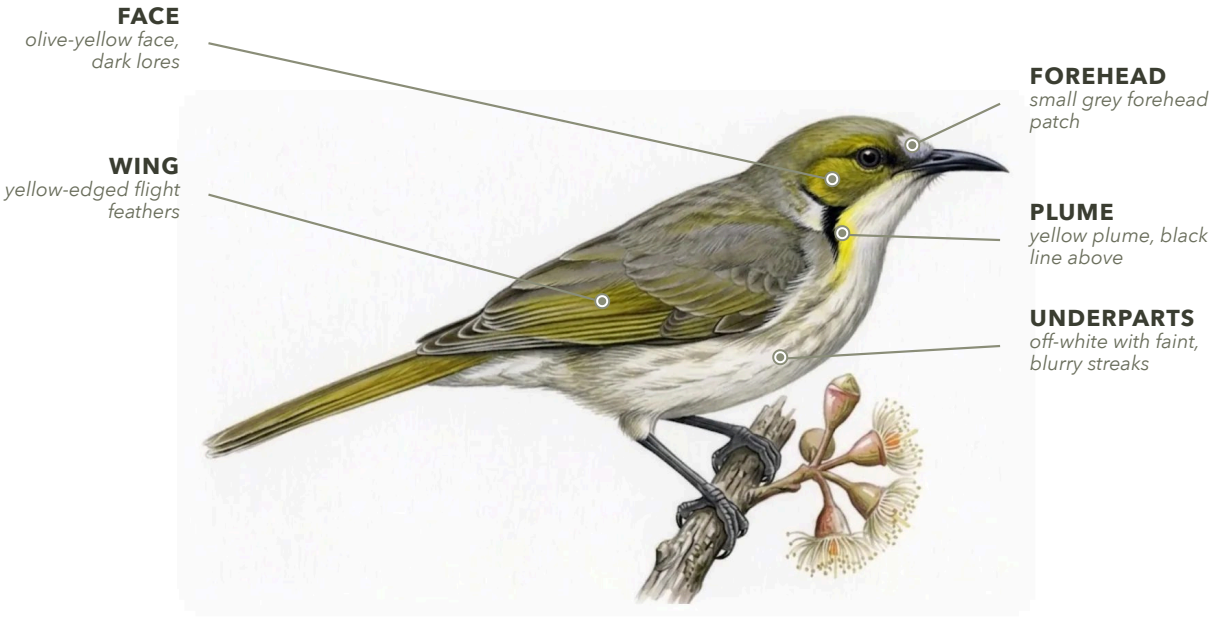
DISTRIBUTION

Essentially a Queensland endemic: Cape York Peninsula and the Gulf Plains south through the Wet Tropics, Einasleigh Uplands and Townsville–Burdekin coast to the Mackay region and about Rockhampton.

BREEDING

Mainly Aug–Feb. Clutch 2. Neat cup of fine bark strips, grass and plant fibre bound with cobweb, slung by the rim in a leafy fork of a shrub or small tree.

Nominate flava: Cape York and Gulf, south to about Cairns; addenda: Cairns–Mareeba south to central QLD. Formerly Lichenostomus flavus.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. CVI

Grey-fronted Honeyeater

Ptilotula plumula

MELIPHAGIDAE · HONEYEATERS

15–17 cm

NO. CVI

BREEDING J F M A M J **J A S O N D** Mainly Jul–Dec; any month

DESCRIPTION

- **Forehead** – small grey forehead patch; obscure in north
- **Face** – dark lores; olive-yellow crown and face
- **Plume** – yellow neck plume; black line above
- **Wing** – grey-olive back; yellow-edged flight feathers
- **Underparts** – off-white with faint, blurry streaks

Sexes alike in plumage. Adult has light grey forehead, olive-yellow crown and face, dark lores, and a bright yellow neck plume topped by a black line; bill and gape black. Juvenile has a dull yellowish-olive forehead, duller plume, yellowish-orange gape and paler bill base.

BEHAVIOUR

Feeds on nectar from eucalypts, grevilleas and eremophilas, plus insects and lerp gleaned from foliage. Usually in pairs or small groups, joining other honeyeaters at blossom and water. Nomadic, following flowering. Uncommon and patchy in Queensland.



Western & central-west inland

Spinifex | Arid scrub | Woodland

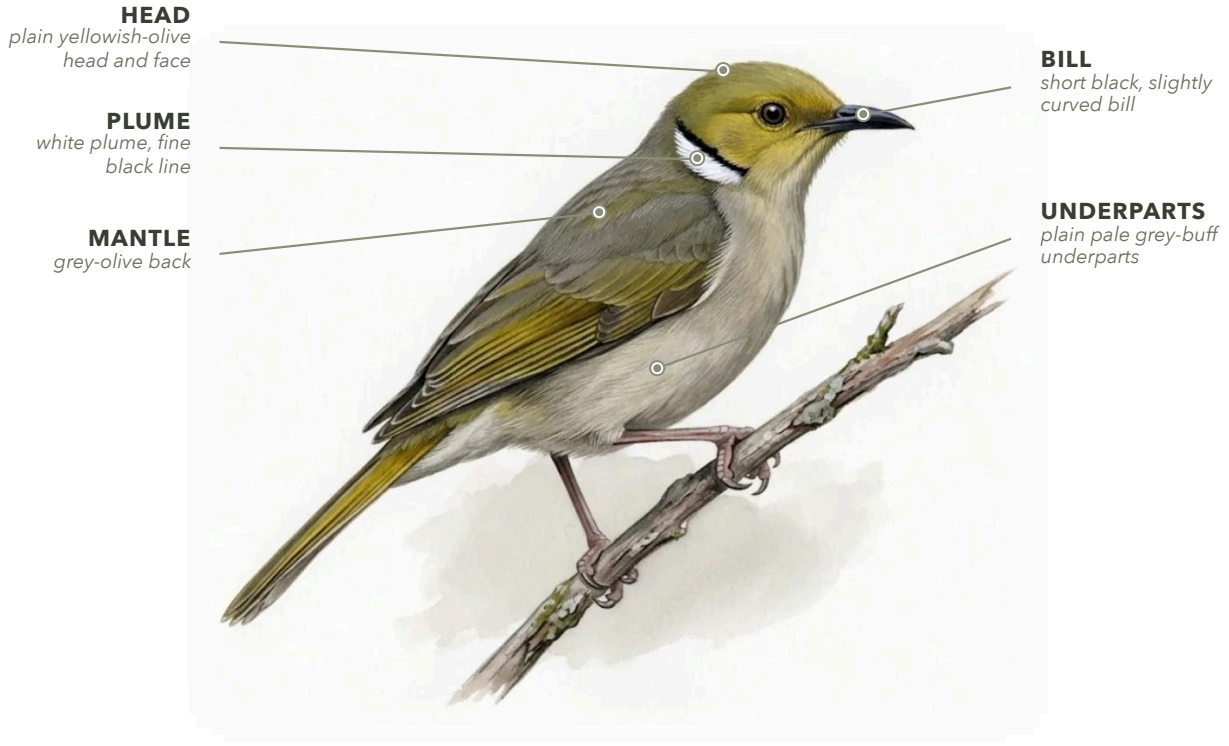
DISTRIBUTION

Patchy in western Queensland: the north-west (Mount Isa uplands, Lawn Hill–Gregory, inland Gulf) through the central west to the Mulga Lands and Channel Country margins; scarce east of about 147°E.

BREEDING

Mainly Jul–Dec, but at other times after rain. Clutch 2–3. Small cup of grass and plant fibre bound with cobweb, slung from twigs of a shrub or sapling.

planasi in north-west Qld (grey forehead obscure); graingeri in central-west and southern Qld. Formerly Lichenostomus plumulus.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. CVII

White-plumed Honeyeater

Ptilotula penicillata

MELIPHAGIDAE · HONEYEATERS

15–17 cm

NO. CVII

BREEDING J F M A M J J **A S O N D** **Mainly Aug–Dec; any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – plain yellowish-olive head and face
- **Plume** – white neck plume; fine black line above
- **Bill** – short black, slightly curved bill
- **Mantle** – grey-olive back; yellow-edged wings
- **Underparts** – plain pale grey-buff underparts

Sexes alike; males slightly larger. Adult has yellowish-olive head, small white neck plume narrowly bordered black above, grey-olive back and pale grey-buff underparts. Inland birds are paler and yellower. Juvenile duller, with a faint plume and paler, yellowish bill base.

BEHAVIOUR

Feeds actively in tree crowns on nectar, insects, lerp, honeydew and manna, with some fruit and seeds; sometimes hawks or feeds on the ground. Gregarious and pugnacious, in pairs or noisy groups. Common to abundant along inland watercourses.



Western & central-west inland

Rivers & creeks · Woodland · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Widespread west of the Great Dividing Range, from the Darling Downs and Maranoa through the Channel Country and central west to the north-west and southern Gulf; absent from Cape York, the Wet Tropics and most of the east coast.

BREEDING

Any month, mainly Aug–Dec; 2–3 broods a year. Clutch 2–3. Female builds a small cup of grass and spider web, lined with wool, hair or feathers, in tree foliage.

Nominate penicillata in the south-east (Darling Downs, Maranoa); paler, yellower leilavalensis across inland and north-west Qld.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. CVIII

Yellow-tufted Honeyeater

Lichenostomus melanops

MELIPHAGIDAE · HONEYEATERS

17–21 cm

NO. CVIII

BREEDING J F M A M J **J A S O N D** Jul–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Crown** – golden-yellow crown and forehead
- **Mask** – broad black mask through the eye
- **Ear tuft** – bright yellow tuft behind the mask
- **Throat** – bright yellow chin and throat
- **Mantle** – dark olive-green back and wings

Sexes alike; males slightly larger. Adult has golden-yellow crown, broad black face mask, bright yellow ear tuft and throat, dark olive-green upperparts and dull yellow underparts. Juvenile duller and paler, with yellow areas washed green and a pale yellow gape.

BEHAVIOUR

Feeds on eucalypt nectar, insects, lerp, honeydew and manna in the canopy, shrubs and on bark. Lives in colonies of neighbouring territories; singly, in pairs or groups of up to ten. Common in suitable habitat; some autumn–winter movement to gullies.



South-east & central-east

Open forest · Woodland · Rivers & creeks

DISTRIBUTION

South-eastern Queensland: the Granite Belt, border ranges and Darling Downs north through the Brisbane Valley, Burnett and Brigalow Belt to about the Tropic (Blackdown Tableland, Gladstone hinterland); sparse near the coast.

BREEDING

Mainly Jul–Jan. Clutch 2–3. Tightly woven cup of bark and grass bound with cobweb, hung in an understorey shrub or sapling. Two or three broods; often with helpers.

Qld birds are the inland race meltoni; nominate melanops is coastal NSW–Vic; Helmeted (cassidix) is confined to Victoria.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE

NO. CIX

White-eared Honeyeater

Nesoptilotis leucotis

MELIPHAGIDAE · HONEYEATERS

18–21 cm



NO. CIX

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D — **Mainly Aug–Jan; any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Crown** – grey cap with fine dark scalloping
- **Face** – black face, chin and throat bib
- **Ear patch** – large white patch behind the eye
- **Mantle** – bright olive-green back and wings
- **Underparts** – yellowish-olive breast and belly

Sexes alike; males larger. Adult has grey, finely scalloped crown, black face, chin and bib, large white ear patch, olive-green upperparts and yellowish-olive underparts. Juvenile duller and browner, with an olive-green crown, greyer face, duller ear patch and yellowish gape.

BEHAVIOUR

Mainly insects gleaned from bark, crevices and foliage of eucalypts, plus nectar, fruit, manna, lerp and honeydew; also feeds at wounds on trunks. Usually in pairs or small family groups; noisy and conspicuous. Sedentary. Fairly common.



South-east & central-east

Open forest · Woodland · Heath

DISTRIBUTION

South-eastern Queensland from the border ranges and Granite Belt west to the Brigalow and Mulga Lands, north through the Burnett to Carnarvon and Blackdown Tableland; isolated population near Pentland–White Mountains.

BREEDING

Most months, mainly Aug–Jan. Clutch 2–3. Deep, thick-walled cup of bark and grass lined with hair or fur, placed low in a shrub or sapling. Female incubates.

Nominate leucotis in coastal forests from north of Brisbane south; novaenorciae west of the Divide from central Qld.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. CX

Black-chinned Honeyeater

Melithreptus gularis

MELIPHAGIDAE · HONEYEATERS

15–17 cm

NO. CX

BREEDING J F M A M **J J A S O N D** Jun–Dec

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – black head; white band from eye to nape
- **Eye** – turquoise-blue crescent above eye
- **Chin** – black chin stripe edged with white
- **Mantle** – olive-green back; brown wings and tail
- **Legs** – bright orange legs and feet

Sexes alike. Adult (gularis) has black head and chin, white nape band reaching the eye, turquoise-blue eye skin, olive-green back and buff-white underparts. Golden-backed laetior has a golden-yellow back and green-yellow eye skin. Juvenile has a brown crown and yellow-orange bill.

BEHAVIOUR

Gleans insects from outer foliage, twigs and bark high in eucalypts; also nectar and honeydew. Noisy, gregarious groups of up to 12, often with other honeyeaters. Resident or locally nomadic. Uncommon and declining in the south-east.



Inland eastern Queensland

Woodland · Rivers & creeks

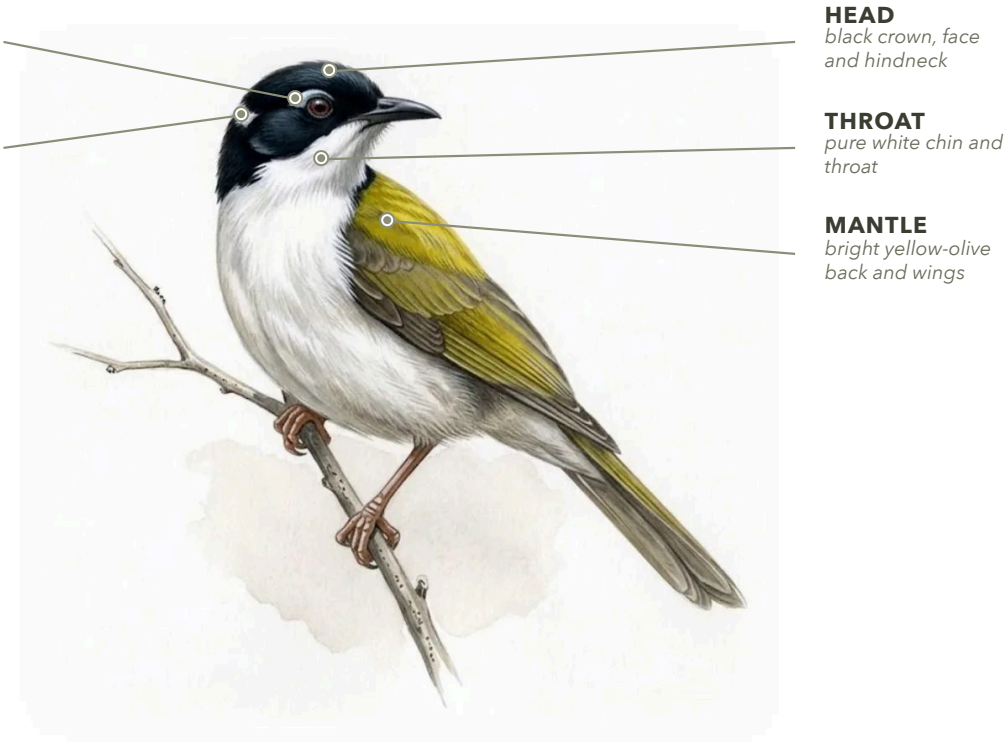
DISTRIBUTION

Inland eastern and northern Queensland: Darling Downs, Brisbane Valley and Brigalow Belt north through the Einasleigh Uplands to the Cape York interior; the Golden-backed form in the Gulf and north-west uplands.

BREEDING

Jun–Dec. Clutch 2–3. Compact, felted cup of bark fibre and hair, slung high in the outer canopy among foliage; often cooperative, with helpers feeding young.

Eastern gularis in southern and central Qld (to about Rockhampton); Golden-backed laetior in the north and west; intergrades in N Qld.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. CXI

White-throated Honeyeater

Melithreptus albogularis

MELIPHAGIDAE · HONEYEATERS

12–14.5 cm

NO. CXI

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Jun–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – black crown, face and hindneck
- **Eye** – pale bluish-white crescent above eye
- **Nape** – narrow white band; stops short of eye
- **Throat** – pure white chin and throat
- **Mantle** – bright yellow-olive back and wings

Sexes alike; males average larger. Adult has black crown, face and hindneck, narrow white nape band, bluish-white eye crescent, white chin and underparts, yellow-olive back and red-brown iris. Juvenile has a mid-brown crown, brown eye, and pale orange-pink gape and bill base.

BEHAVIOUR

Gleans insects, spiders and lerp from foliage and bark, and takes nectar from eucalypts, paperbarks and grevilleas. In pairs or small parties, often in mixed feeding flocks. Common; sedentary or locally nomadic.



Eastern Queensland

Open forest · Woodland · Wetlands · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Widespread in eastern Queensland, from the tip of Cape York through the Wet Tropics and Brigalow Belt to the NSW border, inland to the Einasleigh Uplands and Carnarvon ranges; also the north-west Gulf country.

BREEDING

Mainly Jun–Jan. Clutch 2. Deep, neat cup of bark strips and grass bound with cobweb, slung by the rim among outer leaves high in a eucalypt or paperbark.

Nominate albogularis on Cape York and in the Gulf; inopinatus (longer-winged) through eastern Qld to NE NSW.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. CXII

Lewin's Honeyeater

Meliphaga lewinii

MELIPHAGIDAE · HONEYEATERS

19–22 cm

NO. CXII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A **S O N D** Sep–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Ear** – large pale-yellow crescent ear-patch
- **Gape** – creamy-yellow gape stripe below eye
- **Eye** – blue-grey iris; brown in juveniles
- **Bill** – black, fairly stout, slightly curved
- **Body** – dark olive-green; paler, greyer below

Sexes alike: dark olive-green with a large pale-yellow crescent ear-patch, creamy-yellow gape stripe, black bill and blue-grey eye; pale yellow edges to flight feathers. Juvenile very like adult but has a brown, not blue-grey, eye.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats mostly fruit and berries, plus insects (some caught in flight) and nectar. Forages from the understorey to the canopy and on trunks. Usually solitary or in pairs, sometimes loose groups of up to ~10 at fruiting trees. Common and sedentary.



Eastern seaboard

Rainforest · Wet forest · Vine scrub · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Eastern Qld from the McIlwraith Range (Cape York) through the Wet Tropics, Eungella and the central ranges to SEQ and the NSW border; inland to the Bunya Mtns, Blackdown and Carnarvon.

BREEDING

Mainly Sep–Jan. Clutch 2–3. A large, bulky cup of plant material bound with spider web and lined with soft fibres, slung in a fork of a shrub, sapling or vine.

Nominate lewinii from SEQ to about Rockhampton; mab Rockhampton–Cooktown; amphochlora isolated on Cape York's McIlwraith Range.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. CXIII

Yellow-faced Honeyeater

Caligavis chrysops

MELIPHAGIDAE · HONEYEATERS

15–18 cm

NO. CXIII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D Jul–Mar

DESCRIPTION

- **Face** – yellow stripe below eye, edged black
- **Ear** – small white plume behind the stripe
- **Bill** – black, slightly decurved
- **Wing** – olive-yellow flight-feather edges
- **Underparts** – pale grey-brown, faintly streaked

Sexes alike; male slightly larger. Grey-brown with faint streaks on crown and paler underparts; broad yellow stripe below eye bordered black above and below, ending in a small white plume; olive-yellow wing edges. Juvenile paler, with a plainer, unstreaked head.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats nectar, pollen, insects, fruit and seeds, foraging in flowers and foliage of trees, shrubs and mistletoe; rarely on the ground. Partly migratory: large flocks move north in autumn and south in spring; territorial when breeding. Common.



Eastern Queensland

Open forest | Woodland | Heath | Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Eastern Qld from the Cooktown area and Atherton Tableland through the Wet Tropics uplands, Eungella and central ranges to SEQ, the Darling Downs and Granite Belt; sparser inland to Carnarvon NP.

BREEDING

Jul–Mar. Clutch 2–3. Female builds a small, delicate woven cup of grass and moss, bound with web, low in a shrub, vine or sapling. Both parents feed the young.

Nominate chrysops in central and SE Qld; barroni in the Wet Tropics and Clarke Range (Eungella) of NE Qld; samueli in SA.



ADULT ♂ (♀ YELLOW GAPE) NO. CXIV

Brown Honeyeater

Lichmera indistincta

MELIPHAGIDAE · HONEYEATERS

12–16 cm

NO. CXIV

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D — **Mainly Jul–Jan; any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Ear** – small yellow spot behind the eye
- **Bill** – long, slender, decurved, black
- **Gape** – black in breeding ♂; yellow in ♀
- **Wing** – olive-yellow panel on folded wing
- **Body** – plain grey-brown; paler buff-grey below

Male: grey-brown with darker grey-brown crown, small yellow spot behind eye, olive-yellow wing panel, and a black gape when breeding. Female slightly smaller, olive-brown crown, gape always pale yellow. Juvenile like female, with a bright yellow swollen gape and faint eye-spot.

BEHAVIOUR

Mainly nectar from mistletoe, mangroves, eucalypts, paperbarks, banksias and grevilleas, plus insects gleaned or caught in flight. Usually single, in pairs or small groups; joins mixed honeyeater flocks. Locally nomadic, following flowering. Abundant.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Mangroves · Woodland · Heath · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Throughout Queensland from Torres Strait and Cape York to the NSW border; abundant on the coast and across the tropics, and widespread inland along timbered watercourses into the Gulf and Channel Country.

BREEDING

Any month, mainly Jul–Jan in the east. Clutch 2–3. Female builds a small woven cup of grass and bark bound with web, in a low fork under 2 m, often near water.

IOC: ocularis in eastern Qld incl. Cape York; nominate indistincta reaches western Qld; others in NT, New Guinea and Indonesia.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. CXV

Spiny-cheeked Honeyeater

Acanthagenys rufogularis

MELIPHAGIDAE · HONEYEATERS

22–27 cm

NO. CXV

BREEDING J F M A M J J **A S O N** D **Mainly Aug–Nov; any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Bill** – pink, black-tipped; long and straight
- **Cheek** – white bristly stripe below the eye
- **Throat** – cinnamon-buff throat and breast
- **Eye** – pale blue iris in adults
- **Underparts** – pale, boldly spotted dark brown

Sexes alike. Pink black-tipped bill; white bristly cheek stripe; cinnamon-buff throat and upper breast; streaked grey-brown upperparts; pale, dark-spotted belly; whitish rump and white tail tip; pale blue eye. Juvenile duller, with a brown eye and a yellowish cheek sash.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats fruit (incl. mistletoe berries), nectar and insects, also spiders and small reptiles. Forages in shrubs and the canopy, sometimes on the ground. Usually single or in pairs; flocks at food. Nomadic in the north, more resident south. Common.



Western & central-west inland

Arid scrub · Woodland · Rivers & creeks · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Inland Qld west of the Great Divide: Mulga Lands, Channel Country, Mitchell Grass Downs and NW uplands, east through the Maranoa and Darling Downs to Toowoomba; rare strays to the coast; absent from Cape York.

BREEDING

Mainly Aug–Nov; recorded in most months. Clutch 2–3. Deep cup of grass and web slung between twigs 1–13 m up, lined with fur, wool or plant down.

Monotypic (IOC); the only species in the genus Acanthagenys.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE

NO. CXVI

Striped Honeyeater

Plectorhyncha lanceolata

MELIPHAGIDAE · HONEYEATERS

22–25 cm

NO. CXVI

BREEDING J F M A M J J **A S O N D** Aug–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – white, boldly streaked black
- **Bill** – short, sharp, blue-grey; dark tip
- **Throat** – white, with shaggy pointed feathers
- **Mantle** – grey-brown, streaked darker
- **Underparts** – whitish, faintly streaked

Sexes alike (female may be a little browner above). White head, neck and throat boldly streaked black, with shaggy pointed throat feathers; streaked grey-brown back; whitish underparts with faint streaks; blue-grey bill and legs. Juvenile browner and duller, less streaked.

BEHAVIOUR

Mainly insects and spiders gleaned from foliage and bark or caught in flight; also nectar, seeds and fruit. Usually singly, in pairs or small groups; feeds peaceably with other honeyeaters but dive-bombs nest intruders. Fairly common.



South-east & central-east

Woodland · Open forest · Rivers & creeks · Mangroves

DISTRIBUTION

Southern and central Qld: Darling Downs, Brigalow Belt, Maranoa and Mulga Lands west to the Warrego and Winton districts, north to Charters Towers; also SEQ coastal lowlands incl. Moreton Bay.

BREEDING

Aug–Jan, varying with conditions. Clutch about 3. Both sexes build a deep, thick-walled bag of grass, fibre and often emu feathers, hung from a drooping branch 1–6 m up.

Monotypic; sole species of Plectorhyncha.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE; ♀ SMALLER NO. CXVII

Regent Honeyeater

Anthochaera phrygia

MELIPHAGIDAE · HONEYEATERS

20–24 cm



NO. CXVII

BREEDING J F M A M J J **A S O N D** Aug–Jan

DESCRIPTION

- **Head** – solid black head and neck
- **Face** – bare warty cream skin around eye
- **Breast** – black, scalloped pale yellow
- **Wing** – broad bright-yellow panels
- **Tail** – black centre, yellow sides

Sexes similar: black head, bare warty pale cream skin round the eye, black body scalloped pale yellow, broad yellow wing and tail panels. Female smaller, a little duller, with less facial skin. Juvenile mostly brown, with narrow pale wing edges and smooth grey-brown face skin.

BEHAVIOUR

Feeds mainly on nectar of box, ironbark and other eucalypts and mistletoes; also insects, lerp and fruit. Highly nomadic, tracking flowering. Now seen singly, in pairs or small groups; aggressive at blossom. Wild population about 250–300.



South-east & central-east

Woodland · Open forest · Rivers & creeks

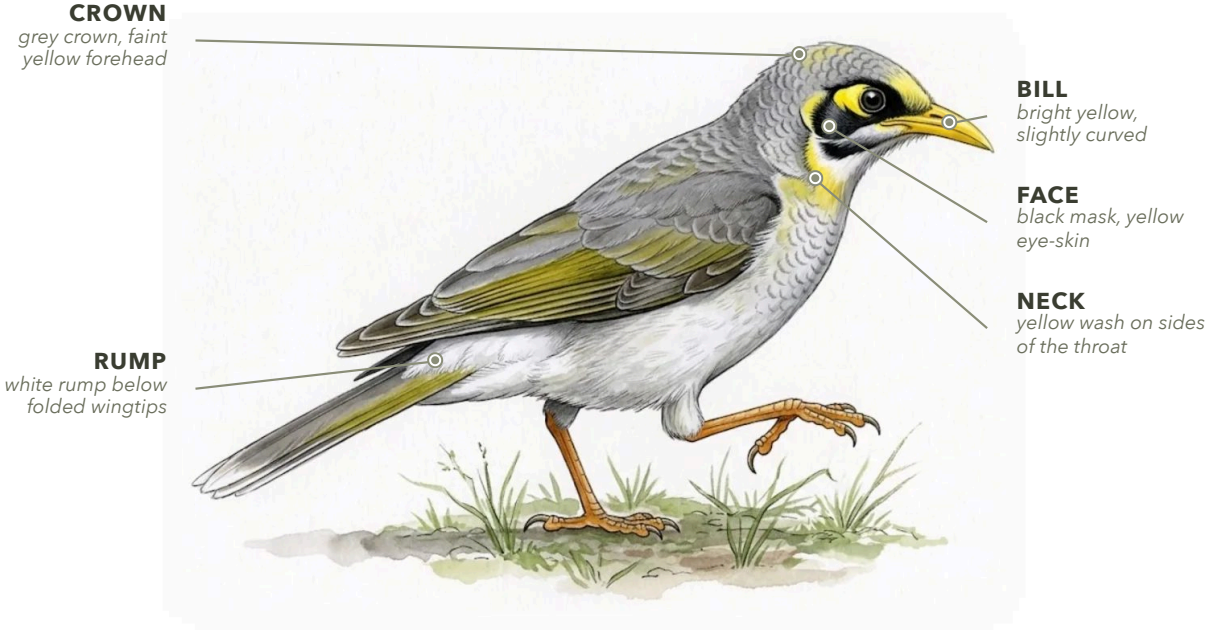
DISTRIBUTION

Now a rare, irregular winter visitor to SE Qld; recent strays at Springfield Lakes (Ipswich) in 2019 and Highfields near Toowoomba in 2024. Once north to the Rockhampton area; vagrant to Mackay in 1963.

BREEDING

Mainly Aug–Jan; core breeding areas now in NSW and NE Victoria. Clutch 2–3. Female builds a bark cup bound with web in a fork or mistletoe clump, 1–20 m up.

Monotypic. Formerly Xanthomyza phrygia; old name 'Warty-faced Honeyeater'.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. CXVIII

Yellow-throated Miner

Manorina flavigula

MELIPHAGIDAE · HONEYEATERS

22–28 cm

NO. CXVIII

BREEDING J F M A M J J **A S O** N D — **Mainly Aug–Oct; any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Crown** – grey crown, faint yellow forehead
- **Face** – black mask; bare yellow skin by eye
- **Neck** – yellow wash on sides of the throat
- **Bill** – bright yellow, slightly curved
- **Rump** – white rump below folded wingtips

Sexes alike. Grey with faint scalloping on the breast; grey crown, faint yellow forehead; black ear-coverts and mask; yellow bill, legs and bare skin by eye; yellow neck sides; white rump; white tail tips. Juvenile softer and plainer, unscalloped, with browner wings and tail.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats insects (most of the diet) and nectar, plus fruit, seeds and lerp, gleaned in the canopy, on bark and on the ground. Lives in noisy colonies of a dozen to 50; aggressive to smaller birds. Sedentary. Common to abundant inland.



Western & central-west inland

Woodland · Arid scrub · Farmland · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Most of inland Qld: Channel Country, Mitchell Grass Downs, Mulga Lands, NW uplands, Gulf plains, Brigalow Belt and Einasleigh Uplands, reaching the dry coast near Townsville–Bowen; absent from Cape York.

BREEDING

Year-round, peaking Aug–Oct. Clutch 2–5, usually 3–4. Loose cup of twigs and grass lined with wool or fur, in a tree fork 3–6 m up; helpers feed young.

Nominate flavigula over most of Qld; wayensis in the far west and north-west (Mount Isa–Channel Country).



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. CXIX

Bell Miner

Manorina melanophrys

MELIPHAGIDAE · HONEYEATERS

17–20 cm

NO. CXIX

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D — **Mainly Jun–Nov; any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Bill** – short, bright yellow; slightly decurved
- **Eye** – orange-red bare patch behind the eye
- **Lores** – black lores and thin dark moustache
- **Plumage** – uniform olive-green; wings darker grey-olive
- **Legs** – bright orange-yellow legs and feet

Sexes alike; males slightly larger. Adult olive-green, a little darker on the wings, with yellow bill, orange-red bare skin behind the eye, black lores and narrow dark moustache, and orange-yellow legs. Juvenile duller and browner, with a paler bill and paler, smaller eye patch.

BEHAVIOUR

Feeds mainly on psyllids and their sugary lerps gleaned from eucalypt foliage, plus other insects, nectar and manna, usually 8 m or more up. Lives in sedentary colonies of 8–200 birds that aggressively exclude other small birds. Locally common.



South-east & central-east

Open forest · Wet forest · Rivers & creeks

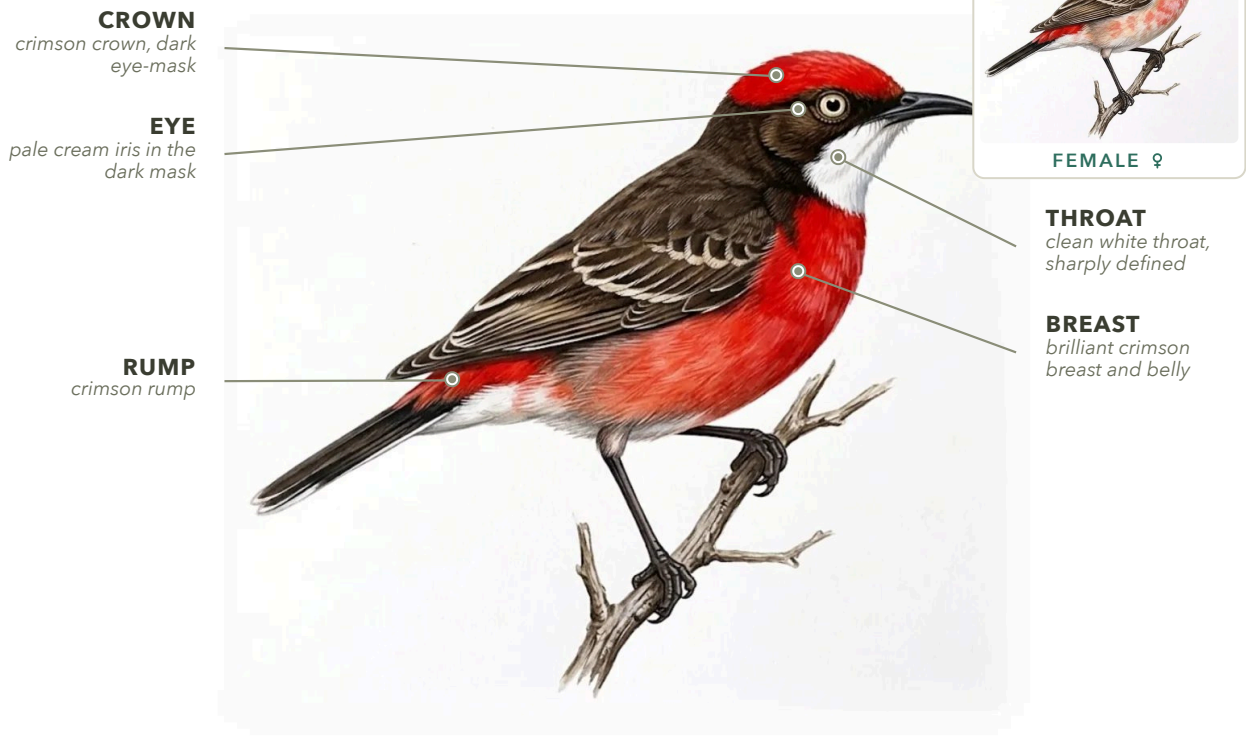
DISTRIBUTION

South-east Queensland only, from about Gympie and the Blackall Range south to the NSW border, coast to the Great Dividing Range, e.g. D'Aguilar Range, Scenic Rim and Lamington; patchy, in discrete colonies.

BREEDING

Mainly Jun–Nov, but any month. Clutch 1–3 (usually 2). Female alone builds a thin cup in a dense shrub or sapling; helpers feed the young.

Monotypic. Formerly called 'Bellbird'; not to be confused with the Crested Bellbird of inland Australia.



ADULT ♂ (♀ BROWN, PINK-WASHED) NO. CXX

Crimson Chat

Epthianura tricolor

MELIPHAGIDAE · HONEYEATERS

11–13 cm

NO. CXX

BREEDING J F M A M J J **A** **S** **O** N D — **Mainly Aug–Oct; any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Crown** – crimson crown; dark mask through the eye
- **Throat** – clean white throat, sharply defined
- **Breast** – brilliant crimson breast and belly
- **Eye** – pale cream iris in the dark mask
- **Rump** – crimson rump; tail blackish, white-tipped

Male: crimson crown, breast and rump, white throat, dark brown mask and upperparts; duller and patchier outside breeding. Female: brown above, buff-white below with a pinkish-red wash on the breast, white throat and red rump. Juvenile like female but plainer and buffer.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats mainly insects and spiders taken on or near the ground, plus nectar and some seeds. In pairs or loose flocks, sometimes of hundreds, moving widely after rain; mostly a winter visitor to the north. Irregular and locally common.



Western & central-west inland

Arid scrub · Spinifex · Grassland

DISTRIBUTION

Western and central Queensland: Channel Country, Mitchell-grass downs, Mulga Lands and the north-west; nomadic, following rain. In dry inland years it irrupts east to the Maranoa, Darling Downs and Brigalow Belt.

BREEDING

Mainly Aug–Oct in the south; almost any month after rain in the north. Clutch 2–4, usually 3. Small cup of grass and twigs low in a shrub or tussock; loose colonies.

Monotypic. Also called Tricoloured Chat or Saltbush Canary.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. CXXI

Eastern Whipbird

Psophodes olivaceus

PSOPHODIDAE · WHIPBIRDS & WEDGEBILLS

25–30 cm



NO. CXXI

BREEDING J F M A M J **J A S O N D** Jul–Dec

DESCRIPTION

- **Crest** – black crest, often raised
- **Cheek** – broad white patch on side of throat
- **Head** – black head and breast; dark eye
- **Mantle** – dark olive-green back and wings
- **Tail** – long, graduated; white tips to outer feathers

Sexes alike; male slightly larger. Adult has black head, crest and breast, broad white cheek patch, dark olive-green upperparts, greyish-olive belly and long white-tipped tail. Juvenile dull olive-brown with a short crest, lacking the black throat and white cheek patch, which grows in as it matures.

BEHAVIOUR

Eats insects, spiders and other invertebrates gleaned from leaf litter and low vegetation, tossing leaves aside with the bill. Alone, in pairs or small family groups; sedentary and secretive but often curious. Common in suitable dense habitat.



Eastern seaboard

Rainforest · Wet forest · Vine scrub · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Eastern Queensland from Cooktown south to the NSW border, in coastal ranges and lowlands and inland to the Bunya Mountains and Carnarvon area. Northern ssp. lateralis in the Wet Tropics; nominate in central-east and SE QLD.

BREEDING

Jul–Dec, often two broods. Clutch 2–3, pale blue eggs with black spots. Loose bowl of twigs lined with fine material, low in dense shrubs or vines under 3 m.

lateralis (Wet Tropics form): Cooktown–Paluma, NE QLD. Nominate olivaceus: central-east and SE QLD, south to Victoria.



ADULT – SEXES ALIKE NO. CXXII

Grey-crowned Babbler

Pomatostomus temporalis

POMATOSTOMIDAE · AUSTRALASIAN BABBLERS

25–29 cm

NO. CXXII

BREEDING J F M A M J J A S O N D — **Mainly Jul–Feb; any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Crown** – pale grey crown; broad white brows
- **Eye** – pale yellow eye in a dark eye-stripe
- **Bill** – long, black and strongly decurved
- **Throat** – white throat and breast; belly brown
- **Tail** – long, blackish, broadly tipped white

Sexes alike. Adult: grey crown edged by broad white brows, dark brown eye-stripe, pale yellow eye, white throat and upper breast grading to brown belly, blackish white-tipped tail. Juvenile: dark brown eye, shorter, less curved bill; eye pales to yellow by about 3 years.

BEHAVIOUR

Forages mostly on the ground and on trunks, probing litter, bark and logs for insects, spiders and small reptiles, with some seeds and fruit. Sedentary family groups of 2–15 defend year-round territories. Common in QLD; declining in the south.



Statewide (suitable habitat)

Woodland · Rivers & creeks · Mangroves · Parks & gardens

DISTRIBUTION

Widespread through most of Queensland, from Cape York and the Gulf to the NSW border and inland to the north-west; scarce or absent in the far south-west deserts. Common in Brigalow Belt and coastal woodlands.

BREEDING

Mainly Jul–Feb, but any month. Clutch 2–3 (up to 6). Large domed stick nest with a hooded side entrance in a shrub or sapling; female incubates, helpers assist.

temporalis (white breast): eastern QLD incl. Cape York. rubeculus (rufous breast): NW QLD; intergrade in north-central QLD.

CROWN
brown crown, narrow white brow

FACE
dark brown eye-stripe below the brow



BILL
long, slender, black and decurved

THROAT
white throat and upper breast

TAIL
long, dark brown

ADULT – SEXES ALIKE

NO. CXXIII

White-browed Babbler

Pomatostomus superciliosus

POMATOSTOMIDAE · AUSTRALASIAN BABBLERS

17–21 cm

NO. CXXIII

BREEDING J F M A M **J J A S O N** D — **Mainly Jun–Nov; any month**

DESCRIPTION

- **Crown** – dark brown crown; narrow white brow
- **Face** – dark brown eye-stripe below the brow
- **Bill** – long, slender, black and decurved
- **Throat** – white throat and upper breast
- **Tail** – long, dark brown; narrow white tips

Sexes alike; males average larger. Adult: dark brown crown and upperparts, narrow white brow, dark brown eye-stripe, white throat and upper breast grading to grey-brown flanks and belly, long white-tipped tail. Juvenile: shorter, less curved bill, cream brow, yellow gape.

BEHAVIOUR

Feeds mostly on the ground, probing litter, bark and logs for insects, spiders and other invertebrates, with some seeds and fruit. Sedentary, highly social groups; inquisitive. Sensitive to shrub clearing and heavy grazing; locally common.



South-east & central-east

Woodland · Arid scrub

DISTRIBUTION

Two separate areas: southern inland SE QLD west of the Divide (Granite Belt north to Toowoomba, Dalby and Chinchilla, west to Goondiwindi and Meandarra), and the Simpson Desert east to Birdsville.

BREEDING

Mainly Jun–Nov, but any month. Clutch usually 2–3, up to 6. Domed stick nest with a hooded side entrance in a shrub; only the breeding female incubates.

gilgandra in SE QLD (Murray-Darling Basin). Simpson Desert birds probably centralis. Older name: White-browed Chatterer.